

Advanced English (C1 Advanced)

Your English notebook for the whole course. Sharpen precision and style, write and argue at an advanced level, and track what you can do.

8 modules • 24 lessons

Words • grammar • speaking • I can...

Name: _____

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Precision in Time & Modality

Three lessons about saying familiar things more exactly. Place an event precisely in the future, or in a future seen from the past. Set your certainty on a dial instead of a switch. And use the subjunctive to make formal recommendations that sound measured and authoritative.

Lessons 1.1-1.3

Classes C1-C3

Level C1

Name: _____

HOW THIS WORKBOOK WORKS

Each lesson has new language, a grammar box, exercises, a model dialogue, a main task, a self-check and space for your own notes. Instructions tell you whether to **read**, **listen**, **write**, **speak** or **work with a partner**. Answers are not printed here; your teacher has them.

Whenever a task touches on your own life, you decide how much to share. Use your real experience, **or** a new identity card, **or** something you invent: all three are equally valid. In role-plays and debates you argue the position on the card, not your personal view, and you can always say "Pass."

◆ WELCOME TO C1

At C1 the gains are subtle. You are rarely learning to say something new; you are learning to say it with greater exactness, nuance and control, and to choose the register that suits the moment. Expect three kinds of feedback in this course: on **range** (the ambitious, precise language you use), on **accuracy** (errors to fix) and on **appropriacy** (whether a form, however correct, suits the situation and the listener).

◆ FIRST-DAY WRITING SAMPLE – WRITE (8 MINUTES)

This is not a test. It helps your teacher plan the course around what you need. Write **80–120 words** without a dictionary or phone. Choose **one** prompt.

A. Write a short email to a manager (real or invented) updating them on a project you have been working on: what has gone well, what has been delayed, and what happens next.

B. Write a short paragraph describing one change that would improve a workplace, school or organization you know (real or invented), and explain why.

My prompt: ☐ A ☐ B

◆ READ AND SAY – NEW WORDS: PROJECTS AND TIMELINES

a milestone

a timeline

a stakeholder

a steering committee

on track

behind schedule

to go live

to roll out

to hand over

in the pipeline

a pilot (project)

phase two

Useful phrases for placing events in time:

by then · by the time...

this time next week

is to... (formal)

is about to...

is on the verge of...

is due to...

is set to...

was to have...

a **stakeholder** = anyone with an interest in a project (a manager, a client, a funder, the public) · **on the verge of** = very close to (doing) something

◆ GRAMMAR BOX

Three vantage points. Stand at a future moment and look around.

In progress at that moment	will be + -ing	This time tomorrow I'll be flying over the Atlantic.
Completed by that moment	will have + past participle	By 2030 the company will have opened ten offices.
Duration up to that moment	will have been + -ing	By June I'll have been working here for a decade.

The time clause stays in the **present**: *By the time you **arrive**, we'll have finished.* Stative verbs stay simple: *By July I'll have **known** her for ten years.* The future continuous also makes an inquiry **tactful**: *Will you **be using** the car tonight?*

The future seen from the past

was / were going to	an earlier plan (often not carried out)	We were going to fly, but the strike changed everything.
would	a future seen from the past, in narrative	She left in 2001; she would never return.
was / were about to	on the point of doing something	I was about to leave when the phone rang.
was to · was to have + pp	destiny / a formal plan · a plan that did not happen	The decision was to have far-reaching consequences. · The launch was to have taken place in March.

Formal and imminent futures

be to	an official arrangement · an instruction · a condition	The mayor is to open the library on May 12. · You are to report to reception. · If we are to meet the deadline, we need help.
be about to	any moment now (no time phrase)	We're about to sign the contract.
be on the verge / point of	+ -ing or a noun: very close	They're on the verge of reaching an agreement.
be due to	a timetable or schedule	The fix is due to arrive on the 20th.
be set to	expected, arranged (news style)	The firm is set to double its staff.

◆ EXERCISE 1 – LISTEN: THE MONDAY STAND-UP. COMPLETE THE FUTURE FORMS.

Your teacher reads a project lead's update on the renovation of the Harbor Point Community Center. Write the missing words.

1. We _____ the main hall in April.
2. This time next week, the electricians _____ on the second floor.
3. By the end of the month, the painters _____ all the classrooms.
4. By the time we reopen, the after-school program _____ in the temporary space for almost six months.
5. We _____ the contract for the new kitchen equipment.
6. The mayor _____ the site on May 12.
7. _____ any of you _____ the hall for evening events in June?

Speak: Is the project on schedule? Which sentence tells you most precisely?

◆ EXERCISE 2 – WRITE: COMPLETE WITH THE MOST PRECISE FUTURE FORM

Choose the future continuous, the future perfect or the future perfect continuous.

1. This time tomorrow, I _____ (fly) over the Atlantic.
2. By the end of the year, we _____ (complete) the merger.
3. In August, they _____ (run) the business for twenty years.
4. Don't phone at six; I _____ (drive) home.
5. By the time the auditors _____ (arrive), we _____ (check) every invoice.
6. By next spring, Dr. Osei _____ (know) her research partner for a decade.
7. _____ you _____ (present) at the conference next week? I'd like to add you to the program.
8. By the time she retires, she _____ (teach) more than three thousand students.

◆ EXERCISE 3 – WRITE: THE FUTURE SEEN FROM THE PAST, AND FORMAL FUTURES

Rewrite each sentence, keeping the meaning. The clue in brackets tells you which form to use.

1. (an earlier plan, canceled) We intended to sign the deal on Friday. → We _____, but...
2. (on the point of) I opened my mouth to object when she cut me off. → I _____ object when she cut me off.
3. (narrative future) He didn't know it then, but that meeting _____ change his life.

4. (an official plan that didn't happen) The plan was that the bridge would open in 2024. It didn't. → The bridge _____ in 2024.
5. (an official arrangement) The press release says, "The CEO will visit the plant on Friday." → The CEO _____ the plant on Friday.
6. (very close) The two companies have almost reached an agreement. → The two companies are _____ an agreement.
7. (a condition) We want to meet the deadline, so we need two more testers. → If we _____ the deadline, we need two more testers.

◆ EXERCISE 4 – READ: PRECISION AND REGISTER. CIRCLE THE BETTER CHOICE.

Be ready to explain each choice to a partner.

1. (to a senior colleague) (Will you use / Will you be using) the projector this afternoon?
2. By the time the guests (arrive / will arrive), dinner will be ready.
3. We're (about to / due to) sign the contract next Thursday.
4. By June, I'll (have known / have been knowing) Sam for ten years.
5. (a text to a friend) "(I'll have been arriving / I'll be there) around eight. Save me a seat!"
6. The new CEO (is to / is about to) be announced at next month's shareholders' meeting.
7. By the time you read this, I (will be leaving / will have left) the building.

◆ EXERCISE 5 – WRITE: A FUTURE-POINT PARAGRAPH

Choose a fixed point for a project (real or invented): a launch, a move, the end of a course, an opening day. Write 4–5 sentences: something in progress at that point, something completed by then, a duration, a plan that changed, and something imminent.

◆ READ AND SPEAK – DIALOGUE: A PROJECT CHECK-IN

Maya: Have you got a minute? The steering committee meets on the thirtieth, and I'm putting the update together.

Daniel: Sure. Where do you want to start?

Maya: The pilot. Will it be finished by then?

Daniel: Not quite. By the thirtieth we'll have been running it for six weeks, and we'll have collected about four hundred responses.

Maya: Good. And the new booking screen? We were to have launched it in May.

Daniel: I know. We were about to go live when the supplier changed the interface. The fix is due to arrive on the twentieth.

Maya: So on the thirtieth we'll still be testing it.

Daniel: Most likely. But the supplier is on the verge of signing a support deal with us, which should speed things up.

Maya: I'll mention that. One more thing: will you be joining the meeting? The director is to attend, and she's bound to have questions.

Daniel: I will. If we're to get the budget for phase two, I'd better be there.

Write: Underline every future form. Which one describes a plan that didn't happen? Which question is tactful, and what makes it tactful?

◆ WORK WITH A PARTNER – PROJECT BRIEFING

In class your group receives an invented project and a timeline. Plan a two-minute briefing for the steering meeting, one sentence per row. Everyone in the group speaks.

Project: _____ Steering meeting: _____	
In progress at the meeting	At the meeting, we'll be...
Completed by then	By then, we'll have...
Duration	By the meeting, we'll have been... for...
A plan that changed	We were going to... / ... was to have...
Imminent	We're about to... / ... is on the verge of... / ... is due to...
A formal arrangement	... is to...
A condition	If we are to..., we will need...

As a stakeholder, prepare two tactful questions for the other group: *Will you be needing...? · Will the team be working...?*

◆ SELF-CHECK — CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

"By the time you arrive, we ___ for hours." Which form best expresses duration up to that future point?

A) will be waiting

B) have been waiting

C) will have been waiting

2

"We ___ take the earlier train, but it was fully booked." Choose the natural "future in the past" form.

A) will

B) were going to

C) would have taken

3

"According to the press release, the director ___ visit the site on Friday."

A) is to

B) is about to

C) would

◆ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ say what will be in progress, completed, or ongoing at a future point
- ◆ ☐ keep the time clause in the present: *by the time we arrive*
- ◆ ☐ ask about someone's plans tactfully: *Will you be using...?*
- ◆ ☐ describe a future seen from the past: *was going to, was about to, was to have*

- ◆ ☐ use formal and imminent futures: *is to*, *is about to*, *is on the verge of*, *is due to*
- ◆ ☐ deliver a short, precise project briefing

◆ MY NEW WORDS

◆ MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Choose one fixed point a year from now (in your life, a project, or an invented persona). Write one sentence in the future perfect and one in the future perfect continuous, and note why each form fits what you mean.

◆ READ AND SAY — NEW WORDS: WEIGHING THE EVIDENCE

a hypothesis a hunch a lead a red herring to rule out to point to conclusive
 circumstantial on the evidence in all likelihood to jump to conclusions a verdict

a **red herring** = a clue that looks important but leads you away from the real explanation · **circumstantial** = suggesting something without proving it

◆ GRAMMAR BOX

The **certainty dial**. Choose exactly how much you are willing to commit to.

Near-certain	must · is bound to (future)	The lights are off; they must have gone to bed. · Prices are bound to rise.
Expected	should / ought to	They left at noon, so they should be home by now.
Quite likely	may / might / could well	Given the polls, the incumbent may well lose.
Possible	may / might / could	Prices might fall next quarter.
A slim chance	might just · could conceivably	This might just work. · It could conceivably be the software.
Ruled out	can't · can't possibly	He can't be serious. · They can't possibly have known.

False twins. *may well* = it's quite likely (probability): *The train **may well** be late.* · *may / might as well* = there's no reason not to (a decision): *The train's late, so we **may as well** get a coffee.*

The hidden jobs of will and would

will · present deduction	There's the doorbell; that'll be the courier.
won't · refusal, persistent failure	He simply won't listen. · The car won't start.
will · typical behavior	She'll sit at that window for hours. · She will keep interrupting! (stressed)
would · past habit (actions only)	Every summer we'd drive to the coast.
wouldn't · past refusal	I asked her to stay, but she wouldn't . · The engine wouldn't start.

would · criticism	"I didn't tell him." "You wouldn't , would you." · You would say that!
would · politeness	I'd suggest a short break. · I wouldn't worry too much.

Speculating about now and about the past

Now, in progress	modal + be + -ing	He must be joking . · They might be waiting outside.
The past	modal + have + pp	They must have left . · It can't have been easy.
The past, ongoing	modal + have been + -ing	She must have been waiting for hours.

◆ EXERCISE 1 – LISTEN: THE TUESDAY SLUMP

Nadia owns a café; Leo manages it. Sales on Tuesdays have fallen by forty percent. Write the modal expression you hear, then mark it on the dial: **R** ruled out · **P** possible · **L** quite likely · **C** near-certain · **D** a decision · **H** a past habit.

- It _____ the coffee. _____
- (the new café) It _____, I suppose. _____
- So it _____ with them. _____
- They _____ to working from home on Tuesdays. _____
- Their staff _____ ten lattes at once. _____
- Then it _____ that. _____
- If they're remote on Tuesdays, we _____ quieter. _____
- We _____ a Tuesday deal first. _____

◆ EXERCISE 2 – READ: RANK BY CERTAINTY

a. Order these from **least** to **most** certain that it will rain.

(a) "It must be going to rain; look at that sky." · (b) "It might rain later." · (c) "It can't rain today; there isn't a cloud." · (d) "It may well rain this afternoon."

Least → most: _____

b. A package has gone missing. Order these from the **weakest** to the **strongest** claim.

(e) "It could conceivably be in the mail room." · (f) "It's bound to turn up by Friday." · (g) "It can't possibly have been delivered; the building was closed." · (h) "It may well have gone to the second floor by mistake." · (i) "It might be in the back of the van."

Weakest → strongest: _____

◆ EXERCISE 3 – WRITE: CHOOSE THE NUANCE

Fill each gap with *may well*, *may as well*, *must* or *can't*.

1. Nobody else has volunteered, so I _____ do it myself.
2. She's been studying medicine for six years; she _____ know a fair bit by now.
3. Given how the market's moving, interest rates _____ rise again.
4. You _____ be hungry; you had an enormous lunch an hour ago.
5. The meeting's been moved to Friday, so we _____ finish the report today.
6. With three new competitors in town, sales _____ drop this quarter.

◆ EXERCISE 4 – READ: NAME THE JOB OF WILL / WOULD

Choose from: *habitual past · past refusal · criticism · politeness · narrative future in the past · present deduction · refusal now · typical behavior*

1. On Sundays my grandfather **would** read us stories by the fire. _____
2. "He blamed the intern." "Of course he did. He **would**." _____
3. I **wouldn't** take that job if I were you. _____
4. The stubborn old lock **wouldn't** turn, no matter how I tried. _____
5. She boarded the ship, never guessing that she **would** see land again only years later.

6. There's someone at the door; that'll be the plumber. _____
7. My printer **won't** connect to the new laptop. _____
8. My manager **will** sit through a two-hour meeting without once checking her phone.

◆ EXERCISE 5 – WRITE: NOW OR PAST? REWRITE WITH A MODAL.

1. I'm sure he was joking. → He _____
2. It's impossible that they knew about the changes. → They _____
3. Perhaps she is waiting outside right now. → She _____
4. I expect they have arrived by now. → They _____
5. It's quite likely that the email went to spam. → The email _____
6. I'm sure she's been working all night; look at her desk. → She _____

◆ READ AND SPEAK – DIALOGUE: THE DARK OFFICE

Sam: The office is dark and Priya's coat's gone. She must have left early.

Alex: She may well have, though she might just be in the server room; the lights are off in there anyway.

Sam: True. But she won't answer her phone when she's deep in something, so we might as well email her.

Alex: Fair. She should reply by morning; she always does. And if she doesn't, well, that would be very her.

Sam: Ha! It would, wouldn't it? She could have been planning this escape all week.

Write: Label each modal with its position on the dial or its job. Which line is a decision rather than a guess?

◆ WORK IN A GROUP – THE EVIDENCE LADDER

Your group receives an invented case file. Clues arrive in three rounds. Place each explanation on the ladder, and say it with the expression of its rung. When a clue changes your mind, move the explanation and say why.

must (have) · is bound to	
should	
may / could well (have)	
might / could (have)	
might just · could conceivably	
can't (possibly) have	

Our verdict (90 seconds):

It can't possibly have been _____, because _____

It may well be that _____

What must have happened is _____

(will / would) _____

Unless something changes, it's bound to _____

So I'd suggest _____ / We might as well _____

◆ SELF-CHECK – CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

"The shops are shut, so we ____ order in." Which fits, meaning there's no better option?

A) may as well

B) may well

C) can't

2

In "Every winter we'd skate on the frozen pond," what job is *would* doing?

A) Conditional (result of a condition)

B) Habitual past (a repeated routine)

C) Politeness / softening

3

"The lights are on and her car's in the driveway. She ____ gone away for the weekend."

A) can't possibly have

B) may well have

C) must have

◆ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ show exactly how certain I am: *may well*, *could conceivably*, *is bound to*, *can't possibly have*
- ◆ ☐ tell *may well* (likely) from *may as well* (no better option)
- ◆ ☐ use *will* / *won't* for deduction, refusal and typical behavior
- ◆ ☐ recognize the jobs of *would*: habit, refusal, criticism, politeness
- ◆ ☐ speculate about now (*must be doing*) and the past (*must have been doing*)
- ◆ ☐ give a calibrated verdict with a softened recommendation

◆ MY NEW WORDS

◆ MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Take one situation you are genuinely unsure about (at work, in the news, or invented). Write it once with

may well and once with *could conceivably*, and note how much credibility each version stakes.

◆ READ AND SAY — NEW WORDS: POLICIES AND RECOMMENDATIONS

a memo a policy a proposal a requirement a rationale to implement
 to comply with to waive (a fee) to pilot with immediate effect in the interim
 on a trial basis

Fixed phrases (formal; use sparingly):

be that as it may (= even so) suffice it to say (= I'll say only this) if need be (= if necessary)
 come what may (= whatever happens) far be it from me to... (= I wouldn't presume to...)

◆ GRAMMAR BOX

The mandative subjunctive: after words of demand, recommendation and importance, use the **base form** of the verb for every person: no -s, no *do*, no *to*.

Verbs	recommend, insist, propose, request, require, demand, urge, suggest, ask	The board demanded that he resign .
Adjectives	It is essential / vital / imperative / crucial / important / advisable that...	It is vital that the report reach them by Friday.
Nouns	recommendation, proposal, requirement, demand, request, insistence	a requirement that each applicant submit references

Negative	not + base form	We ask that he not resign before the vote.
Passive	be + past participle	We propose that the rule be abolished .
be	always be	It's vital that they be ready.

Three registers. *I suggest that she **be** promoted* (most formal; standard in American English) · ...*that she **should be** promoted* (typically British, a little softer) · ...*that she **is** promoted* (informal). **Beware the lookalike:** *The evidence **suggests** that he **is** guilty* (= shows: a fact) · *She **insisted** that she **was** innocent* (= asserted a fact).

Unreal forms

if ... were	If I were you, I'd accept. · If it were possible, we would.
Were + subject (+ to)	Were I in charge, things would change. · Were we to delay, we'd lose the client.

wish ... were	I wish it were simpler.
suppose / supposing	Suppose she were to resign; what then? · Supposing the budget was / were cut?
it's (high) time	It's high time we reviewed this policy. (past simple: it's overdue)
would rather	I'd rather you didn't mention this just yet.

As if / as though: the tense signals how real the comparison is.

+ present	possibly true	He talks as if he knows what he's doing.
+ past / were	contrary to fact (now)	He talks as if he owned the place. · She treats me as though I were a stranger.
+ past perfect	contrary to fact (earlier)	He looked as if he had seen a ghost.

◆ EXERCISE 1 – LISTEN: THE COMMITTEE'S RECOMMENDATIONS

The chair of the Riverside Community Center board presents recommendations on the volunteer program. Write the missing verbs.

1. It is essential that the volunteer handbook _____ before the spring program.
2. We recommend that every new volunteer _____ an orientation session.
3. We propose that volunteers _____ to work more than two shifts a week.
4. It is vital that each team leader _____ a key to the storage room.
5. If the budget _____ larger, we would hire a part-time coordinator.
6. For too long, we have treated training as though it _____ optional.
7. It is high time we _____ this seriously.

◆ EXERCISE 2 – WRITE: PUT THE VERB IN THE MANDATIVE SUBJUNCTIVE

Use the base form. Watch for negatives and passives.

1. The committee recommends that the deadline _____ (extend, passive) by two weeks.
2. It is essential that every member _____ (be) present at the vote.
3. Her lawyer insisted that she _____ (not, answer) any further questions.
4. We propose that the old logo _____ (retain, passive) for continuity.
5. It is imperative that he _____ (have) full access to the records.

6. The auditors have requested that each department _____ (submit) its figures by March 1.

7. Our recommendation is that the policy _____ (review, passive) annually and that staff _____ (not, require, passive) to attend in person.

◆ EXERCISE 3 – WRITE: REGISTER AND MEANING

a. Convert each sentence to the other formal option, keeping the meaning.

1. (subjunctive → *should*) I suggest that she apply for the grant. → I suggest that she _____ for the grant.

2. (*should* → subjunctive) They demanded that the fee should be waived. → They demanded that the fee _____.

3. (subjunctive → *should*) It is vital that everyone arrive on time. → It is vital that everyone _____ on time.

4. (*should* → subjunctive) HR recommends that he should not sign the contract yet. → HR recommends that he _____ the contract yet.

b. Demand or fact? Complete with the correct form of the verb.

5. The figures suggest that the new system _____ (work) well.

6. The manager suggested that the new system _____ (test, passive) for another month.

7. He insisted that he _____ (send) the email on Monday; it must have gone to spam.

8. He insisted that she _____ (send) the email immediately.

◆ EXERCISE 4 – WRITE: UNREAL USES

Complete each sentence. In items 1–4, decide whether the comparison is real or unreal.

1. It looks as if it _____ (be) going to snow; the sky's gray. (the speaker thinks it genuinely might)

2. He orders us around as if he _____ (own) the company. (he doesn't)

3. She greeted me warmly, as if we _____ (be) old friends. (we're not)

4. He sounds as if he _____ (know) the answer; let's ask him. (he probably does)

5. It's high time the company _____ (update) its travel policy.

6. _____ we to lose the contract, we would have to reduce our hours.

7. Supposing the client _____ (reject) the proposal, what would we do?

8. I'd rather you _____ (not, forward) this email to the whole team.

◆ EXERCISE 5 – READ: EDIT THE MEMO. CORRECT ONE ERROR IN EACH LINE.

1. We recommend that each manager sends the report by Friday. → _____
2. It is vital that the kitchen is not be left dirty overnight. → _____
3. They demanded that he to apologize in writing. → _____
4. Was I in charge, I would change the schedule. → _____
5. We ask that visitors don't park in the loading area. → _____
6. He acts as if he owns the place, but he's only been here a week. → _____
7. (a text to a friend) "It is imperative that you bring snacks on Saturday!" The grammar is correct. What's wrong? Rewrite it. → _____

◆ READ AND SPEAK – DIALOGUE: PREPARING THE RECOMMENDATION

Rosa: I've read the survey. People spend fourteen hours a week in meetings. It's high time we did something about it.

Ken: Agreed. What are you going to recommend?

Rosa: First, that every meeting have a written agenda. No agenda, no meeting.

Ken: And that Wednesdays be kept free of meetings?

Rosa: Yes. I'd also propose that managers not invite more than six people unless it's essential.

Ken: Some of them will react as if it were the end of the world.

Rosa: Be that as it may, the numbers are clear. Were we to do nothing, we'd lose another quarter to meetings.

Ken: Suppose the directors refused?

Rosa: Then we'd pilot it in one department first. If need be, I'll present the data myself.

Ken: I'd rather you did. They listen to you.

Write: Find three mandative subjunctives, four other unreal forms, one *as if* and two fixed phrases.

◆ WORK IN A GROUP – POLICY MEMO AND PEER REVIEW

Your group receives an issue brief with an assigned recommendation. Write a memo of **120–160 words**.

To		From	
Date		Re	
Background			
Recommendations	1. It is essential that... 2. We recommend that... 3. Our proposal is that...		

Rationale	Were we to... / Supposing... / If ... were...
Next steps	It is high time... / If need be, ...

Checklist: ☐ three different trigger types (verb · adjective · noun) · ☐ one negative (*that ... not ...*) · ☐ one passive (*that ... be + pp*) · ☐ one unreal form · ☐ no -s, *do* or *to* after a trigger · ☐ a consistent formal tone

Peer review: read another group's memo in three passes (accuracy, range, appropriacy). Write in pencil. Finish with **one strength** (quote it), **one question** and **one suggested change**. The authors decide what to accept.

◆ SELF-CHECK – CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

"The regulations require that each application ____ signed by a supervisor."

A) be

B) is

C) has to be

2

"He strode past us without a word, as if he ____ us at all." The speaker means he did recognize them but pretended not to.

A) doesn't know

B) wouldn't have known

C) didn't know

3

"For security reasons, we ask that staff ___ their passwords with anyone."

A) not share

B) don't share

C) not to share

◆ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ use the base form after triggers: *It is essential that he **be** present.*
- ◆ ☐ form the negative and passive: *that staff **not share** · that it **be reviewed***
- ◆ ☐ choose between the subjunctive, *should* and the indicative for register
- ◆ ☐ use *were*, *Were we to...*, *suppose*, *it's high time* and *would rather*
- ◆ ☐ choose the right tense after *as if / as though*
- ◆ ☐ write and peer-review a short formal recommendation

◆ MY NEW WORDS

◆ MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Write one recommendation for an organization you know (real or invented) with the subjunctive, then write it again for a friend over coffee. Which words changed, and why?

Conditionals, Inversion & Emphasis

Three lessons about choosing where the weight of a sentence falls. First, conditionals that cross time frames, and the precise alternatives to *if* that analysts and negotiators rely on. Then inversion, the grammar of speeches and formal warnings, and the judgment to know when it earns its place. Finally, cleft sentences and fronting: the quiet tools that make a paragraph flow and let you correct a misunderstanding gracefully.

Lessons 2.1-2.3

Classes C4-C6

Level C1

Name: _____

HOW THIS WORKBOOK WORKS

Write · Listen · Say · Work with a partner · Read

Whenever a task touches on your own life, you decide how much to share. Draw on your real experience, **or** take a new identity card, **or** invent freely. All three are equally valid. The companies, speeches and articles in this module are fictional, and in role-plays you speak for your card, not for yourself.

◆ NEW WORDS — THE LANGUAGE OF DECISIONS

in hindsight

a turning point

a hinge factor

to turn down (an offer)

to pay off

to backfire

to fall through

a contingency plan

a buffer

a stipulation

a trade-off

to scale up

a **hinge factor** = the single detail on which an outcome turned · **to backfire** = to produce the opposite of the intended result · a **buffer** = a reserve (of stock, time or money) that absorbs a shock

Setting terms and weighing what-ifs

provided (that) the terms hold...

as long as we agree on...

on condition that...

unless something changes...

supposing that had happened...

in case things go wrong...

otherwise, we'd have to...

even if that's true...

but for one detail...

if it hadn't been for...

Precautions: things you take now, *in case* something happens later.



in case it rains



a charger, in
case the
battery dies



a copy, in case
it's lost



a spare key, in
case you're
locked out

◆ GRAMMAR BOX

Mixed conditionals: the condition and the result sit in **different times**. Diagnose each clause separately.

Past → present	if + past perfect → would / could / might + base verb	If we had accepted the offer, we'd be twice the size now.
Present → past	if + past simple (<i>were</i>) → would / could / might + have + pp	If she weren't so cautious, she would have invested years ago.

✗ *If I had studied finance, I would have been an analyst now.* · ✓ *...I **would be** an analyst now.* (The result is now.)

Three shades of the same event: probability and formality.

If the merger fails...	a real possibility we are planning for
If the merger should fail...	unlikely, but worth considering (tentative)

If the merger were to fail...	a formal, exploratory hypothesis
-------------------------------	----------------------------------

Alternatives to "if": each adds its own twist.

provided / providing (that)	only if this condition is met (often negotiated)	You can borrow it provided that you return it by Monday.
as long as / so long as	on the single condition that; for the whole time that	I'll support the plan as long as costs stay flat.
on condition that	a formal, explicit stipulation	The funds were released on condition that the audit continued.
unless	except if (the one exception)	We'll leave at six unless you object.
supposing / what if	introduces a hypothesis (mostly spoken)	Supposing the client says no, what then?
in case	a precaution taken in advance , not a condition	Take an umbrella in case it rains.
otherwise	if not; or else	Hurry; otherwise we'll miss it.
even if	the result holds regardless	Even if it rains, we'll go.

Isolating the decisive factor (+ a noun, never a clause):

but for + noun	past or present · formal	But for your help, I would have failed.
if it weren't for + noun	unreal now	If it weren't for the traffic, the commute would be pleasant.
if it hadn't been for + noun	unreal past	If it hadn't been for one witness, the case would have collapsed.

◆ EXERCISE 1 – LISTEN TO "THE HINGE," A BUSINESS PODCAST. COMPLETE THE ANALYSIS.

Your teacher reads an extract about Brightwell Bikes, a small e-bike maker. Write the missing words.

1. If Brightwell _____ the Swift Deliveries contract in 2022, it _____ twice its current size today.
2. If its founder _____ so cautious by nature, she _____ the offer on the spot.
3. _____ a loyal base of local customers, the company would have closed in 2023.
4. It can still grow, _____ it finds a second factory.
5. It now keeps a buffer of batteries _____ a supplier lets it down.

6. If the market _____ recover next year, Brightwell would be well placed.

7. _____ it moves quickly, a rival will take the new city contract.

In one sentence: what was the hinge factor in Brightwell's story?

◆ EXERCISE 2 – DIAGNOSE THE TIME. COMPLETE THE MIXED CONDITIONALS.

Decide when the condition is and when the result is. Write **P→Pr** (past → present) or **Pr→P** (present → past) at the end.

1. If we (not / sign) _____ that lease in 2021, we (not / pay) _____ twice the market rent now. _____

2. If Omar (be) _____ a more patient person, he (not / resign) _____ in the middle of the project. _____

3. If the team (test) _____ the app properly, customers (still / trust) _____ us today. _____

4. If I (speak) _____ Portuguese, the meeting in São Paulo last week (go) _____ much better. _____

5. If the board (listen) _____ to its analysts, the company (might / be) _____ in profit by now. _____

6. If she (not / be) _____ so good with numbers, they (never / offer) _____ her the finance role. _____

◆ EXERCISE 3 – CHOOSE THE EXACT ALTERNATIVE TO "IF"

Use each once: *provided that* · *as long as* · *on condition that* · *unless* · *supposing* · *in case* · *otherwise* · *even if*

1. The bank approved the loan _____ the company submitted quarterly reports.

2. We'll keep a month's cash in reserve _____ sales drop over the summer.

3. _____ the supplier doubled its prices overnight: what would we do?

4. _____ we win the contract, we won't be able to hire anyone until spring.

5. You're welcome to work from home on Fridays _____ your targets are met.

6. The launch will go ahead in May _____ the final tests reveal a serious fault.

7. We need a decision by Friday; _____, the offer expires.

8. I'm happy to lead the project _____ I have a say in who joins the team.

◆ EXERCISE 4 – ISOLATE THE DECISIVE FACTOR

Rewrite with *but for*, *if it weren't for* or *if it hadn't been for*. Mind the time frame.

1. If the engineers hadn't acted so quickly, the data would have been lost.

→ _____

2. The office would be perfect. The only problem is the noise from the street.

→ _____

3. If a single investor hadn't believed in us, we would never have launched.

→ _____

4. Our volunteers keep the festival running. Without them, it would stop.

→ _____

5. If there hadn't been a chance meeting at a trade fair, the partnership would never have happened.

→ _____

◆ EXERCISE 5 – RIGHT OR WRONG? TICK THE CORRECT SENTENCES AND FIX THE OTHERS.

1. If I had studied finance, I would have been an analyst now. _____

2. I'd be amazed unless she got the promotion. _____

3. Take a photocopy of your passport in case it gets lost. _____

4. If the price would fall, we would buy more stock. _____

5. But for you helped me, I would have missed the deadline. _____

6. Call me in case you need anything, and I'll come straight over. _____

7. Should the client call while I'm out, please take a message. _____

◆ DIALOGUE – TWO CO-FOUNDERS LOOK BACK, AND AHEAD

Priya: If we hadn't opened five cafés in one year, we'd still have money in the bank.

Dan: True. But if we weren't such an impatient pair, we'd never have gotten the first one off the ground.

Priya: Fair point. So, the next twelve months?

Dan: We keep the seven profitable sites, provided that the landlords renew on the same terms.

Priya: And supposing they don't?

Dan: Then we relocate the two weakest, as long as we can find sites nearby. And we hold three months' rent in reserve in case a renewal falls through.

Priya: Honestly, but for Maria's weekend markets, Elm Street would have closed last spring.

Dan: Exactly. Even if the numbers improve, let's not expand again unless we've tested a site with a pop-up first.

Priya: Agreed, on condition that I design the pop-up menu.

Dan: Deal. And if the board should ask, the strategy is "slow and steady."

Find two mixed conditionals (which direction is each?), one *but for*, and at least five alternatives to *if*. Which sentence describes a precaution rather than a condition?

◆ SPEAKING – THE CASE STUDY PANEL

In class: your group becomes a team of consultants. You receive a case file on an invented company: one of you holds **the story**, another **the numbers and hinge factors**. Share what you know (don't show the cards), then present a three-minute analysis to "the board," another group, who will question you.

Company	_____
What happened	
The hinge factor(s)	
Past → present	If they had..., they would... now.
Present → past	If they weren't..., they would have...
The decisive factor	But for... / If it hadn't been for...
Our recommendation + terms	provided that... · as long as... · unless... · in case...
A look ahead	If the market were to... / If a competitor should...

☐ past → present · ☐ present → past · ☐ *but for* / *if it weren't (hadn't been) for* · ☐ *even if* + two other alternatives · ☐ *in case* used for a genuine precaution · ☐ *were to* or *should*

As the board: ask at least two questions that begin *Supposing...* or *What if...*

◆ SELF-CHECK – CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

"If I ___ that email yesterday, I wouldn't be in this mess now." Which completes this mixed conditional?

A) didn't send

B) wouldn't have sent

C) hadn't sent

2

"I'll take my charger ____ the battery dies on the train." Which best fits a precaution taken in advance?

A) if

B) in case

C) unless

3

"We'll sign the contract ____ the delivery date stays in March. That's our only condition."

A) provided that

B) in case

C) even if

◆ ☒ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ build mixed conditionals in both directions by diagnosing the time of each clause
- ◆ ☐ shade a hypothesis with *should* or *were to*
- ◆ ☐ choose the precise alternative to *if*, and keep *in case* for precautions
- ◆ ☐ isolate a decisive factor with *but for* / *if it weren't* (*hadn't been*) *for*
- ◆ ☐ present and defend a short analysis of a business decision

◆ MY NEW WORDS

◆ MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Write one mixed conditional about a decision (yours, a new identity card's, or a company's you know), then rewrite it with *but for* or *if it weren't for*.

◆ NEW WORDS — SPEECHES AND RHETORIC

a keynote a tribute a toast an acceptance speech a call to action a set piece
to land (a line) emphatic understated pompous a flourish poise

pompous = trying too hard to sound important · **to land a line** = to deliver it so that it has its full effect · **a set piece** = a carefully prepared passage, delivered for effect

Triggers worth knowing by heart

Never before have I... Not only... but also... No sooner had... than... Little did I know...
Only then did I realize... Not until... did... Under no circumstances should you...
At no time was... Nor do I...

◆ GRAMMAR BOX

The mechanism: front a negative or restrictive adverbial → switch to question word order (**auxiliary + subject**) → no auxiliary? Borrow **do / does / did**, and the main verb goes bare.

With an auxiliary	I had never seen... → Never had I seen...
Without one	I never imagined... → Never did I imagine... (not imagined)

Never (before) · Rarely · Seldom	Seldom does one encounter a mind so original.
Little	Little did he know what awaited him.
Not only... but (also)	Not only did she resign , but she also exposed the fraud.
Not until...	Not until midnight did the truth emerge.
No sooner... than · Hardly / Scarcely... when	No sooner had we sat down than the alarm rang.
Only then / after / by / when / if	Only by working together will we succeed.
On no account · Under no circumstances · At no time · In no way	At no time was the public at risk.
Nor / Neither	She didn't apologize, nor did she explain.

Conditional inversion: drop *if*. Only three auxiliaries: **had, were, should**. Negatives stay uncontracted.

If I had known...	Had I known...
If she were to accept...	Were she to accept...
If you should require...	Should you require...
If it had not been for...	Had it not been for... (never Hadn't it been for)

So / such: **So great was** the demand that the servers crashed. · **Such was** his anger that no one dared speak.

Place and direction (literary; full-noun subjects only): *In the doorway stood a stranger.* · *Here comes the bus.* but *Here it comes* (not ~~Here comes it~~).

No inversion when the negative is not fronted (*I have never seen it*) or when *only* belongs to the subject (*Only Sarah knew the answer*).

◆ EXERCISE 1 – LISTEN TO AN ACCEPTANCE SPEECH. COMPLETE THE INVERSIONS.

Your teacher reads an extract from the speech given by the Harborview Volunteer of the Year. Write the missing words (usually an auxiliary + subject, sometimes more).

1. Never in my life _____ so completely lost for words.
2. Little _____, ten years ago, that one Saturday morning would change everything.
3. Not only _____ the pantry open through the storm, but you also delivered meals to every door on Pier Street.
4. So generous _____ that we had to borrow a second truck.
5. _____ for Rosa's spreadsheets, we would have lost track of half the donations.
6. Only by standing together _____ able to keep the doors open next winter.

Which line would you cut if the speech had to be shorter? Why?

◆ EXERCISE 2 – FRONT THE ADVERBIAL AND INVERT

Begin with the words given. Add *do / does / did* where there is no other auxiliary.

1. I have seldom read such a persuasive report. → Seldom _____
2. The public was not in danger at any time. → At no time _____
3. We understood the scale of the problem only when the audit was complete. → Only when _____
4. She not only met the deadline, but she also came in under budget. → Not only _____
5. The meeting had hardly begun when the power went out. → Hardly _____

6. You should not leave the lab unlocked under any circumstances. → Under no circumstances _____

7. The truth didn't emerge until the following morning. → Not until _____

◆ EXERCISE 3 – DROP "IF": REWRITE WITH HAD, WERE OR SHOULD

1. If we had known about the delay, we would have rebooked. → _____

2. If you should require further information, please contact our office. → _____

3. If the factory were to close, the town would lose its largest employer. → _____

4. If it had not been for the volunteers, the event would have been canceled. → _____

5. If I were in your position, I would accept the offer. → _____

6. If you do not receive a confirmation within 48 hours, please call us. → _____

◆ EXERCISE 4 – FAULTY OR FINE? CORRECT THE ERRORS. TICK THE SENTENCES THAT ARE ALREADY CORRECT.

1. Never I have seen such a turnout. _____

2. Rarely does the director admits a mistake. _____

3. Hadn't we left early, we would have missed the train. _____

4. Only Sarah knew the password. _____

5. Not until the end of the meeting she mentioned the budget. _____

6. Look, here comes it! _____

7. So impressive the results were that the board approved the plan. _____

◆ EXERCISE 5 – WEIGHT OR POMP? JUDGE THE REGISTER.

Write ✓ (the inversion earns its place) or ✗ (it sounds pompous or odd here). For each ✗, write a plainer version.

1. A text message to a friend: "Never have I eaten such an enormous burrito." _____

2. A retirement tribute: "Rarely does a colleague touch so many lives." _____

3. A sign in a laboratory: "Under no circumstances should food be brought into this area." _____

4. A quick email to a coworker: "Should you wish to join us for lunch, we shall be at the café at noon." _____

5. A book review: "Not only is the plot gripping, but the characters stay with you for weeks." _____

6. A company update: "Never have we grown so fast. Seldom have we hired so many. Not only did profits rise, but so did morale. Only now do we see the result." _____

◆ DIALOGUE — THE SPEECHWRITER'S EDIT

Manager: Here's my opening for Grace's retirement party: "I have never worked with anyone like Grace."

Writer: It's sincere, but it's your first line, so give it some weight: "Never have I worked with anyone quite like Grace."

Manager: Better. And the part about the flood in the archive? "We didn't realize how much she had saved until the water went down."

Writer: "Only when the water went down did we realize how much she had saved." Pause after "down."

Manager: Could I add "So calm was she that nobody panicked"?

Writer: You could, but that would be three inversions in a row. Keep two, and let the rest of the speech breathe.

Manager: So: weight where it counts, plain prose everywhere else.

Writer: Exactly. Then close warmly: "Should you ever need a book found, you know exactly who to call."

Underline each inversion and name its trigger. Which inversion did the writer advise against, and why?

◆ SPEAKING — THE SPEECHWRITER

In class: your pair receives a speechwriter's brief: an occasion and a plain, flat draft. Rewrite it for the occasion, then one of you delivers your strongest paragraph from "the podium."

Occasion	_____
Flat line	Our rewrite

☐ three different triggers · ☐ one conditional inversion (*Had / Were / Should*) · ☐ one *so / such* inversion · ☐ **no more than five** inversions in total · ☐ the editor cut one inversion that was doing no work

From the audience: hold up your card after each paragraph: **WEIGHT** (it landed) or **POMP** (too much). Be ready to say which line landed best.

◆ SELF-CHECK — CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

Which is the correct inversion of "She rarely admits a mistake"?

A) Rarely does she admit a mistake.

B) Rarely she admits a mistake.

C) Rarely does she admits a mistake.

2

Which correctly rewrites "If I had known, I would have called" with conditional inversion?

A) Had I known, I would have called.

B) Would I have known, I would have called.

C) Did I know, I would have called.

3

Which sentence is correct?

A) Not only she apologized, but also she offered a refund.

B) Not only did she apologize, but she also offered a refund.

C) Not only did she apologized, but she also offered a refund.

◆ ☒ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ invert after a fronted negative or restrictive adverbial, borrowing *do / does / did* when needed
- ◆ ☐ drop *if* with *Had / Were / Should*, keeping negatives uncontracted
- ◆ ☐ use *So... was / Such was...* and recognize place inversion
- ◆ ☐ judge when inversion adds weight and when it merely sounds pompous
- ◆ ☐ rewrite a plain draft for a formal occasion and deliver it with poise

◆ MY NEW WORDS

◆ MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Invert one sentence you have written recently. Then give your honest verdict: is it stronger, or just louder?

◆ NEW WORDS — INFORMATION AND FLOW

given information new information the focus end-weight cohesion to flow
 choppy to spotlight a misconception to set the record straight a spokesperson
 to clarify

given = what the listener already knows or has just heard · **end-weight** = the tendency to put long, heavy elements at the end of a sentence · **to set the record straight** = to correct a false account of events, calmly and publicly

Focus and cohesion frames

It was... that / who... It wasn't until... that... What really matters is...
 What happened was (that)... All I'm saying is... The reason... is that... The thing that... is...
 Even more... is... It's a pity (that)...

◆ GRAMMAR BOX

It-cleft	It + be + focus + that / who...	It was her attitude that impressed me. (spotlight up front; often "...not something else")
Corrective it-cleft	It was X, not Y, that...	It was the timing , not the price, that worried us.
Time frame	It wasn't until... that...	It wasn't until later that I realized.
What-cleft	What + clause + be + focus	What impressed me was her attitude . (focus saved for the end)
Other frames	All / The thing / The reason / The place / The way / The one who... + be	All I want is a quiet evening. · The reason I left is that I was bored.
Fronting	move a (usually given) element to the front; no inversion	We tried three strategies. The first we dismissed at once.
Extraposition	light <i>it</i> first, heavy clause last	That you missed it is a pity. → It's a pity (that) you missed it.

Two principles behind all of these: ① **given before new:** start from what the listener knows and end on what is newsworthy. ② **light before heavy** (end-weight): long clauses belong at the end.

Agreement: What I need **is** a break. · What I need **are** some answers. · What surprised us **was** the silence (past). · Formal: *The reason is **that**...*, not *The reason is because...*

Fronting ≠ inversion. *That book, I have never read.* ✓ · *That book have I never read.* ✗ (Inversion needs a negative or restrictive trigger.)

◆ EXERCISE 1 – LISTEN TO A RADIO INTERVIEW. COMPLETE THE CLEFT SENTENCES.

Nadia Brooks, owner of The Copper Kettle café, sets the record straight about her "no laptops at lunch" rule. Write the missing words.

1. It _____ the laptops themselves _____ were the problem.
2. _____ was that forty people were sharing six tables between noon and two.
3. It _____ we counted the customers walking out that we understood the scale of it.
4. _____ did was ask people to close their laptops for two hours a day.
5. The reason we tried it _____ our lunch customers were leaving.
6. The morning regulars, _____ at all. They still work here every day.

What was the misconception, and what actually happened? Summarize in two sentences.

◆ EXERCISE 2 – REWRITE FOR FOCUS

Use the frame in brackets.

1. (it-cleft) The new manager changed the schedule. → _____
2. (it-cleft, corrective) We canceled the event because of the weather, not the budget. → _____
3. (what-cleft) I need more time. → _____
4. (what-cleft, explanation) The server simply overheated. → What happened _____
5. (all-cleft) I only want a straight answer. → _____
6. (the reason) I'm calling because the invoice is wrong. → _____
7. (it-cleft, time) We only noticed the error on Monday. → It wasn't _____

◆ EXERCISE 3 – FRONT THE LINKING ELEMENT

Rewrite the second sentence so that it begins with the element that ties back to the first. Let the new information fall at the end.

1. The committee reviewed four proposals. It accepted the second one immediately.
→ The committee reviewed four proposals. _____

2. We tried two suppliers last year. We will never use the first one again.

→ We tried two suppliers last year. _____

3. The report lists several risks. The cost of further delay is even more serious.

→ The report lists several risks. Even more _____

4. The survey asked about pay, hours and training. Training was the most popular request of the three.

→ The survey asked about pay, hours and training. Of the three, _____

◆ EXERCISE 4 – MOVE THE WEIGHT TO THE END

Each sentence is top-heavy. Rewrite it with anticipatory *it*.

1. That the project was late surprised nobody. → _____

2. Whether the client will renew is still unclear. → _____

3. To finish the whole report by Friday is impossible. → _____

4. That she was offered the job is no surprise. → _____

◆ EXERCISE 5 – WHICH CONTINUATION FLOWS BETTER?

Circle (a) or (b). Be ready to explain your choice with *given* → *new* or *end-weight*.

1. "Everyone assumed the new prices put customers off." (a) "Actually, it was the parking that put them off." (b) "Actually, the parking was a thing that put them off."

2. "The board discussed two options." (a) "That they rejected the first one at once is what happened." (b) "The first, they rejected at once."

3. "You asked why we changed suppliers." (a) "That the old one kept missing deadlines is the reason." (b) "The reason is that the old one kept missing deadlines."

4. "We have enough staff, and we have enough money." (a) "What we don't have is time." (b) "Time is what we have not got, though."

◆ DIALOGUE – SETTING THE RECORD STRAIGHT

Reporter: So the library closed the Saturday tool-lending service because it was losing money?

Spokesperson: Actually, it wasn't the money that closed it. It was space: we needed the room for the new study center.

Reporter: But people say the tools were never returned.

Spokesperson: That's a common misconception. What the figures show is a return rate of ninety-six percent.

Reporter: Then why the sudden decision?

Spokesperson: It wasn't sudden. It was in March that we first consulted members. The reason it felt sudden is that the notice went up late. That part, I fully accept.

Reporter: So what happens to the tools?

Spokesperson: All we're doing is moving them. The service reopens at the community center in June.

Find three it-clefts, two *what* / *all*-clefts, one *the reason*-frame and one example of fronting. Which cleft is corrective?

◆ SPEAKING – THE EDITING DESK & SETTING THE RECORD STRAIGHT

The Editing Desk: your group edits a choppy article so that it flows. Use at least one it-cleft, one *what*-cleft (or another frame), and two instances of fronting or extraposition, but **no more than three clefts** in total. Here is article A:

ARTICLE A • THE FOUR-DAY WEEK AT TALLIS PRINT WORKS

Tallis Print Works is a small printing company in Riverside. It has 40 employees. It moved to a four-day week last year. Many people expected productivity to fall. Productivity did not fall. It rose by eight percent. Better scheduling caused the rise. The shorter week did not cause it on its own. The staff now plan every job on Monday morning. Sick days have also fallen. Nobody predicted that. The owner, Ruth Tallis, says the change was a risk. She is glad she took it.

Setting the Record Straight: Partner A reads a misconception from a card. Partner B, the spokesperson, corrects it politely with an it-cleft and a *what*-cleft, then adds one fact. Switch roles.

☐ It wasn't X that..., it was Y. · ☐ What actually happened was... · ☐ The reason... is that... · ☐ All we did was... · ☐ I stressed the focus word

1

Rewrite "I admire her honesty most of all" as a cleft that delivers the focus at the end. Which is the natural *what-cleft*?

A) It is her honesty that I admire most of all.

B) What I admire most of all is her honesty.

C) Her honesty, I admire most of all.

2

Context: "We reviewed three designs." Which continuation best respects cohesion and end-weight?

A) That we rejected the last one outright is what happened.

B) We rejected the last one outright.

C) The last, we rejected outright.

3

Which is the best version for a formal report?

A) The reason sales fell is because the store moved.

B) The reason sales fell is that the store moved.

C) The reason sales fell, it is that the store moved.

◆ ☒ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ spotlight or correct one element with an *it-cleft*
- ◆ ☐ save the focus for the end with a *what-cleft* or another frame (*All / The reason / The thing*)
- ◆ ☐ front a given element to link one sentence to the last
- ◆ ☐ apply given-before-new and end-weight, including extraposition with *it*
- ◆ ☐ edit a choppy text so it flows, and set the record straight politely in speech

◆ MY NEW WORDS

◆ MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Take two sentences from a message you wrote this week. Rewrite them with one cleft or one fronted

element, and say why the new version flows better (or why it doesn't).

Cohesion, Register & Style

Three lessons about how you package what you mean. Turn actions into nouns for a compact, impersonal academic style, and turn them back into verbs when your reader needs plain English. Stitch sentences together without repeating yourself. And soften your language on purpose: to keep a claim defensible, to deliver a hard message kindly, or simply to sound relaxed.

Lessons 3.1–3.3

Classes C7–C9

Level C1

Name: _____

HOW THIS MODULE WORKS

Each exercise heading tells you what to do: **Write**, **Listen**, **Say**, **Read** or **With a partner**. Most tasks in this module have more than one good answer; what matters is that your choice fits the reader and keeps the meaning.

When a task draws on your own experience, you decide what to share. Use your real life, **or** a new identity card, **or** something you invent. All three are equally good. In role-plays you play the card, not yourself, and you can always say "Pass."

◆ READ AND SAY — NEW WORDS AND CHUNKS

nominalization register agent impersonal abstract concise a noun phrase
 plain English appropriacy to rebalance

Light verb + noun collocations (the meaning lives in the noun):

carry out an investigation into make an assessment of reach a conclusion
 provide an explanation for pose a threat to bring about a change in have an impact on
 place emphasis on lead to a reduction in give rise to

agent = the person or thing that does the action · **register** = the level of formality and style that fits a situation · **appropriacy** = choosing language that suits the reader, the purpose and the setting

◆ GRAMMAR BOX

Same fact, two packages.

Verbal (spoken, agent visible)	They decided to expand, which reduced their costs.
Nominal (written, agent hidden)	The decision to expand led to a reduction in costs.

Forming the noun. Check the real noun: many are irregular.

-tion / -sion	decide → decision · expand → expansion · introduce → introduction
-ment · -ance / -ence	assess → assessment · perform → performance · depend → dependence
-ity · -ness	stable → stability · complex → complexity · aware → awareness
-al · -ure · -th	approve → approval · fail → failure · grow → growth · strong → strength
no suffix	increase → an increase · change → a change · rise → a rise · use → a use
irregular	believe → belief · choose → choice · analyze → analysis

The **nominal style** travels with the passive, *there is / there are*, and long noun phrases. Watch the preposition after the noun: an increase **in** · an impact **on** · an investigation **into** · a threat **to** · a response **to**.

Don't overdo it. ❌ *The implementation of the utilization of renewable resources is a requirement for the achievement of a reduction in emissions.* ✅ *To reduce emissions, we must use renewable resources.* If you can't tell **who does what**, turn a noun back into a verb.

◆ LISTEN – EXERCISE 1: THE UPDATE AND THE SUMMARY

Your teacher reads a spoken team update about a trial of electric delivery vans, then the written summary of the same meeting. Complete the nouns in the summary.

The (1) _____ of two electric vans in March was followed by a three-month (2) _____ of their performance. Despite an initial (3) _____ in costs for chargers and the (4) _____ of one charger in May, the trial resulted in a significant (5) _____ in fuel costs. Following the board's (6) _____ last week, the (7) _____ of a ten-van rollout is planned by the end of the year.

With a partner: which verb in the spoken update became each noun?

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 2: FORM THE NOUN

Write the noun. Mind the irregulars and the stress.

1. develop _____
2. aware _____
3. arrive _____
4. able _____
5. fail _____
6. analyze _____
7. strong _____
8. increase _____
9. believe _____
10. refuse _____
11. complex _____
12. depend _____
13. choose _____
14. grow _____

Now underline the stressed syllable in 4, 8 and 11. Did it move?

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 3: LIGHT VERBS AND PREPOSITIONS

Complete each sentence with a light verb in the correct form and the right preposition where needed.

1. The auditors _____ a thorough investigation _____ the missing payments.
2. After two weeks of discussion, the committee finally _____ a decision.
3. Poor lighting on the path _____ a serious threat _____ cyclists.
4. The new timetable has _____ a positive impact _____ attendance.
5. The report _____ particular emphasis _____ staff training.
6. No one has yet _____ a convincing explanation _____ the delay.
7. The survey showed a sharp increase _____ demand for evening classes.
8. It is too early to _____ any firm conclusions.

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 4: FROM VERBAL TO ACADEMIC

Rewrite each sentence in a compact, impersonal, noun-based style. Use a light verb or the passive where it helps.

1. We investigated why the system failed.

→ _____

2. The company expanded quickly, and this reduced its unit costs.

→ _____

3. They didn't explain why the results were different.

→ _____

4. Because the population is aging, healthcare costs are rising.

→ _____

5. If we cut the training budget, staff will feel less motivated.

→ _____

6. People are becoming more aware of how much sugar is in drinks, so they're buying fewer of them.

→ _____

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 5: BACK TO PLAIN ENGLISH

Each sentence is over-nominalized. Rewrite it clearly with working verbs. Keep it serious and polite; think about the real reader.

1. The facilitation of the improvement of communication is an objective of the reorganization.

→ _____

2. There was a consideration by the committee of the possibility of the postponement of the vote.

→ _____

3. The utilization of the software resulted in an enhancement of the accuracy of the measurements.

→ _____

4. (A letter to tenants) The completion of the elevator repairs is subject to the arrival of replacement parts.

→ _____

5. (A note to parents) Confirmation of your child's attendance is required prior to the commencement of the program.

→ _____

◆ READ AND SAY – DIALOGUE: TWO READERS, ONE FACT

Nadia: Can you look at my summary for the quarterly report? I'm not sure it sounds formal enough.

Tom: Sure. "We tried longer opening hours, and more people came in." It's clear, but it reads like a chat.

Nadia: So how would you package it?

Tom: Something like "The introduction of extended opening hours led to a rise in visitor numbers."

Nadia: Nice. And the part about the cost? "The extension of hours resulted in the necessity of the recruitment of additional staff."

Tom: Hmm. Now I've lost track of who's doing what. Try "The longer hours meant we had to hire two more staff."

Nadia: In a report? Isn't that too plain?

Tom: Then meet in the middle: "The extended hours required the recruitment of two additional staff." One noun doing real work, one clear verb.

Nadia: Got it. And for the poster in the lobby?

Tom: "We're now open until 9 p.m.!" Nobody wants a nominalization on a poster.

Underline every nominalization. Which sentence was over-nominalized, and how did Tom fix it? Which version belongs in which "room"?

◆ WITH A PARTNER – REGISTER WORKSHOP

Round 1: Verbal → Academic. Your group gets a chatty spoken update. Write a 4–5 sentence formal summary for a report.

☐ 4+ nominalizations · ☐ 2 light-verb collocations · ☐ 1 passive · ☐ 1 *there is / there are* · ☐ no *I / we / they* · ☐ facts unchanged

Round 2: Academic → Plain. Your group gets an over-nominalized notice. Rewrite it for its real reader: short sentences, active verbs, *you / we*, still polite.

Round 3: Peer review. Swap with another group. For each sentence ask: **Who does what?** Can you tell in three seconds?

One strength (quote it)	
One suggestion (quote it)	

◆ SAY – SELF-CHECK: CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

Which is the correct noun formed from the adjective *able*?

A) ability

B) ableness

C) ablement

2

A colleague sends a friendly email: "The facilitation of the enhancement of team communication is the objective of the reorganization." What's the best advice?

A) Add more nominalizations to sound even more professional.

B) It's over-nominalized: rebalance it with plain verbs for clarity and register.

C) Leave it. It's grammatically correct, so it's fine.

3

Which sentence is correct and suits a formal report?

A) The survey showed a sharp increase of demand for evening classes.

B) The survey showed that demand for evening classes kind of went up a lot.

C) The survey showed a sharp increase in demand for evening classes.

◆ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ form nouns from verbs and adjectives, including irregulars (*belief, growth, analysis*)
- ◆ ☐ use light-verb collocations with the right preposition (*carry out an investigation into*)

- ◆ ☐ rewrite a chatty sentence in a compact, impersonal, academic style
- ◆ ☐ spot over-nominalization and rewrite it in plain English
- ◆ ☐ choose the right packaging for the reader, and explain why

◆ MY NEW WORDS

◆ MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Write one sentence about your week (real or invented) in plain verbal English, then rewrite it in nominal academic style.

◆ READ AND SAY — NEW WORDS AND CHUNKS

cohesion

reference

substitution

ellipsis

an antecedent

ambiguous

a summary noun

recoverable

repetitive

stilted

this trend / these findings

such a move

the former ... the latter

for the above reasons

as follows

the red one / the old ones

if you fail to do so

I think so / I hope not

I'm afraid so

I'd love to

antecedent = the word or idea a pronoun refers back to · **ambiguous** = could mean two different things ·
stilted = stiff and unnatural

◆ GRAMMAR BOX

When you are about to repeat something, ask three questions: **Can I point to it? Swap it? Drop it?**

Point to it (reference)	it · they · this / that + noun · such (a) + noun · the former / the latter · the above · as follows	House prices rose sharply. This increase surprised economists.
Swap it (substitution)	one / ones for count nouns · do / do so / do it for verb phrases · so / not for clauses	I'll take the red one . · Those who fail to do so ... · I hope not .
Drop it (ellipsis)	after <i>and / but / or</i> , auxiliaries, <i>to</i> , comparatives: keep the anchor	I haven't finished, but Sam has . · I'd love to .

so / not	I think so · I don't think so · I believe so · I expect so · I hope so · I hope not · I'm afraid so · I'm afraid not ❌ I don't hope so
one / ones	count nouns only: the small one · the new ones ❌ a coffee one → some
do so vs do it	do so = formal, a general or stated action · do it / do that = concrete, spoken

Keep it unambiguous. ❌ *Sales fell and the manager resigned. It was unexpected.* ✅ *The resignation was unexpected.* Add a summary noun after *this / that* whenever it points at a whole idea.

Register. *the former / the latter, such, the above, as follows, do so* → writing. *one, do it, I think so* and ellipsis → everywhere, especially speech.

◆ LISTEN — EXERCISE 1: THE HANDOVER CALL

Sam is going on vacation and hands his work over to Priya on the phone. What does each **bold** word refer to? Write it.

1. "Yes, I've got **it** here." → _____
2. "Not yet, but I'll **do it** first thing tomorrow." → _____
3. "The new **ones** arrive on Thursday." → _____
4. "I already **have**." → _____
5. "I think **so**." → _____
6. "I hope **not**." → _____
7. "**The former** is urgent..." → _____
8. "...**the latter** can wait." → _____

What does Priya still have to do? _____

◆ WRITE — EXERCISE 2: REPLACE THE REPETITION

Replace the repeated words with the device in brackets.

1. "Do you want the big suitcase or the small suitcase?" (one) → _____
2. "You should apologize. If you don't apologize, she'll never forgive you." (do so) → _____
3. "Is the deal going ahead?" — "I believe the deal is going ahead." (so) → _____
4. "He was rude to a customer in public. That kind of behavior is unacceptable." (such) → _____
5. "We considered Chicago and Denver; we chose Denver." (the former / the latter) → _____
6. "Will the printer be fixed by Monday?" — "I'm afraid the printer won't be fixed by Monday." (not) → _____
7. "Energy prices doubled last winter. The doubling of prices hit small businesses hardest." (this + summary noun) → _____

◆ WRITE — EXERCISE 3: DROP IT (ELLIPSIS)

Rewrite each sentence without the words the reader can recover. Keep the anchor word.

1. She wanted to come, but she couldn't come. → _____
2. I haven't seen the movie, but my brother has seen the movie. → _____
3. "Would you like to join us?" — "I'd love to join you." → _____
4. He was tired but he was happy. → _____

5. The trip cost far more than we had expected it to cost. → _____

6. The first group finished early; the second group did not finish early. → _____

◆ READ AND WRITE – EXERCISE 4: FIX THE FAULTY REFERENCE

Each sentence has an ambiguous, missing or wrong cohesive device. Correct it.

1. The teacher praised the student's essay, and it made her proud. → _____

2. There's still some milk if you want a milk one. → _____

3. "Are you coming?" – "I don't hope so." → _____

4. He resigned suddenly, which everyone found strange. This was in March. → _____

5. "Is it going to rain?" – "I think yes." → _____

6. "Can you help me move on Saturday?" – "I'd love, but I'm working." → _____

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 5: A SHORT REPAIR

Rewrite this note so it is much shorter and reads naturally. Use at least one reference device, one substitution and one ellipsis.

The office is moving to the third floor on Friday. The move to the third floor means that everyone needs to pack their desks. Please pack your desk by Thursday. If you can't pack your desk by Thursday, tell Maria. Maria has boxes. Maria has large boxes and small boxes. The large boxes are for files and the small boxes are for personal items. The IT team will move the computers. The IT team said the IT team will move the computers on Saturday.

◆ READ AND SAY – DIALOGUE: TWO REPORTS

Anna: Did you finish the two reports?

Ben: The short one, yes; the long one, not yet.

Anna: Will it be ready by Friday?

Ben: I think so. I meant to start it yesterday, but I didn't get to.

Anna: Can you send me the figures?

Ben: I'll do so this afternoon. Well, I'll try to. Such requests always take longer than they look.

Anna: Fair enough. The client asked for a summary too.

Ben: Did they? Then I'll write one tonight, if you can check it tomorrow.

Anna: I can. I'm afraid it'll have to be after ten, though.

Find two examples each of reference, substitution and ellipsis. Which device sounds a little formal for a chat between colleagues?

◆ WITH A PARTNER – REPAIR THE REPORT + THE TWO-MINUTE TALK

Repair. Your group gets a repetitive report of about 140 words. Cut it to **90 words or fewer** and keep every fact.

☐ 2+ reference (one *this / these* + summary noun) · ☐ 2+ substitution · ☐ 2+ ellipsis · ☐ no ambiguous *it / this* · ☐ written-report register · Words: _____

Peer review: "Point at it." Draw an arrow from every *it / they / this / one / the latter / do so* to what it refers to. If an arrow could land in two places, write "?".

The two-minute talk. Speak for two minutes on your topic card. Your tally-keeper counts:

Repeats (could have been replaced)	
Devices (it, this, one, so, I did, the latter...)	
One strength · one suggestion	

◆ SAY – SELF-CHECK: CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

"Tenants must vacate by June. Those who fail to ____ will face penalties." Which fits a formal notice best?

A) do it

B) make so

C) do so

2

Which sentence uses ellipsis correctly and naturally?

A) "I haven't read the memo, but Sara has."

B) "Would you like to stay?" — "I'd love."

C) "She can swim, and she can also swim well."

3

"Will the shipment be delayed again?" You don't want a delay. What do you say?

A) I don't hope so.

B) I hope not.

C) I hope no.

◆ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ refer back clearly, using *this* / *these* + a summary noun for a whole idea
- ◆ ☐ use *one* / *ones*, *do so* / *do it* and *so* / *not* correctly
- ◆ ☐ leave out repeated words and keep the anchor (*I'd love to.* · *but Sam has.*)
- ◆ ☐ choose devices that fit writing or speech
- ◆ ☐ repair a repetitive text and talk for two minutes without needless repetition

◆ MY NEW WORDS

◆ MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Find a sentence you wrote recently (or invent one) that repeats itself. Write the repaired version and name the device you used.

◆ READ AND SAY — NEW WORDS AND CHUNKS

to hedge

defensible

to save face

tactful

blunt

understatement

a minimizer

to soften

rapport

to decline (a request)

Academic hedging:

The evidence suggests that...

This may indicate that...

It could be argued that...

There is some evidence that...

...appears to...

...tends to...

arguably

to some extent

Diplomatic English:

I was wondering if...

Would it be possible to...?

I'm not entirely convinced.

I take your point, but...

I see it slightly differently.

It might be worth...

I'm afraid...

The thing is...

As much as I'd like to...

Perhaps we could... instead.

Vague language (casual speech only): *eightish · twenty or so · sort of / kind of · a couple of · and that sort of thing · roughly*

◆ GRAMMAR BOX

Three reasons to soften, three toolkits.

H · Academic hedging	protects your claim · formal, written	The data suggest that the program may improve outcomes to some extent .
D · Diplomatic softening	protects the person · spoken or written	I was wondering if you could take another look.
V · Vague language	builds rapport · casual, spoken	Let's meet at eightish . There'll be ten or so of us.

The distance ladder: past, continuous and *would* make a request softer.

Direct	Can you send it today?
Softer	Could you send it today?
Softer still	Would it be possible to send it today?

Most distant

I was wondering if you could send it today.

Minimizers and understatement: *a slight problem · a bit of an issue · not exactly ideal · not the cheapest option (= expensive) · I'm not entirely convinced (= I disagree).* **Negative questions:** *Wouldn't it be safer to wait?*

Bad news and refusals: **preface** (I'm afraid... / Unfortunately...) → **soften** (it's not going to be possible to...) → **reason** (the thing is...) → **alternative** (Could we perhaps...?).

✗ *The results were sort of significant.* (vague language in an essay) · ✗ over-softening: if the listener can't say what must change, you haven't delivered the message.

◆ LISTEN – EXERCISE 1: FEEDBACK ON A DRAFT

Lena, a team lead, gives Dev feedback on his draft of the community newsletter. Complete the softeners.

"Thanks for the draft, Dev. Can I share (1) _____? Overall it's (2) _____, genuinely. The events section is (3) _____, though. (4) _____ we could cut it to the top five. And to be honest, I'm (5) _____ by the headline. It (6) _____ asking the volunteers what they'd call it. (7) _____ to send me a new version by Thursday?"

What exactly does Dev have to change? _____

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 2: SOFTEN THE BLUNT STATEMENTS

Rewrite each line as diplomatic English. Use distancing, minimizers, or preface → soften → reason.

1. "Your report is full of mistakes." → _____
2. "No, I can't help you." → _____
3. "You're wrong about this." → _____
4. "Give me the file now." → _____
5. (to your manager) "That deadline is impossible." → _____
6. (to a client) "We can't give you a discount." → _____

◆ WRITE – EXERCISE 3: HEDGE THE OVER-STRONG CLAIMS

Rewrite each claim so it is cautious and defensible. Use at least two hedging devices, but don't hedge it into nothing.

1. "This study proves that remote work increases productivity." → _____
2. "Everyone learns better with visual aids." → _____
3. "Online courses are always less effective than classroom teaching." → _____
4. "Drinking coffee improves concentration." → _____

◆ READ AND WRITE – EXERCISE 4: WHICH TOOLKIT? H, D OR V

Write **H** (academic hedge), **D** (diplomatic softening) or **V** (vague language), and where it belongs.

1. "The findings appear to indicate a modest effect." _____
2. "I was wondering if you could take a look?" _____
3. "We got there about eightish and had a coffee and stuff." _____
4. "It could be argued that the policy was largely ineffective." _____
5. "Would it be possible to move the meeting?" _____
6. "There were, like, thirty or so people at the barbecue." _____
7. "I take your point, but I see it slightly differently." _____
8. "Regular exercise tends to be associated with better sleep." _____

◆ READ – EXERCISE 5: WHAT DO THEY REALLY MEAN?

Match each understatement to its real meaning.

1	"It's not the cheapest option."	a	It went well.
2	"I'm not entirely convinced this will work."	b	It's very expensive.
3	"That didn't go badly at all."	c	This is a serious problem.
4	"He's not exactly known for his patience."	d	I think it will fail.
5	"We might have a slight issue with the timeline."	e	He is impatient.

1 _____ · 2 _____ · 3 _____ · 4 _____ · 5 _____

◆ READ AND SAY – DIALOGUE: A REQUEST, A REFUSAL, AN ALTERNATIVE

Carla: Have you got a minute? I was wondering if you could do me a favor.

Omar: Sure, what's up?

Carla: Would it be possible for you to present our results at Thursday's meeting? I'm going to be at the training day.

Omar: Ah. As much as I'd like to, I'm afraid Thursday's not going to work. The thing is, I'm with a client all afternoon.

Carla: Oh, I see. That's a bit of a problem.

Omar: Perhaps we could ask Jin instead? She knows the figures. Or couldn't we record a short video?

Carla: A video might actually work. I'm not entirely sure the manager will like it, though.

Omar: Wouldn't it be worth asking? I'm happy to help you record it on Wednesday.

Carla: That's really kind. Let's do that.

Find Omar's preface, softener, reason and alternative. Which two lines use distancing? Which line is a negative question?

◆ WITH A PARTNER – DIPLOMATIC ROLE-PLAY SERIES

Four difficult workplace conversations, in groups of three: **A** delivers the message, **B** receives it, the **Observer** uses the checklist. Change roles every round. Play the card, not yourself.

① Giving bad news · ② Disagreeing with a manager · ③ Declining a request · ④ Softening criticism in feedback

Plan your turn as A (one minute):

Preface	
My message (in one sentence)	
Softeners (3+)	
Reason	
Alternative / next step	

"What must change?" test: after each conversation, B says in one sentence what they understood. If B can't, A was too soft.

◆ SAY – SELF-CHECK: CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

A colleague proposes a plan you think is risky. Which reply is the most diplomatically softened?

A) "That won't work. It's too risky."

B) "It's sort of risky and stuff."

C) "I wonder if it might be a bit risky — it might be worth thinking through the downside first?"

2

Which sentence belongs in a formal academic essay rather than casual speech?

A) "It kind of helped, twenty or so people improved and stuff."

B) "The data suggest that the intervention may improve outcomes to some extent."

C) "I was wondering if you could re-run the numbers?"

3

Your manager asks you to take on a third project, but you're already overloaded. Which reply protects the relationship and gives a clear answer?

A) "No. I have too much work."

B) "I'd really like to help, but I'm afraid I can't take on another project right now. The thing is, the Harris report is due on Friday. Could we look at it again next month?"

C) "Hmm, that might be a little bit tricky, maybe, possibly... we'll see."

◆ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ hedge a claim to match the evidence (*suggests, may, to some extent*) without hedging it into nothing
- ◆ ☐ make a request softer with the distance ladder (*I was wondering if...*)
- ◆ ☐ deliver bad news or say no with preface → soften → reason → alternative
- ◆ ☐ disagree with a manager and give critical feedback that is gentle **and** clear
- ◆ ☐ tell academic hedging, diplomatic softening and vague language apart, and use each in the right place

◆ MY NEW WORDS

◆ MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Think of a difficult moment at work or school (real, invented, or from a new identity card). Write what was said bluntly, then a softened version that still makes the point.

Lexical Range & Fluency

At this level, grammar rarely lets you down; word choice is what separates a correct sentence from a genuinely natural one. In this module you'll choose between a phrasal verb and its formal twin, find the partner a word prefers and the shade of feeling it carries, and then bring the whole first half of C1 together in one argument: spoken, defended and written up.

Lessons 4.1–4.3

Classes C10–C12

Level C1

Name: _____

ICONS

Write • Listen • Say • Work with a partner • Read

When a task draws on your own life, you decide what to share. Use your real experience, **or** a new identity card, **or** something you invent; all three are equally valid. When you describe people in this module, describe invented people, never classmates. In role-plays and debates you argue the card, not necessarily your own view, and you can always say "Pass."

◆ NEW WORDS — THE REGISTER PAIRS (SPOKEN ⇌ WRITTEN)

put off ⇌ postpone

find out ⇌ discover

look into ⇌ investigate

go up ⇌ increase / rise

set up ⇌ establish

give up ⇌ abandon

put up with ⇌ tolerate

carry out ⇌ conduct

get rid of ⇌ eliminate

come across ⇌ encounter

One verb, several jobs: the literal senses first.take off (leave
the ground)take off
(remove)set off (start a
journey)break down
(stop working)**Working sets,** grouped so the collocations travel together:

take on (a task, staff)

follow up (on an email)

lay off (staff)

get on with (a colleague)

fall out (with someone)

look up to (admire)

cut down on (sugar)

get over (an illness)

point out (a problem)

bring up (a topic)

sum up

fall through (a plan)

◆ GRAMMAR BOX

Four types. Ask two questions: *Does it take an object?* and *Can the object go in the middle?* The quickest test is to try it with it.

① Intransitive	no object	The car broke down . · We set off at dawn.
② Separable	noun object: either position · pronoun: in the middle only	turn off the light · turn the light off · turn it off
③ Inseparable	the object always follows, even a pronoun	look after the kids · look after them
④ Three-part	never split	put up with the noise · put up with it

✓ Turn it off. · Pick her up at six. · Deal with it. ✗ Turn off it. · Pick up her. · Deal it with.

A **long object** goes at the end: *She turned off every light in the house before she left.*

The register swap. Phrasal verbs lean spoken; their single-word twins lean written and formal. Neither is better: choose by reader, setting and purpose. Some phrasal verbs are perfectly at home in formal writing: *carry out, point out, set up, bring about.*

Noun forms fuse the two parts and move the stress to the front: break **DOWN** → a **BREAK**down · take **Over** → a **TAKE**over · turn **OUT** → an **OUT**come · break out → an **OUT**break.

◆ EXERCISE 1 – LISTEN TO THE VOICE MESSAGE. COMPLETE THE PHRASAL VERBS.

Priya, a project lead, leaves her team an update. Write the missing verbs, then label each one's type (①–④).

1. The launch nearly _____ last week. Type _____
2. Two of our suppliers _____ at the last minute. Type _____
3. We had to _____ by a week. Type _____
4. ...and _____ new contracts from scratch. Type _____
5. You all _____ brilliantly. Type _____
6. Since the launch, things have really _____. Type _____
7. Jonah is going to _____ why the suppliers backed out. Type _____
8. We'll _____ single-source deals. Type _____

Now retell the update to a partner as a formal email would put it. Which three verbs change?

◆ EXERCISE 2 – PLACE THE OBJECT

a) Rewrite each sentence with the pronoun in brackets.

1. Could you turn down the music? (it) → _____
2. She looks after her grandmother on weekends. (her) → _____
3. Please fill in the application form. (it) → _____
4. I can't put up with the noise any longer. (it) → _____
5. We need to deal with these complaints today. (them) → _____
6. He threw away all the old receipts. (them) → _____
7. Have you gotten over the flu yet? (it) → _____
8. They called off the meeting. (it) → _____

b) Circle the more natural sentence and say why.

(A) She turned off every light in the building before she left. / (B) She turned every light in the building off before she left.

◆ EXERCISE 3 – THE REGISTER SWAP

a) Match each phrasal verb (1–10) with its formal single-word twin (a–j).

1. put off _____	6. give up _____	a) tolerate · b) encounter · c) investigate · d) eliminate · e) postpone
---------------------	------------------	--

2. find out _____	7. put up with _____	f) abandon · g) increase · h) establish · i) discover · j) conduct
3. look into _____	8. carry out _____	
4. go up _____	9. get rid of _____	
5. set up _____	10. come across _____	

b) Which fits? Circle the better choice for the context. Then write a few words explaining why.

1. (a text to your roommate) The landlord's going to (look into / investigate) the leak tomorrow.

2. (a formal letter from a college) We regret to inform you that the ceremony has been (put off / postponed) until June. _____

3. (a safety report) Inspectors (carried out / conducted) a full review of the site.

4. (chatting with a coworker) I'm trying to (give up / relinquish) sugar. _____

5. (an academic essay) Prices (went up / rose) by 12% over the decade. _____

6. (a formal customer-service email) Please let us know if you (come across / encounter) any further problems. _____

7. (a quick team meeting) We need to (get rid of / eliminate) the old sign-in sheet.

c) Rewrite this spoken update as one or two formal sentences for a written report.

"We've found out that the heating broke down because nobody had carried out the yearly check, so we've set up a new schedule."

◆ EXERCISE 4 – ONE VERB, MANY MEANINGS

Match each sentence (a–i) with the meaning of the verb (i–ix).

a) The flight took off an hour late. _____ b) Her podcast took off overnight. _____ c) Please take off your shoes at the door. _____

d) They took 15% off the price. _____ e) I'll pick you up at the station. _____ f) She picked up some Korean from TV dramas. _____

- g) Business usually picks up in the spring. _____ h) I could barely make out the sign in the fog.
_____ i) He made out that he'd organized the whole event. _____

Meanings: (i) improve · (ii) remove clothing · (iii) claim, probably falsely · (iv) leave the ground · (v) learn informally · (vi) become successful · (vii) manage to see · (viii) deduct · (ix) collect someone

◆ EXERCISE 5 – FROM VERB TO NOUN

Complete each sentence with the noun form. Underline the stressed syllable.

1. The talks broke down in May. → The _____ of the talks came in May.
2. A competitor took the company over. → The _____ was announced on Friday.
3. Flu broke out in the dormitory. → There was an _____ of flu in the dormitory.
4. We were pleased with how it turned out. → We were pleased with the _____.
5. Thanks for putting in your ideas. → Thanks for your _____.
6. The storm set the project back by a month. → The storm was a major _____.
7. Hundreds of people turned out for the festival. → The _____ was excellent.

◆ DIALOGUE – THE LAUNCH, IN TWO REGISTERS

Leah: So how did the launch go? I heard it nearly fell through.

Omar: It almost did. Two suppliers pulled out at the last minute, so we had to put it off by a week and set up new contracts from scratch.

Leah: Ouch. How did the team hold up?

Omar: Honestly, they put up with a lot. A couple of them nearly burned out, but once things picked up, morale came back. Sales have taken off since.

Leah: Nice. Did you ever find out why the suppliers backed out?

Omar: We looked into it. Turns out a competitor had taken them over. We've since cut down on single-source deals so we don't get caught out again.

The formal written version: *The launch was nearly abandoned. Two suppliers withdrew at short notice, obliging us to postpone it by a week and establish new contracts from scratch. The team tolerated considerable pressure, but as performance recovered, morale returned, and sales have since increased sharply. On investigating the suppliers' withdrawal, we discovered that a competitor had acquired them; we have consequently reduced our reliance on single-source agreements.*

Underline every phrasal verb in the dialogue (there are more than twelve). Then find the formal twin of *fell through*, *pulled out*, *put off*, *set up*, *put up with*, *looked into*, *found out*, *taken over* in the written version. Which phrasal verb from the dialogue *could* have stayed in the written version?

◆ SPEAKING – THE REGISTER SWAP

In class you and your partner get one story. A tells an informal voice note; together you write the formal update; then B turns a formal memo into a 30-second spoken update. Here, plan a second story of your own (real, invented, or from a new identity card): a project, a change at work, an event you helped organize.

Version A — spoken. Ten phrasal verbs I could use (at least two types):

Version B — formal update (70–90 words, for a manager or committee). Mark with **K** any phrasal verb you keep on purpose.

I kept _____ because _____

☐ every pronoun object is in the right place · ☐ swaps where the register calls for them · ☐ at least one phrasal verb kept on purpose · ☐ no idioms in Version B

◆ SELF-CHECK — CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

The light is still on. Which is correct?

A) Could you turn off it?

B) Could you turn it off?

C) Could you turn it off from?

2

In a formal written report, which best replaces "we'll look into the complaint"?

A) we will look up the complaint

B) we will put up with the complaint

C) we will investigate the complaint

3

Which sentence uses the three-part verb correctly?

A) I can't put up it with any longer.

B) I can't put up with it any longer.

C) I can't put it up with any longer.

◆ ☒ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ sort a multi-word verb into one of the four types and say where its object goes
- ◆ ☐ place a pronoun correctly: *turn it off*, but *look after it*
- ◆ ☐ work out which meaning of *take off*, *pick up* or *make out* is meant from the context
- ◆ ☐ swap a phrasal verb for its formal twin, and back, and explain which one fits
- ◆ ☐ use and stress the noun forms: *a breakdown*, *an outcome*, *a takeover*

◆ MY NEW WORDS

◆ MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Write one idea from your week twice: once as you'd say it to a friend, with a phrasal verb, and once as you'd write it in a formal email, with its single-word twin.

◆ NEW WORDS — WORDS THAT TRAVEL TOGETHER



strong coffee



heavy rain



bitterly cold

deeply
concerned

get cold feet



take a photo

Collocations worth owning:

a strong argument

heavy traffic

a bitter disappointment

a key issue

make a decision

do research

meet a deadline

raise an issue

highly unlikely

fully aware

widely regarded as

apologize profusely

a round of applause

a pang of guilt

Idioms (spoken, informal, fixed):

a blessing in disguise

the last straw

hit the nail on the head

bite the bullet

cut corners

on the same page

a gray area

get cold feet

the tip of the iceberg

food for thought

use it or lose it

◆ LEXIS BOX

Collocation types. Store the whole partnership, not the single word.

adjective + noun	heavy rain · a valid point · a bitter disappointment
verb + noun	make a decision · do research · take a risk · pay attention · meet a deadline
adverb + adjective	deeply concerned · highly unlikely · bitterly cold · fully aware
verb + adverb	apologize profusely · argue convincingly · fail miserably
noun + noun	a round of applause · a surge of anger · a flurry of activity

Strong and weak. A **strong** collocation is fixed and predictable (*bitterly* → *cold*). A **weak** one combines with almost anything (*very, good, big*). Weak is never wrong, but strong is precise.

Weak

very cold · very unlikely · very worried · a big problem · said sorry a lot

Strong	bitterly cold · highly unlikely · deeply concerned · a pressing problem · apologized profusely
---------------	--

Connotation: same dictionary meaning, different feeling. Ask: *Am I praising, staying neutral, or criticizing?*

Positive	Neutral	Negative
slender · slim	thin	skinny · scrawny
thrifty · frugal	economical	stingy · tight
self-assured · confident	—	arrogant · cocky
renowned	well-known	notorious
curious · inquisitive	interested	nosy
determined	firm	stubborn · pig-headed
childlike (wonder)	—	childish (immature)

Idioms: three rules. Mostly **spoken** (rephrase them in formal writing) · **a pinch, not a plateful** (one or two per talk) · **exact form** (a broken idiom is worse than none).

◆ EXERCISE 1 – LISTEN TO THE TEAM MEETING. TICK THE IDIOMS YOU HEAR.

Dana and Sam discuss a pilot program that failed.

☐ the last straw · ☐ get cold feet · ☐ cut corners · ☐ hit the nail on the head · ☐ the tip of the iceberg · ☐ a gray area · ☐ a blessing in disguise · ☐ on the same page · ☐ food for thought · ☐ bite the bullet

Explain three of the idioms you heard in your own words.

- _____
- _____
- _____

What do Dana and Sam decide to do? Would they use these idioms in the email to the board?

◆ EXERCISE 2 – COLLOCATION GRIDS

a) Tick (✓) every natural combination. Say each one aloud before you decide.

	a decision	research	a photo	attention	an issue	a deadline	a mistake	a risk	a compliment
make									
do									
take									

pay									
raise									
meet									

b) Which adverbs go with which adjectives? Tick the strong collocations.

	concerned	unlikely	cold	aware	regarded	disappointed	respected
deeply							
highly							
bitterly							
fully							
widely							

◆ EXERCISE 3 – FROM WEAK TO STRONG

Replace the words in *italics* with a strong collocation.

1. It was *very cold* at the bus stop. → _____
2. It's *very unlikely* that the store will open on time. → _____
3. The parents were *very worried* about the new schedule. → _____
4. She *said sorry many times*. → _____
5. There was *a lot of traffic* on the bridge. → _____
6. Losing the contract was *a big disappointment*. → _____
7. The audience *clapped for a long time*. → _____
8. Cost is *a big issue* for the board. → _____

◆ EXERCISE 4 – CHOOSE THE SHADE AND THE REGISTER

a) Arrange each set on the line, from most positive to most negative.

1. slender · scrawny · thin · slim · skinny
+ _____ –
2. stingy · economical · thrifty · tight · frugal
+ _____ –
3. nosy · interested · inquisitive · curious
+ _____ –

b) Circle the word whose feeling and formality fit the context.

1. (complimenting a colleague's presentation manner) You came across as really (arrogant / self-assured) up there.
2. (a formal business email) We (require / want) your confirmation by end of day.
3. (praising a friend's careful budgeting) You're so (stingy / thrifty); I really admire it.
4. (describing a district known for pickpockets) The district is (renowned / notorious) for pickpockets.
5. (chatting casually with a friend) Should we (commence / get going)? I'm starving.
6. (a toast at a retirement party) Her (childlike / childish) curiosity kept us all young.
7. (complaining about an invented neighbor) He's always asking what we paid for things. He's so (curious / nosy).
8. (a formal job reference) She is extremely (determined / stubborn) and never gives up on a problem.

◆ EXERCISE 5 – IDIOMS: FIX THEM, OR REPHRASE THEM

a) Each idiom is slightly wrong. Correct it.

1. You've hit the nail on its head. → _____
2. Losing that job was a blessing in the disguise. → _____
3. Let's make sure we're on the same paper. → _____
4. He got cold foot the night before the launch. → _____
5. That's just the top of the iceberg. → _____

b) Rephrase each sentence for a formal written report, with no idiom.

1. The complaints are just the tip of the iceberg. → _____
2. The contractor cut corners on safety. → _____
3. The rules on this are a gray area. → _____
4. The board finally bit the bullet and raised the fees. → _____

◆ DIALOGUE – THE COMMUNITY GARDEN FENCE

Rosa: Have you seen the quote for the new fence? I'm deeply concerned about the cost.

Ken: Me too. It's highly unlikely the city will cover all of it.

Rosa: We could do some research on cheaper materials. Or build it ourselves.

Ken: Ourselves? That's a calculated risk. None of us are carpenters.

Rosa: True, but Mr. Ali is. He's famously frugal. He'll find us the cheapest wood in town.

Ken: Frugal? He's the stingiest man on the block!

Rosa: Let's not be unkind. He's thrifty, and that's exactly what we need right now.

Ken: Fair enough. Let's raise the issue at Thursday's meeting and make a decision by the end of the month.

Rosa: Agreed. We'll also need to meet the grant deadline.

Ken: Then let's bite the bullet and ask him tonight.

Underline eight strong collocations and circle the idiom. Which three words describe Mr. Ali? How does each speaker feel about him?

◆ SPEAKING – "USE IT OR LOSE IT" AND THE PRECISE TALK

Discuss in threes. "Use it or lose it" is itself an idiom. Is it true of vocabulary? Of idioms in particular? Have you ever lost words you once knew well, in English or another language? What is a realistic way to keep a new chunk alive?

My three chunks for this week, and where I will use each one:

1. _____ → _____

2. _____ → _____

3. _____ → _____

The Precise Talk (90 seconds). Choose a topic: a place you know well, a trend in your field, a decision you had to make, a piece of news that gave you pause. Your listeners tick the chunks they hear.

Topic	
6 collocations	
1–2 idioms (only if they fit)	
A near-synonym set I'll explain	

◆ SELF-CHECK – CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

Which sentence uses the natural English collocations?

A) There was heavy traffic, so we had to make a quick decision.

B) There was strong traffic, so we had to make a quick decision.

C) There was heavy traffic, so we had to do a quick decision.

2

You want to compliment a friend who is careful and sensible with money. Which word fits the connotation?

A) thrifty

B) stingy

C) tight

3

An invented coworker keeps asking about everyone's salary and private life. Which word expresses your critical view?

A) curious

B) inquisitive

C) nosy

◆ ☒ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ use natural collocations of five types and avoid translated ones
- ◆ ☐ upgrade a weak collocation to a strong one: *very cold* → *bitterly cold*
- ◆ ☐ choose between near-synonyms to praise, stay neutral or criticize
- ◆ ☐ use an idiom accurately in speech, and rephrase it plainly in formal writing
- ◆ ☐ give a short talk rich in precise collocations

◆ MY PHRASEBOOK (NEW CHUNKS)

◆ MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Describe an invented person, a place or an object twice: once kindly and once critically, changing only

one or two words.

◆ NEW WORDS — THE COMMUNICATOR'S PHRASE BANKS

Register ladders (formal → neutral → informal):

commence → start → kick off

purchase → buy → pick up

assist → help → give a hand

require → need → could use

insufficient → not enough → a bit short

regarding → about → on

it is imperative → we really must → we've got to

Signposts for extended talk:

I'd like to make the case that...

There are three points I want to raise.

Let me begin by...

This brings me to...

Turning now to...

Crucially,...

To put it another way,...

Admittedly,... That said,...

In essence,...

The bottom line is this:...

Answering questions diplomatically:

I take your point, but I'd argue...

That's a fair challenge. What I'd say is...

I'd push back on one thing...

If I understand you correctly, your concern is...

That's beyond the scope of this proposal, but...

◆ GRAMMAR BOX — THE SPECTRUM AND THE TOOLKIT

Register is a spectrum, and its features shift **as a set**: vocabulary, grammar and sentence structure together.

Formal	The initiative will commence next quarter and is anticipated to yield significant benefits.	nominal · passive · hedged · Latinate · long sentences · no contractions
Neutral	The project starts next quarter and should bring real benefits.	balanced · some hedging
Informal	We're kicking this off next quarter, and it should pay off nicely.	verbal · active · contracted · phrasal verbs · <i>so, look, honestly</i>

Rhetorical devices: one or two, placed at the hinges (the opening, the turn, the close).

Rhetorical question	Can we really afford to wait another decade?
Rule of three	It is cheaper, it is cleaner, and it is already here.

Repetition	We owe it to our patients. We owe it to our staff. We owe it to ourselves.
Contrast	The problem is not a lack of money, but a lack of will.
Cleft / inversion	What we need is courage. · Never has the case been clearer.

Your C1 toolkit so far:

Module 1	By 2030, attitudes will have shifted. · It may well prove decisive. · It is essential that action be taken.
Module 2	Had we acted sooner, we would not be in this position. · Not only is it costly, but it is also ineffective. · What is so often overlooked is the human cost.
Module 3	The implementation of the reforms met with fierce resistance. · Some favored the plan; others did not. · The evidence would appear to suggest a modest effect.
Module 4	We'll need to iron out the details. · It remains a pressing concern. · (spoken only) something of a gray area

◆ EXERCISE 1 – LISTEN TO THE MODEL TALK AND THE Q&A

Amara proposes one paid learning day a month for staff. Then two colleagues challenge her.

a) Number the signposts in the order you hear them (1–9).

_____ This brings me to... _____ In essence,... _____ I take your point, but I'd argue... _____ There are three points I want to raise.

_____ Ask yourself this: ... _____ Turning now to... _____ That's a fair challenge. What I'd say is... _____ I'd like to make the case that... _____ Let me begin by...

b) Tick the structures you hear. Write the words if you can.

- ☐ future perfect _____ · ☐ the subjunctive _____
- ☐ a mixed conditional _____ · ☐ *not only* inversion _____
- ☐ a *what*-cleft _____ · ☐ nominalization _____
- ☐ hedging _____ · ☐ a strong collocation _____
- ☐ *needn't have* _____ · ☐ ellipsis with *so / not* _____

◆ EXERCISE 2 – SHIFT THE REGISTER

Rewrite each message at the register in brackets. Change vocabulary, grammar and structure together.

1. (→ formal) "We need to talk about the money side of things pretty soon."

2. (→ informal) "I would be most grateful if you could furnish me with the relevant documentation."

3. (→ neutral / professional) "This whole thing is a total mess and someone needs to fix it."

4. (→ formal) "We're kicking off the new schedule in March, and we think it'll cut down on overtime."

5. (→ informal) "Attendance is mandatory for all personnel; failure to comply may result in disciplinary action."

◆ EXERCISE 3 – NAME THE DEVICE

1. "It was cheaper, it was faster, and it was fairer." → _____
2. "The issue is not whether we act, but how." → _____
3. "What this town needs is a proper bus service." → _____
4. "Can we really afford to lose another good nurse?" → _____
5. "We owe it to our patients. We owe it to our staff. We owe it to ourselves." → _____
6. "Never has the case for change been clearer." → _____

◆ EXERCISE 4 – REPAIR THE REGISTER CLASH

Each sentence mixes registers. Rewrite it consistently; you choose the direction.

1. "The board will convene on Thursday to sort out the mess."

2. "I think the aforementioned proposal is pretty sketchy."

3. "Hey team, pursuant to our discussion, let's grab a coffee and hash it out."

4. "Dear Ms. Patel, Thanks a bunch for your application. Unfortunately, we are unable to offer you the position."

5. "So, like, the quarterly figures indicate a substantial decline in revenue."

◆ EXERCISE 5 – UPGRADE WITH THE TOOLKIT

Rewrite each sentence with the structure in brackets.

1. (future perfect) The scheme will pay for itself before the end of 2028. → _____

2. (subjunctive) Every employee must complete the training. It's essential. → _____

3. (mixed conditional) We didn't invest in training, so we're short of skilled staff now. → _____

4. (*not only* inversion) The plan is cheap. It is also effective. → _____

5. (cleft) We need time, not money. → _____

6. (nominalization) When they introduced the policy, waste fell sharply. → _____

7. (hedging) This proves the scheme works. → _____

8. (formal lexis) We'll look into why costs went up so much. → _____

◆ DIALOGUE – ONE POINT, TWO VOICES

To a client: Having reviewed the current timeline, I would respectfully suggest that a modest extension may well prove prudent. It is by no means certain that the present deadline can be met without some compromise to quality, and quality, I'm sure we agree, must remain paramount.

To a colleague: Look, between us, there's no way we're hitting Friday without cutting corners, and that'd be a false economy. Let's just push it back a week and do it properly, OK?

Find five features that shift together (for example, *would respectfully suggest* ↔ *Look, between us*). Read both aloud to a partner. How do your voice and posture change?

◆ SPEAKING & WRITING – THE ADVANCED COMMUNICATOR

Part 1: the talk planner (notes, not a script; up to three minutes). Topic: _____ Side / persona: _____

Open	device (question / bold claim):
Preview	There are ____ points I want to raise:
Point 1	claim · evidence · example:
Point 2	signpost · claim · evidence · example:
Point 3 (optional)	signpost · claim · evidence:
Close	In essence,... / The choice, then, is...

Toolkit plan: M1 _____ · M2 _____ · M3 _____
· M4 _____

Part 2: the Q&A card (two minutes of questions). Two likely objections and how I'll concede, then counter:

1. _____ → I take your point, but _____
2. _____ → That's a fair challenge. What I'd say is _____

Part 3: the written summary. About 150 words, for a committee that did not hear your talk. Include your proposal, your two strongest reasons, the strongest objection raised (report it fairly) and your response. Formal register: nominalize, hedge, no idioms, no contractions.

Peer review (your partner ticks): ☐ the proposal is clear in the first sentence · ☐ two reasons, each supported · ☐ the objection is reported fairly, with a reporting verb · ☐ a response follows · ☐ the register stays formal throughout (no idioms, contractions or clashes) · ☐ at least one hedge and one nominalization

Praise: _____ Question: _____ Polish: _____

◆ SELF-CHECK – CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

A speaker wants to draw listeners in and make them supply the answer themselves. Which device fits?

- A) Nominalization ("the implementation of the plan")
- B) Ellipsis ("some agreed, others didn't")
- C) A rhetorical question ("Can we really afford to wait?")

2

Which sentence best combines a formal register with the subjunctive to express urgent necessity?

- A) We really need to do something about this soon.
- B) It is imperative that action be taken at once.
- C) It's imperative that action is taken pronto.

3

Which sentence keeps a consistent formal register?

- A) The committee will sort out the discrepancies.
- B) The committee will resolve the discrepancies.
- C) The committee's gonna resolve the discrepancies.

◆ ☒ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ shift one message from formal to neutral to informal, changing its features as a set
- ◆ ☐ spot and repair a register clash
- ◆ ☐ deliver a signposted three-minute persuasive talk with one or two well-placed devices
- ◆ ☐ answer a challenge diplomatically: concede, then counter
- ◆ ☐ write a formal summary of my argument that reports an objection fairly
- ◆ ☐ use structures and vocabulary from all four modules in one extended performance

◆ MY NEW WORDS

◆ MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

You're halfway through C1. Write one sentence about what you can do now that you couldn't do at the start, and one about what you want to sharpen next.

Structure & Advanced Vocabulary

The quiet machinery of formal English. Compress a clause into a participle so your prose carries more in fewer words, and keep every participle anchored to the right subject. Connect words with the exact preposition the pattern demands. Choose the precise academic word, report a source at exactly the strength it deserves, and know when the plain word serves you better.

Lessons 5.1–5.3

Classes C14–C16

Level C1

Name: _____

HOW THIS WORKBOOK WORKS

Write • Listen • Say • Work with a partner or team • Read

This module is built around three editing workshops: condensing a report, correcting a formal email, and summarizing a research abstract. All the texts are invented, and none of them asks about your own life. Where a journal prompt invites a personal example, a colleague's experience, a news item or an invented example is just as good.

◆ MY GOAL AFTER PROGRESS TEST 1

One thing I did well: _____

One thing I want to refine: _____

How I'll work on it each week: _____

◆ KEY PHRASES

a participle clause	an absolute clause	a dangling (misrelated) participle	a reduced relative clause
having said that, ...	all things considered, ...	weather permitting	given that ...
provided that ...	judging by ...	barring any delays, ...	strictly speaking, ...

◆ GRAMMAR BOX

A participle clause drops the conjunction and the repeated subject: *When she realized the risk, she paused* → **Realizing the risk, she paused.** Choose the participle by voice, not by tense.

Form	Meaning	Example
-ing	active · same time, reason or result	Knowing the road well, he took a shortcut. · The storm hit the coast, flattening dozens of homes.
having + past participle	active · clearly earlier	Having signed the contract, they celebrated. · Having been warned twice, the driver slowed down.
past participle	passive meaning	Written in 1920, the novel still speaks to readers. · Given more time, we could have finished.
reduced relative	noun + -ing / past participle	members wishing to attend · any items damaged in transit
absolute clause	its own subject + participle (<i>being</i> often dropped)	The weather being fine , we set off. · The meeting over , the staff went home. · She waited, her heart pounding .

The one-question test	After a leading participle, ask: Who or what is doing this -ing / being this -ed? That exact answer must be the subject of the next clause.
Dangling	✗ <i>Walking into the room, the noise was overwhelming.</i> (The noise was walking?)
Repair ①	Change the main subject: <i>Walking into the room, I found the noise overwhelming.</i>
Repair ②	Give the participle its own subject, or restore a full clause: <i>The exam finished, the results came quickly.</i> · <i>As I walked into the room, ...</i>

Register

Full participle and absolute clauses are formal and written. Fixed phrases (*having said that, generally speaking*) work in speech too.

◆ EXERCISE 1 – LISTEN TO THE COMMITTEE CHAIR. WRITE THE PARTICIPLE CHUNKS YOU HEAR.

The chair of a community volunteer committee opens a planning meeting. Write the missing words.

1. _____ last year's feedback, the committee has made three changes.
2. The fair will be held in the main hall, _____ until June.
3. Volunteers _____ a stall are asked to register by Friday.
4. All materials _____ will be recycled afterward.
5. _____, each presentation will be limited to five minutes.
6. _____, we'll also set up tables on the lawn.
7. _____, we expect a busy and productive day.
8. _____, we still need people to help with setup.

Which two chunks have their **own subject**? _____

◆ EXERCISE 2 – COMPRESS EACH SENTENCE. WRITE ONLY THE PARTICIPLE CHUNK.

1. Because he knew the area well, he took a shortcut. → _____ the area well, he took a shortcut.
2. After she had locked the door, she checked it twice. → _____ the door, she checked it twice.
3. The report was written in a hurry, and it contained several errors. → _____, the report contained several errors.
4. The volunteers who are helping at the fair should arrive by eight. → The volunteers _____ at the fair should arrive by eight.
5. Since she had not received a reply, she called the office. → _____ a reply, she called the office.
6. If it is taken as directed, the medicine is safe. → _____ as directed, the medicine is safe.

◆ EXERCISE 3 – DOES THE SUBJECT DO IT, OR RECEIVE IT? CIRCLE THE CORRECT PARTICIPLE.

1. (Checking / Checked) twice, the figures were finally approved.
2. (Having interviewed / Interviewed) all the candidates, the panel made its decision.
3. Any passengers (traveling / traveled) without a ticket will be fined.

4. (Founding / Founded) in 1992, the co-op now has 4,000 members.
5. The flood swept through the valley, (destroying / destroyed) three bridges.
6. (Having told / Having been told) about the delay, the passengers waited calmly.

◆ EXERCISE 4 – THE SUBJECTS DIFFER, SO A PLAIN PARTICIPLE WOULD DANGLE. REWRITE EACH WITH AN ABSOLUTE CLAUSE.

1. Because the funds had run out, the project was suspended. → _____

2. The last guest left, and the hosts sank into their chairs. → _____

3. When the speeches were over, the music began. → _____

4. She presented the plan, and her voice was calm and steady. → _____

◆ EXERCISE 5 – SOUND OR DANGLING? WRITE S OR D. REPAIR EACH DANGLING PARTICIPLE.

1. Having missed the bus, she walked to work. _____
2. Rushing to the station, the train had already left. _____ → _____
3. Opened in 2021, the library has become the heart of the neighborhood. _____
4. Looking out of the office window, the new park was clearly visible. _____ →

5. All things considered, the launch went well. _____
6. After signing the lease, the apartment finally felt like home. _____ →

◆ DIALOGUE – READ WITH A PARTNER

Editor: Your draft is good, but "Reading the report, several errors jumped out at me" dangles. The errors didn't do the reading.

Writer: Ah. So either "Reading the report, I noticed several errors," or I give it its own subject: "Once the report had been read, several errors stood out."

Editor: Exactly. And "Having said that, the second half is much tighter" is fine as it is. It's a fixed phrase, so keep it.

Writer: Good. What about "The budget approved, work began in May"?

Editor: That's an absolute clause. It has its own subject, so it's perfectly sound. All things considered, just the one dangler to fix.

Find one example each of a dangling participle, a fixed phrase and an absolute clause in the dialogue.

◆ WORKSHOP – CONDENSE THE REPORT

Your team receives a short report that is correct but over-connected. Condense it to **90 words or fewer** without losing a single fact. Use at least **four** participle or absolute constructions (one must be an absolute) and **one** fixed phrase. Then swap with another team and review their draft.

Our report			
Words before → after	_____ → _____		
Constructions we used	-ing ☐ having + p.p. ☐	past participle ☐ absolute ☐	fixed phrase ☐ reduced relative ☐
Review we received	Praise:	Question:	Polish:

Reflection: Which sentence did your team decide **not** to compress, and why? _____

◆ SELF-CHECK – CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

Which sentence contains a dangling participle?

- A) Having missed the bus, she walked to work.
- B) Rushing to the station, the train had already left.
- C) Built in 1850, the house needs repairs.

2

You want to compress "Because the road was blocked, the drivers turned back," but the two clauses have different subjects. What is the best construction?

- A) The road blocked, the drivers turned back.
- B) Blocking the road, the drivers turned back.
- C) Being blocked the road, the drivers turned back.

3

Which sentence is both correct and properly anchored?

A) Damaging in transit, the parcel was returned to the sender.

B) Damaged in transit, the sender returned the parcel.

C) Damaged in transit, the parcel was returned to the sender.

◆ ☒ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ compress a clause with -ing, *having* + past participle or a past participle, choosing by voice
- ◆ ☐ reduce a relative clause: *members wishing to attend* · *items damaged in transit*
- ◆ ☐ build an absolute clause when the subjects differ: *The meeting over, the staff went home.*
- ◆ ☐ use fixed phrases such as *having said that, all things considered, weather permitting*
- ◆ ☐ find a dangling participle and repair it in two ways

◆ MY NEW WORDS

◆ MY JOURNAL

Describe one event from your day (or a colleague's, or one you invent) in two short, fully connected clauses. Rewrite it as a present participle clause, then as a *having* clause, then, if the subjects differ, as an absolute. Finally, write a dangling version on purpose and fix it. What did the fix change?

◆ KEY CHUNKS — LEARN THE WORD AND ITS PREPOSITION TOGETHER

comply with	refrain from + -ing	account for	resort to
result in / result from	aware of	subject to	consistent with
reliant on	conducive to	an increase in	a solution to
an alternative to	insight into		

Fixed formal phrases:

with regard to	in light of	by virtue of	in the event of	on behalf of	in accordance with
in the wake of	for the sake of	in terms of	at the expense of		

◆ GRAMMAR BOX

A **dependent preposition** is fixed by the word in front of it, not by logic. Store the pair as one chunk.

Family	Examples
of (knowing, lacking)	aware of · capable of · devoid of · indicative of · a lack of
with (matching)	comply with · consistent with · compatible with · familiar with
to (tending, turning)	subject to · prone to · conducive to · object to · resort to · a solution to · an alternative to
on / from / in / for	depend on · reliant on · an impact on · refrain from · benefit from · an increase in · insight into · a reason for · a demand for

Verb → noun	The preposition can switch: <i>increase prices</i> → an increase in prices · <i>solve a problem</i> → a solution to a problem
in vs of	in = the area that changed · of = the size of the change: <i>an increase in unemployment of 3%</i>
Meaning changes	<i>result in (cause) vs result from (be caused by)</i> · <i>agree with a person, to a proposal, on a plan</i>

No preposition	discuss the plan · enter the room · contact the office · emphasize the point ✗ discuss about
After a preposition	-ing: capable of managing · refrain from smoking · object to paying
Register	Fixed phrases belong in reports and formal emails. In conversation: <i>with regard to</i> → about · <i>in the event of</i> → if · <i>in the wake of</i> → after

◆ EXERCISE 1 – LISTEN TO THE VOICEMAIL FROM HUMAN RESOURCES. WRITE THE MISSING CHUNKS.

1. I'm calling _____ the training team.
2. _____ next week's workshop, I'd like to confirm a few details.
3. _____ the feedback we received, we've moved the session to Room 204.
4. All participants must _____ the new sign-in procedure.
5. We ask you to _____ using laptops during the first hour.
6. _____ a fire alarm, please follow the staff to the east exit.
7. The workshop _____ three short modules.
8. We've seen a sharp _____ demand, so please reply by Thursday.

◆ EXERCISE 2 – WRITE THE PREPOSITION THE PATTERN REQUIRES. ONE ITEM NEEDS NONE: WRITE -.

1. All contractors must comply _____ the safety regulations.
2. The region is heavily reliant _____ tourism.
3. How do you account _____ the drop in sales?
4. An open-plan office is not always conducive _____ concentration.
5. The committee will discuss _____ the proposal on Friday.
6. Several residents objected _____ paying the new fee.
7. The results are consistent _____ earlier research.
8. With the last train canceled, we had to resort _____ taking a taxi.

◆ EXERCISE 3 – COMPLETE EACH SENTENCE WITH A PHRASE FROM THE BOX.

in light of

by virtue of

with regard to

in the event of

on behalf of

in the wake of

1. _____ your inquiry of May 3, I can confirm that the room is available.
2. _____ a power outage, the backup generator will start automatically.

3. _____ the whole team, thank you for your patience.
4. _____ the new safety data, the launch has been postponed.
5. She was appointed chair _____ her long experience on the board.
6. _____ the merger, several departments were reorganized.

Which two sentences would sound oddly stiff in a text to a friend? Say them plainly:

◆ EXERCISE 4 – IN OR OF?

1. a sharp increase _____ energy prices
2. an increase _____ 12%
3. a steady decline _____ membership _____ about 300 people
4. a noticeable reduction _____ waiting times
5. a rise _____ two degrees
6. a fall _____ unemployment

◆ EXERCISE 5 – THIS EMAIL CONTAINS SIX PREPOSITION ERRORS. UNDERLINE THEM AND WRITE THE CORRECTIONS.

Subject: Changes to our appointment system

Dear Patient,

With regards to your recent inquiry, we are writing to explain the changes to our appointment system. In accordance to new county guidelines, all appointments must now be booked online. We are aware about the difficulties this may cause for some patients, and we have set up a phone line as an alternative for the online system. Please refrain to call the front desk for routine bookings. The change should result in shorter waiting times. If you would like to discuss about this further, please contact the practice manager.

Sincerely,

Riverside Health Clinic

1. _____ 2. _____
3. _____ 4. _____
5. _____ 6. _____

◆ DIALOGUE – READ WITH A PARTNER

Manager: With regard to the quarterly figures, how do you account for the drop in sales?

Analyst: It largely results from the supply delays. The dip is consistent with what we saw last winter, and it's certainly indicative of a wider slowdown.

Manager: Are we still reliant on a single supplier?

Analyst: For now, yes. We need an alternative to them. In the event of another delay, we have no buffer at all.

Manager: Agreed. Draft a proposal for a second source, in accordance with the procurement policy.

Analyst: Will do. It should have a real impact on our resilience.

Find three adjective or verb chunks and two fixed phrases. Which fixed phrase would you replace with a plain word in a quick hallway chat? _____

◆ WORKSHOP – THE FORMAL EMAIL CORRECTION CHALLENGE

Your team receives a formal email from a college facilities office. It contains **12 preposition errors** and **5 correct chunks that look suspicious**. Score +1 for each correct fix and –1 for changing something that was already right. Then write a formal reply (80–100 words) with at least four dependent prepositions and two fixed phrases, and proofread another team's reply for prepositions only.

Our score	Correct fixes: _____	Over-corrections: _____	Total: _____
The chunk we argued about most			
Our reply (card A / B) — chunks we'll use			
Review we received	Praise:	Question:	Polish:

◆ SELF-CHECK – CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

Which sentence uses the dependent preposition correctly?

A) We were not aware about the deadline.

B) Let's discuss about the results.

C) All staff must comply with the dress code.

2

A report notes: "There was a significant increase ____ carbon emissions." Which preposition fits?

A) of

B) on

C) in

3

Which sentence is correct for a formal report?

A) In light of the new figures, the board will revise its forecast.

B) In light with the new figures, the board will revise its forecast.

C) By light of the new figures, the board will revise its forecast.

◆ ☒ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ use the right preposition after verbs and adjectives: *comply with, refrain from, aware of, subject to*
- ◆ ☐ use the preposition a noun needs: *an increase in, a solution to, insight into*
- ◆ ☐ tell *in* (the area) from *of* (the figure) after change nouns
- ◆ ☐ leave out prepositions after transitive verbs: *discuss the plan*
- ◆ ☐ use fixed formal phrases in formal writing, and plain words in conversation

◆ MY PREPOSITION CHUNK LIST

Ten chunks: five you knew, five that surprised you.
Star the two you feel least sure of, and use them in a
real message this week.

◆ MY JOURNAL

Which three prepositions does your first language
tempt you to use in English (for example, "depend
of")? Write each wrong chunk, the right one, and a
sentence you might really need at work or in your
studies.

◆ KEY WORDS

obtain (get)	demonstrate (show)	substantial (big: amount)	significant (big: importance)
examine (look at)	sufficient (enough)	approximately (about + number)	regarding (about + topic)
deteriorate (get worse)	determine (find out)	facilitate (help, make easier)	constitute (make up)

Stance phrases:

The findings suggest that...	The data indicate that...	The authors argue that...
This study demonstrates that...	The report highlights...	The authors acknowledge that...
Further research is needed to...		

◆ VOCABULARY BOX

Everyday	Academic	Check the fit
get · show · look at	obtain · demonstrate · examine	<i>demonstrate</i> implies proof; <i>illustrate</i> gives an example
big	substantial / significant	<i>substantial</i> = size or amount; <i>significant</i> = importance (or statistically meaningful)
about	approximately / regarding	<i>approximately</i> for numbers only; <i>regarding</i> for topics
find out · go up · set up	determine · increase · establish	Keep a natural phrasal verb when no single verb is clearer

Stance thermometer	demonstrate / show — treated as proven argue / claim / maintain — a position others may contest suggest / indicate / imply — tentative, points toward note / observe — neutral, states a fact acknowledge / concede — admits a limitation
---------------------------	--

The use / utilize test

Does the longer word add **meaning**, or only **length**? If only length, it is *just formal*: cut it.

- ◆ EXERCISE 1 – LISTEN TO THE RADIO ITEM. NOTE SIX CASUAL EXPRESSIONS AND GIVE AN ACADEMIC EQUIVALENT.

	Casual (what you hear)	Academic
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		
6		

- ◆ EXERCISE 2 – REPLACE THE INFORMAL WORD WITH ONE ACADEMIC EQUIVALENT.

1. The team managed to _____ (get) funding for the project.
2. The graph clearly _____ (shows) the upward trend.
3. There was a _____ (big) rise in applications.
4. The report aims to _____ (look at) the root causes.
5. We did not have _____ (enough) evidence to reach a conclusion.
6. The program will _____ (start) next spring.
7. The sample contained _____ (about) two hundred people.
8. Conditions began to _____ (get worse) after the storm.

- ◆ EXERCISE 3 – COMPLETE THE WORD FAMILIES. THEN USE THE RIGHT FORM.

Noun	Verb	Adjective	Adverb
analysis			analytically
	signify	significant	
evidence	—		
	establish		—
consequence	—		

- a. A detailed _____ of the survey revealed three patterns.

- b. Sales improved _____ after the redesign.
- c. It was _____ from the data that demand had peaked.
- d. Funding fell; _____, two projects were canceled.

◆ EXERCISE 4 – REPORT THE SOURCE AT THE RIGHT STRENGTH. CIRCLE THE BETTER VERB.

1. The authors write that the effect "may" exist. They (suggest / demonstrate) that walking breaks improve concentration.
2. The report (highlights / concedes) three risks for managers to consider.
3. The authors (acknowledge / maintain) that the sample was small.
4. After ten large trials with the same result, the review (implies / demonstrates) that the treatment is effective.
5. Smith (notes / argues) that costs rose by 4% last year.
6. Despite the new evidence, critics (maintain / indicate) that the model is flawed.

◆ EXERCISE 5 – SHARPER OR JUST FORMAL? LABEL EACH SENTENCE, THEN REWRITE IT TO FIT ITS CONTEXT.

1. (a report) "The team looked into the causes of the delay." _____ → _____
2. (an email to a colleague you know well) "I shall utilize the conference room at three." _____ → _____
3. (a text to a friend) "I will endeavor to commence my journey imminently." _____ → _____
4. (a research summary) "A lot of people got put off by the price." _____ → _____

◆ DIALOGUE – READ WITH A PARTNER, THEN COMPARE THE REPORT VERSION

- Ana:** So we looked at the survey and found out that a lot of people got put off by the price.
- Ben:** Yeah, and sign-ups went up once we cut the cost, which kind of shows price was the big thing.
- Ana:** Right. We should probably start doing that across the board.

Report version: *An examination of the survey indicated that a substantial proportion of respondents were deterred by the price. Enrollment increased once the cost was reduced, which suggests that price was the primary factor. It would therefore be advisable to implement this change more widely.*

Match three casual phrases to their academic versions. Which verb in the report is a hedge?

◆ WORKSHOP – ABSTRACT TO SUMMARY

Read the abstract. Underline academic words, box every hedge and stance verb, and circle the one result that was **not** statistically significant.

Short Walking Breaks and Afternoon Concentration in Office Workers: A Pilot Study

Prolonged sitting is widely associated with reduced alertness, yet evidence regarding brief interventions in the workplace remains limited. This pilot study examined whether three five-minute walking breaks per afternoon affect self-reported concentration and task accuracy among office staff. Sixty-two employees at two municipal offices were randomly assigned to a walking-break group or a control group for four weeks. Concentration was assessed through a daily questionnaire, and accuracy was measured using a standardized data-entry task. Participants in the walking-break group reported approximately 18% higher afternoon concentration than the control group, and their error rate declined modestly; however, the difference in accuracy did not reach statistical significance. The findings suggest that brief walking breaks may constitute a low-cost means of sustaining afternoon concentration, although the small sample and reliance on self-report limit the generalizability of the results. Further research involving larger and more diverse workplaces is required.

Step 2: Explain the study to a partner as if to a friend over coffee: plain English only. **Step 3:** With your team, write a 70–90-word summary for a staff newsletter's "Research Roundup."

Checklist	☐ six academic words or phrases ☐ two stance verbs at the right strength ☐ one word-family shift ☐ no claim stronger than the abstract's
Sentence starters	A recent pilot study examined... · Participants who... reported approximately... · However, ... did not reach... · The authors suggest that... · They acknowledge that...

Review we received — Praise: _____ Question: _____ Polish: _____

Faithful to the abstract? ☐ Yes ☐ It claims a little too much in line _____

◆ SELF-CHECK — CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

In an academic essay, which is the best upgrade of "The results show the plan didn't really work"?

- A) The results demonstrate that the plan was largely ineffective.
- B) The results kind of show the plan didn't work out.
- C) The results evidence that the plan's utilization was suboptimal.

2

A friend texts to ask when you're leaving. Which reply has the right register?

- A) I shall commence my departure imminently.
- B) I'll head off in about ten minutes.
- C) I anticipate initiating my egress shortly.

3

An abstract says brief walking breaks "may" improve concentration. Which summary sentence is faithful?

- A) The findings prove that brief walking breaks improve concentration.
- B) The findings suggest that brief walking breaks may improve concentration.
- C) The findings indicate walking breaks is the primary factor of concentration.

◆  I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ replace everyday words with academic ones that fit the exact sense
- ◆ ☐ move an idea across a word family: *analyze* · *analysis* · *analytical*
- ◆ ☐ report a source at the right strength: *suggest*, *indicate*, *argue*, *demonstrate*, *acknowledge*
- ◆ ☐ choose a precise single verb in writing, and keep a natural phrasal verb when it reads better
- ◆ ☐ recognize over-formal English and bring it back down to earth

◆ MY NEW WORDS

Fifteen everyday → academic pairs. Mark each one *sharper* or *just formal*.

◆ MY JOURNAL

Write one sentence about something you (or a colleague, or a news report) concluded this week, in casual English. Rewrite it in academic register. Then

write a deliberately over-formal third version. In one line, explain why the second is better than both the first (for a report) and the third (for anyone).

◆ MODULE 5 – LOOK BACK AT MY GOAL

My goal after Progress Test 1 was: _____

Did I work on it? ☐ Yes ☐ A little ☐ Not yet

Next, I will _____ .

Reading & Writing at C1

Three workshops on the texts that shape decisions. First you take an argument apart: what is claimed, on what evidence, and where the reasoning slips. Then you build one that could survive the same scrutiny. Finally, you put that discipline to work in the documents that represent you professionally: the email, the report and the job application.

Lessons 6.1–6.3

Classes C17–C19

Level C1

Name: _____

HOW THIS MODULE WORKS

Each class is a workshop: you read, draft, test and revise, usually with a partner. Task labels tell you what to do: **Read · Listen · Write · Say · Pair work · Group work**. Every writing genre in this module comes with an annotated model and a rubric, so you always know what "good" looks like before you start.

You never have to argue for a view you actually hold. In the debates and essays you may take the side on your card. In the job-application task you may write as yourself or as one of the professional profiles your teacher provides. Both are equally valid.

◆ READ • SAY — KEY LANGUAGE

Parts of an argument

a claim evidence (uncountable) a warrant a stance a bias loaded / emotive language
 an inference a fallacy a counter-argument a verdict

Types of evidence

statistics / data a research finding expert testimony an anecdote an analogy
 bare assertion (no evidence at all)

Verbs for what a writer does

asserts contends / argues implies concedes / acknowledges downplays dismisses
 overstates refutes / rebuts

◆ LANGUAGE BOX — THE ANATOMY OF AN ARGUMENT

Claim	the point the writer wants you to accept	"The pilot should be made permanent."
Evidence	what is offered in support: data, research, testimony, examples	"Sick days fell by 18 percent."
Warrant	the usually unstated assumption that links the evidence to the claim	"The four-day week, and nothing else, caused the fall."
Weak point	where the evidence is thin, unrepresentative or does not support <i>this</i> claim	Compared with which period? Winter, when people are often ill?

Three questions that never fail: **What exactly is claimed? What is the evidence? Does the evidence support this claim, or a smaller, different one?**

Describing a text precisely	The author contends that... · concedes that... but downplays... · implies (without stating) that... · overstates the significance of... · dismisses the objection that...
Evaluating evidence	The evidence is relevant but thin / anecdotal / selective / outdated / compelling . · The figure suggests a correlation but does not establish cause .

◆ LISTEN • EXERCISE 1 — A RADIO COMMENTARY

Your teacher reads a short commentary from a local radio program. Listen twice, then make notes.

1. The speaker's central claim: _____
2. One piece of evidence and its type: _____
3. A second piece of evidence and its type: _____
4. One weakness in the reasoning (name it): _____
5. The tone in one precise adjective: _____

◆ WRITE • EXERCISE 2 – FACT, OPINION, OR OPINION IN DISGUISE?

Write **F** (a fact: it can be checked), **O** (an openly signaled opinion), or **D** (an opinion dressed in the grammar of fact).

1. Harborview Logistics employs 240 people. _____
2. The pilot ran from January to June. _____
3. The four-day week is clearly the future of work. _____
4. Customer complaints rose by 11 percent during the pilot. _____
5. It is widely accepted that a rested worker is a better worker. _____
6. Profits fell in the second quarter of the year. _____
7. Profits fell because of the four-day week. _____
8. Frankly, the whole experiment was a waste of everyone's time. _____

◆ WRITE • EXERCISE 3 – MATCH THE VERB TO WHAT THE WRITER IS DOING

1. assert	A. mention a point against your own side, then make it seem minor
2. concede	B. present something as bigger or more important than it is
3. downplay	C. state firmly, without offering proof
4. imply	D. show, with reasons, that a claim is wrong
5. refute	E. admit that an opposing point has some truth
6. overstate	F. suggest something without saying it directly
7. dismiss	G. refuse to consider an idea seriously
8. concede ... but downplay	H. make something seem less important than it is

1 _____ 2 _____ 3 _____ 4 _____ 5 _____ 6 _____ 7 _____
 _____ 8 _____

◆ READ – TWO ARTICLES ON ONE DECISION

Harborview Logistics, a regional delivery company, has just finished a six-month trial of a four-day working week. Management must now decide whether to keep it. Two columnists in *Riverside Business Weekly* have taken opposite sides. Both writers, the company and the figures are invented. Read each article twice: once for sense, once with a pen. Sentence numbers are for reference.

ARTICLE A • GIVE US FRIDAY BACK — BY DANA WHITFIELD, WORKPLACE COLUMNIST

¹ Six months ago, Harborview Logistics did something its competitors still consider unthinkable: it gave its 240 employees Fridays off, with no cut in pay. ² The results are in, and they should settle the argument. ³ During the pilot, sick days fell by 18 percent. ⁴ In May, the company's best month, output per employee actually rose by 9 percent. ⁵ Anyone who still believes that more hours automatically mean more work has simply not been paying attention.

⁶ Consider Rosa Delgado, a warehouse supervisor who has worked at Harborview for eleven years. ⁷ "For the first time, I'm not exhausted on Monday," she told me. ⁸ "I spend Fridays with my daughter, and I come back ready to work." ⁹ Stories like hers are everywhere at Harborview. ¹⁰ According to Dr. Amara Osei, an organizational psychologist at Lakeside University, rested employees make significantly fewer errors, a finding that matters enormously in a business where a single mislabeled pallet can cost thousands.

¹¹ Admittedly, customer response times slipped during the pilot. ¹² But this was a minor teething problem, and it will surely disappear as teams adjust.

¹³ Meanwhile, forward-thinking companies across the country are making the switch. ¹⁴ Harborview can either join them or watch its best people walk out the door to employers who already have. ¹⁵ The dinosaurs in the boardroom who want to drag staff back to the grinding five-day treadmill should ask themselves one question: do they want a workforce that is merely present, or one that is genuinely productive? ¹⁶ The answer is obvious. ¹⁷ Give us Friday back — permanently.

ARTICLE B • A LONG WEEKEND IS NOT A BUSINESS PLAN — BY MARTIN KEANE, BUSINESS COMMENTATOR

¹ Harborview Logistics' four-day-week experiment has been a pleasant holiday for some employees. ² For the company's customers, it has been something else entirely. ³ During the six-month pilot, customer complaints rose by 11 percent. ⁴ That figure alone should end the discussion.

⁵ Last month I spoke to the owner of a family bakery that relies on Harborview for its flour deliveries. ⁶ A Friday order arrived on Monday, and she had to close her shop for a day. ⁷ Behind every statistic is a small business like hers, struggling to survive. ⁸ Is a longer weekend for warehouse staff really worth a family's livelihood?

⁹ The supporters of this fashionable gimmick seem to believe that employees should be paid for doing less. ¹⁰ That is not how business works. ¹¹ Profits fell in the second quarter of the pilot, which tells you everything you need to know about where this experiment is heading. ¹² Industry consultant Greg Hollis, who has advised logistics firms for thirty years, calls the four-day week "a luxury that only tech companies can afford."

¹³ Of course, it is true that staff turnover fell during the pilot. ¹⁴ But young workers today will always chase the next perk; loyalty bought with long weekends will not last. ¹⁵ And if Harborview gives in now, where will it end? ¹⁶ Next year it will be a three-day week, and the year after that, the warehouse will be run on goodwill alone. ¹⁷ Harborview's management should end the experiment before the damage becomes permanent.

◆ WRITE • EXERCISE 4 — MAP THE TWO ARGUMENTS

	Article A (Whitfield)	Article B (Keane)
Central claim (sentence no.)	_____	_____
Purpose • stance • tone	_____	_____
Strongest evidence + type	_____	_____
Weakest evidence + why	_____	_____
A concession (sentence no.) and what happens to it	_____	_____
Two loaded phrases	_____	_____
One hidden warrant	_____	_____
Fallacies spotted (name + sentence no.)	_____	_____

◆ WRITE • EXERCISE 5 – TAKE THE LOADING OUT

Rewrite each phrase in neutral language. Then say, in a few words, what judgment the original smuggled in.

1. the dinosaurs in the boardroom → _____
2. this fashionable gimmick → _____
3. drag staff back to the grinding five-day treadmill → _____
4. a pleasant holiday for some employees → _____
5. management slashed customer service → _____
6. so-called experts who disagree → _____

◆ READ • SAY – DIALOGUE: TALKING ABOUT A TEXT, NOT JUST REACTING TO IT

Nadia: So, did Whitfield convince you?

Tomás: Emotionally, yes. Intellectually, I'm less sure. She asserts that the results "settle the argument," but the evidence doesn't quite carry that weight.

Nadia: The 18 percent drop in sick days seems solid enough.

Tomás: It's relevant, certainly. But she never says what it's being compared with. If the comparison is with the winter months, the pilot may simply have coincided with fewer colds.

Nadia: Fair point. And the May figure is the best month, isn't it? That's cherry-picking.

Tomás: Exactly. And notice what she does with the customer problem: she concedes it in one sentence and downplays it in the next. "A minor teething problem" is an assertion, not a finding.

Nadia: To be fair, Keane isn't any better. He dismisses the fall in staff turnover with a sweeping remark about young workers.

Tomás: Agreed. Neither of them is arguing in good faith, really. They're both recruiting readers rather than informing them.

Nadia: So where does that leave the decision?

Tomás: Where it should be: with the full figures, not with either columnist.

Underline every verb that describes what a writer *does*. Which sentence contains Tomás's verdict?

◆ GROUP WORK – THE CRITICAL-READING SEMINAR

In groups of four, each person takes a role card: **Chair**, **Evidence Checker** (who holds the company's full pilot figures), **Devil's Advocate** and **Reporter**. Discuss two questions, which are not the same question:

1. Which article makes the **stronger case**?
2. Which article is **better argued**?

The Reporter presents your group's verdict in four moves. Prepare it here:

1 • Claims	Whitfield contends that... whereas Keane argues that...
------------	---

2 • Evidence	The strongest evidence on either side is... because... However, the full figures show that...
3 • Weaknesses	Both writers rely on... In particular, ... commits a ... when...
4 • Verdict	On balance, we found ... more persuasive, although neither...

◆ READ — MODEL: A CRITICAL EVALUATION (ANNOTATED)

Model text	What it is doing
In "A Long Weekend Is Not a Business Plan," Martin Keane contends that Harborview Logistics should end its four-day-week pilot.	Claim identified in one sentence, with a precise verb (<i>contends</i> , not <i>says</i>).
His purpose is plainly persuasive, and his tone, scornful from the first sentence, where the pilot becomes "a pleasant holiday," signals his stance before any evidence appears.	Purpose, stance and tone , supported with a short quotation.
His strongest evidence is statistical: customer complaints rose by 11 percent. This is relevant, but Keane overstates its weight when he claims it "should end the discussion"; a six-month total can conceal whether a problem is growing or fading.	Evidence evaluated fairly: its strength is acknowledged before its limits.
The rest of the case is weaker. A single bakery's late delivery is an anecdote presented as typical, and the question that follows is an appeal to emotion rather than an argument. Keane also attributes the fall in second-quarter profits to the pilot without considering other causes, a classic false cause. He concedes that turnover fell, yet immediately dismisses the point with an unsupported generalization about "young workers," and he closes with a slippery-slope prediction of a three-day week.	Weaknesses named precisely , each tied to a specific part of the text.
Keane may well be right that customer service needs protecting. However, because his argument depends more on loaded language and speculation than on evidence, it does not, in my view, justify ending the pilot.	Verdict : fair (grants what is right), hedged (<i>may well, in my view</i>), and reasoned (<i>because...</i>).

Notice what the model does *not* do: it never says whether the four-day week is a good idea. It judges the **argument**, not the policy.

◆ RUBRIC – CRITICAL EVALUATION (150–250 WORDS)

Criterion	3 · Strong C1	2 · Secure	1 · Not yet
Claim & purpose	central claim stated precisely in one sentence; purpose, stance and tone identified with evidence	claim identified; purpose or tone mentioned	summarizes the topic rather than the claim
Evidence	evidence evaluated for type, relevance and sufficiency; strengths acknowledged	evidence identified and partly evaluated	evidence listed or repeated, not evaluated
Weaknesses & bias	two or more weaknesses named accurately and anchored in the text	one weakness or bias named with an example	"it is biased" with no example
Verdict & language	fair, hedged, reasoned verdict; precise evaluative verbs; consistent formal register	clear verdict; some evaluative verbs	"I agree / I disagree" only; says, talks about

◆ SELF-CHECK – CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

A writer says: "Since the ban came in, accidents have fallen, so the ban clearly works." Even if the numbers are accurate, what should a critical reader most suspect?

- A) That the accident figures must have been invented
- B) That the sentence uses loaded language
- C) A false cause: the ban preceding the fall does not prove it caused it

2

"The council's reckless plan will devastate our neighborhood." What does the word choice tell a critical reader?

- A) The language is loaded: it signals the writer's stance before any evidence is given
- B) The plan is definitely dangerous, because the writer says so
- C) The sentence is neutral and factual

3

"Remote workers answer emails faster, so remote work makes people more productive." Which is the unstated warrant?

A) Remote workers receive more emails than office workers.

B) Answering emails quickly is a good measure of overall productivity.

C) Some people prefer working in an office.

◆ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ separate a writer's claim from the evidence and judge whether the evidence supports that claim
- ◆ ☐ identify purpose, stance and tone, and point to the words that reveal them
- ◆ ☐ make a hidden warrant visible and test it
- ◆ ☐ name common fallacies (false cause, cherry-picking, false dilemma, straw man, slippery slope...) in a real text
- ◆ ☐ describe a text with precise verbs: *asserts, concedes, downplays, overstates, dismisses*

◆ WRITE — MY NEW WORDS

◆ WRITE — MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Think of an argument you *agree* with. Name one weakness in how it is usually made, and one piece of evidence that would make it stronger.

◆ READ • SAY — KEY LANGUAGE

a thesis (statement) a hook a topic sentence coherence cohesion signposting

to concede to rebut a straw man to synthesize an implication an outline

a reverse outline

Phrases for building and defending a case

This essay will argue that... One clear advantage is... A more serious concern, however, is...

The evidence strongly suggests that... Admittedly, ... Nevertheless, ...

Critics contend that... Yet... This overlooks the fact that...

Taken together, these points indicate... On balance, ... The wider implication is that...

◆ LANGUAGE BOX — THE ARCHITECTURE OF AN ARGUMENT ESSAY

Introduction	Hook → context → thesis. The thesis usually comes last, where it lands with most force.
Body paragraph	PEEL: Point (topic sentence) → Evidence → Explanation (why it supports the point) → Link (back to the thesis). One idea per paragraph.
Counter-argument	Concede → rebut: state the strongest opposing point fairly, then show why your position survives it.
Conclusion	Restate → synthesize → implication. No new points.

Adding	Furthermore • Moreover • What is more	Contrasting	However • By contrast • On the other hand
Result	Consequently • Therefore • As a result	Conceding	Admittedly • Granted • It is true that
Exemplifying	For instance • To illustrate • A case in point	Turning back	Nevertheless • Yet • Even so

A strong thesis is **specific, arguable and defensible**, and it answers the question actually asked. Test: *Could a reasonable person disagree?*

◆ LISTEN • EXERCISE 1 — AN INTRODUCTION, READ ALOUD

Your teacher reads the introduction to an essay on this question: "*Should cities turn underused downtown parking lots into public squares?*" Listen twice.

1. The hook (what kind is it?): _____
2. The context in a few words: _____
3. The thesis (as close to the original as you can): _____

4. Predict the topics of the body paragraphs: _____
5. Which word in the thesis concedes a point to the other side? _____

◆ WRITE • EXERCISE 2 – THESIS CLINIC

Question: "*Should employers give staff paid time for training?*" Diagnose each thesis. Write **T** (only announces a topic), **O** (obvious; nobody would disagree), **F** (sits on the fence), **Q** (answers a different question) or **S** (strong).

1. "This essay is about training at work." _____
2. "Training is important for employees." _____
3. "There are good arguments on both sides of the training debate." _____
4. "Employees in most industries deserve higher salaries." _____
5. "Although paid training time carries short-term costs, employers who offer it gain more skilled and more loyal staff, and should treat it as an investment rather than a perk." _____

Now rewrite two of the weak theses so that they are specific and arguable.

- a. _____
- b. _____

◆ WRITE • EXERCISE 3 – SIGNPOSTING THAT MATCHES THE LOGIC

Choose from: *Furthermore* · *Nevertheless* · *Consequently* · *By contrast* · *Admittedly* · *For instance*. Use each once.

1. Several branches reduced their opening hours. _____, fewer residents used them.
2. Small teams can make decisions in a single meeting. _____, large departments often need weeks of consultation.
3. The course is expensive. _____, most participants say it changed their careers.
4. Flexible hours reduce stress. _____, they help parents manage school schedules.
5. _____, some employees find it hard to switch off at home; yet most say they would not return to the office full-time.
6. Libraries now offer far more than books. _____, many run free job-search workshops.

7. Fix the connector: "The new policy saved the company money. Consequently, some staff disliked it." →

◆ WRITE • EXERCISE 4 – CONCEDE AND REBUT, FAIRLY

Question: "*Should employers give staff paid time for training?*" Writer's position: **yes**. Read the two counter-argument paragraphs. Which one rebuts a **straw man**? Explain in one sentence.

A. Critics contend that paid training is expensive and that trained staff may simply leave for better-paid jobs. Yet the cost of replacing an employee who leaves for lack of development is often far higher than the cost of training one, and staff who are invested in tend to stay longer.

B. Some people think workers should never learn anything new and should do the same job forever. This is obviously wrong, because the world is changing.

The straw man is _____ because _____

Now write your own concession and rebuttal for this question: "*Should phones be collected at the start of team meetings?*" (Take either side.)

Admittedly, _____

Yet / However, this overlooks _____

◆ WRITE • EXERCISE 5 – REBUILD A PEEL PARAGRAPH

Put the sentences in order and label each **P**, **E**, **E** or **L**.

A. This suggests that, for many residents, the library functions less as a book collection than as an employment center.

B. Public libraries also play an increasingly important role in helping people find work.

C. It follows that cutting library budgets may quietly raise the cost of unemployment elsewhere.

D. At the Riverside branch, for instance, more than a third of all computer sessions are spent on job applications, and staff run a weekly résumé clinic.

Order: _____ → _____ → _____ → _____

◆ READ – MODEL ESSAY (ANNOTATED)

Question: "*To what extent should employers limit work email outside working hours?*"

Model text	What it is doing
For many employees, the working day no longer ends when they leave the building; it follows them home in their pocket and chimes at the dinner table. As smartphones have blurred the line between office and home, a growing number of organizations have begun to ask whether after-hours email is a harmless convenience or a hidden cost. While a total ban would be impractical for many businesses, employers	Hook (a vivid image, not "Since the dawn of time...") → context (frames the debate) → thesis : concedes (<i>While a total ban...</i>), commits (<i>should set clear</i>

should set clear limits on out-of-hours email, because doing so protects employee well-being and, perhaps surprisingly, improves the quality of the work itself.	<i>limits</i>) and previews two reasons.
The most compelling reason for limiting after-hours email is its effect on recovery. Studies in occupational health have repeatedly found that employees who cannot mentally detach from work in the evening report poorer sleep and greater exhaustion. This matters because recovery is not a luxury: a worker who never fully switches off arrives each morning with a smaller reserve of energy and patience. Protecting evenings, therefore, is less a perk than a condition of sustainable performance.	P topic sentence · E research evidence · E explanation (<i>This matters because...</i>) · L link back to the thesis (<i>therefore</i>).
A second, less obvious benefit is that limits force clearer communication during the working day. Organizations that have introduced "quiet hours" often report that staff plan ahead, write fuller messages and rely less on last-minute requests. In other words, a boundary on time becomes a discipline on thinking: a question that cannot be fired off at 10 p.m. tends to be asked better at 10 a.m. Far from slowing work down, then, sensible limits can make it more deliberate.	Second reason, same PEEL rhythm. <i>A second, less obvious benefit</i> signposts and references back. Nominalization (<i>a discipline on thinking</i>) gives an academic register.
Admittedly, critics contend that rigid rules ignore the reality of modern work: teams are spread across time zones, and genuine emergencies do not respect office hours. Yet this objection targets a blanket ban rather than the limits proposed here. A policy that allows delayed sending, defines what counts as urgent and gives staff the right not to reply until morning preserves flexibility while removing the expectation of constant availability. It is that expectation, not the occasional late message, that does the damage.	Concede the strongest objection, fairly and in full → rebut it (<i>Yet this objection...</i>) by showing the thesis survives it. No straw man.
Limiting after-hours email, then, is not an attack on flexibility but a defense of the conditions that make good work possible. Better recovery and clearer daytime communication point in the same direction: the costs of constant availability outweigh its convenience. Employers who set sensible boundaries now are likely to find that what they protect is not only their employees' evenings, but their employees' best thinking.	Restate in fresh words → synthesize the two reasons into one judgment → implication (the "so what"). No new evidence.

Test the architecture: read only the first sentence of each paragraph. Do they add up to the thesis?

Mei: Before I say anything, can I check I've understood your thesis? You're arguing that open-plan offices cost more in lost concentration than they save in space.

Karim: Yes, that's it exactly.

Mei: Good, because it comes through very clearly. The strongest sentence, for me, is the one about "renting silence back by the hour" in meeting rooms. That's memorable.

Karim: Thanks. What didn't work?

Mei: I wasn't entirely sure how the second paragraph connects to the thesis. It's about noise, which is fine, but the explanation stops at the evidence. You might consider adding a sentence on why noise matters for the kind of work your company does.

Karim: So you'd suggest finishing the PEEL, basically. What about the counter-argument?

Mei: It's fair, but I'd question the rebuttal. You concede that open-plan offices help new staff learn quickly, and then you just say that isn't important. That reads a little like dismissing it.

Karim: Hmm. Would it work better if I argued that new staff can get the same benefit from structured mentoring?

Mei: That would be much stronger. It answers the real objection instead of waving it away.

Karim: OK. I'll rework both. Thanks, that's genuinely useful.

Find three phrases Mei uses to soften criticism without hiding it. Why does she check the thesis first?

◆ WRITE – WORKSHOP: OUTLINE → DRAFT → PEER REVIEW

Your teacher gives you a question card with an **assigned side** and three evidence notes. You argue the card, not necessarily your own view.

My question: _____ · My side: _____	
Thesis	_____
Body 1 · topic sentence + evidence	_____
Body 2 · topic sentence + evidence	_____
Counter-argument → rebuttal	_____
Conclusion · implication	_____

Draft: your introduction and one full body paragraph (or your counter-argument paragraph).

◆ PAIR WORK – PEER-REVIEW CHECKLIST

Swap drafts. Read your partner's draft twice without commenting. Then complete this checklist for **them**: Y = yes · P = partly · N = not yet.

The thesis in my own words:	_____	
Reverse outline: the one-line point of each paragraph	_____	
The thesis is specific, arguable and answers the question.	Y · P · N	Notes
The introduction moves from hook to context to thesis.	Y · P · N	
Each body paragraph makes one point, stated in its first sentence.	Y · P · N	
Evidence is explained, not just dropped in.	Y · P · N	
The counter-argument is fair (no straw man) and is actually rebutted.	Y · P · N	
Connectors match the logic; not every sentence starts with one.	Y · P · N	
The register is formal and consistent.	Y · P · N	
The strongest sentence:	_____	
One question that would make it stronger:	_____	

Protocol. The reviewer speaks first; the writer listens without defending. The writer then asks one clarifying question. The writer decides what to change: it is their essay.

◆ RUBRIC – ARGUMENT ESSAY (4-5 PARAGRAPHS)

Criterion	3 · Strong C1	2 · Secure	1 · Not yet
Task & thesis	specific, arguable thesis that answers the exact question; position held consistently	clear position, slightly general or drifting	topic announced but no position; or off-question

Organization & cohesion	hook → context → thesis; topic sentences add up to the thesis; purposeful signposting and referencing back	clear paragraphs; some mechanical or mismatched connectors	ideas listed; paragraphs lack a single point
Argument & evidence	evidence explained (PEEL); strongest counter-argument conceded fairly and rebutted; conclusion synthesizes	evidence present, partly explained; counter-argument present but thin	assertions without support; no counter-argument; new points in conclusion
Language	wide academic range (nominalization, hedging); very few errors; formal register throughout	good range; errors rarely obscure meaning	limited range; register slips (<i>stuff, a lot of, I think so</i>)

◆ SELF-CHECK – CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

Which of these is the strongest thesis statement for an argument essay?

A) "This essay will discuss electric cars and their advantages and disadvantages."

B) "Although electric cars are costly upfront, their long-term savings and lower emissions make them the better choice for most drivers."

C) "Electric cars are a type of vehicle that runs on electricity."

2

You are writing your conclusion and think of a strong new piece of evidence. What should you do?

A) Move it into a body paragraph, where it can be developed; the conclusion introduces no new points

B) Add it to the conclusion for a strong finish

C) Leave it out entirely, since the essay is nearly done

3

"Critics argue that paid training is expensive." Which is the strongest rebuttal?

A) "But these critics clearly don't care about workers."

B) "Yet the cost of replacing staff who leave for lack of development is often far higher."

C) "However, training is very important."

◆ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ write a specific, arguable thesis that answers the question asked
- ◆ ☐ open with hook → context → thesis
- ◆ ☐ build a body paragraph with PEEL, explaining my evidence
- ◆ ☐ concede the strongest objection fairly and rebut it
- ◆ ☐ close with restate → synthesize → implication, and no new points
- ◆ ☐ give and receive structured peer feedback that is honest and useful

◆ WRITE — MY NEW WORDS

◆ WRITE — MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

What was the most useful comment you received in peer review? What will you change in your draft because of it?

◆ READ · SAY — KEY LANGUAGE

a subject line a sign-off an attachment findings recommendations a respondent
 a response rate a cover letter a résumé (US) / CV (UK) a job posting a hiring manager
 transferable skills

Professional formulae

I am writing to... I am writing with regard to... Following up on our conversation, ...
 Please find attached... I would be grateful if you could... Could you please confirm...
 Please do not hesitate to contact me. This report examines... It was found that...
 It is recommended that... be... I am particularly drawn to this role because...
 I look forward to hearing from you.

◆ LANGUAGE BOX — FOUR PRINCIPLES, THREE GENRES

Clarity	the reader understands on the first reading: plain words, one idea per sentence
Concision	every word earns its place; no throat-clearing, no filler
Register	formality matches the reader and the relationship
Reader-focus	purpose first; the request or action is easy to find

Email	specific subject line → greeting → purpose in the first sentence → detail and a polite but direct request with a deadline → thanks → sign-off matched to formality
Report	title and memo line → Purpose → Method → Findings (headings, passive, figures) → Conclusions → Recommendations (specific, actionable)
Cover letter	the role and a one-line reason you fit → one or two paragraphs of evidence + relevance → confident, courteous close

American conventions	<i>Dear Ms. Carter</i> , (period after <i>Ms.</i> ; a colon, <i>Dear Ms. Carter:</i> , is very formal) · <i>Sincerely</i> , (formal) · <i>Best regards</i> , / <i>Kind regards</i> , (standard) · <i>résumé</i> , not CV · <i>inquire</i> (UK <i>enquire</i>) · write dates as <i>March 3</i> to avoid 3/3 confusion
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**Report
grammar**

passive for neutral findings (*A survey was distributed*) · nominalization (*a decline in satisfaction*) · subjunctive after *recommend* (*It is recommended that the form **be** replaced*) · active for clear actions (*Team leaders should...*)

◆ LISTEN · EXERCISE 1 – FROM VOICEMAIL TO EMAIL

Your teacher plays the part of your manager, Karen Liu, leaving you a voicemail at Harborview Logistics. Take notes, then write the email she asks for (80–120 words).

Who the email is to: _____

Purpose (one sentence): _____

What they must do, and by when: _____

Other details (date, time, place, copy to): _____

Subject line: _____

◆ WRITE · EXERCISE 2 – THE RIGHT FORMULA

Choose from: *I am writing to inquire* · *Please find attached* · *Following up on our conversation* · *I would be grateful if you could* · *Please do not hesitate to contact me* · *I look forward to hearing from you*.

1. _____ about the Patient Services Coordinator position advertised on your website.
2. _____ my résumé and two letters of reference.
3. _____ on Tuesday, I can now confirm the delivery schedule for next week.
4. _____ send the signed contract by Friday, May 9.
5. If you need any further information, _____
6. Thank you for your time and consideration. _____

◆ WRITE · EXERCISE 3 – REGISTER REPAIR

Each message fails one principle. Name the problem, then rewrite it as clear, purpose-first professional English.

1. *"hey, dunno if u saw but the safety report is due soon, can u sort it?"* (to a manager you have never met)

Problem: _____

2. "I hope this email finds you well. I trust you had a pleasant weekend. I wanted to reach out and touch base about a few things. The main reason I am writing, in the end, is that the invoice from March still hasn't arrived."

Problem: _____

3. "I was just sort of wondering if it might perhaps be possible to maybe take Friday off at some point?"

Problem: _____

4. "I hereby humbly request that you graciously favor me with the honor of a brief meeting at your earliest possible convenience." (to a colleague)

Problem: _____

◆ WRITE • EXERCISE 4 – NOTES INTO REPORT LANGUAGE

Rewrite each note in the objective register of a report. Use the words in brackets.

1. "We sent a survey to everyone." (*distributed*) → _____
2. "Loads of people said the form is really hard." (*majority · respondents*) → _____
3. "It takes ages to get a swap approved, like four days." (*found · average*) → _____
4. "We think you should get rid of the paper form." (*It is recommended that*) → _____
5. "People got annoyed because some teams got approved and others didn't." (*inconsistent · dissatisfaction*)
→ _____

◆ WRITE • EXERCISE 5 – CONFIDENT, NOT BOASTFUL

Label each cover-letter sentence **B** (boastful), **H** (over-humble) or **C** (confident and evidenced). Then rewrite one B and one H sentence as C.

1. "I am an outstanding communicator and a natural leader." _____
2. "I trained twelve new staff members last year, and all of them passed their probation period."

3. "I know I don't have much experience, but I hope I might be suitable." _____
4. "By redesigning our booking system, I reduced patient waiting times by 20 percent." _____
5. "Honestly, I am the best candidate you will ever interview." _____
6. "I'm sorry if my English is not perfect." _____

B → C: _____

H → C: _____

◆ READ – MODEL 1: A PROFESSIONAL EMAIL (ANNOTATED)

Model text	What it is doing
Subject: Request for Q3 overtime figures — staffing report due Friday	Specific subject line: the reader knows the topic <i>and</i> the urgency.
Dear Mr. Nguyen,	Formal greeting for a colleague she has not worked with before.
I am writing to request the overtime figures for the third quarter, which I need to complete the staffing report due this Friday.	Purpose first , plus the reason it matters to the reader.
Could you please send the spreadsheet by the end of the day on Wednesday? If that timeline is difficult, please let me know, and I will adjust my schedule.	Polite and direct request with a clear deadline; offers flexibility.
Thank you for your help. Best regards, Leila Haddad Operations Coordinator, Harborview Logistics	Brief thanks; standard professional sign-off; signature with role.

◆ READ — MODEL 2: A SHORT REPORT (ANNOTATED)

Model text	What it is doing
Staff Views on the Shift-Swap System To: Operations Management Team · From: Leila Haddad, Operations Coordinator · Date: October 14	Informative title; memo line tells the reader who, from whom, when.
1. Purpose This report examines staff satisfaction with the current shift-swap system and recommends improvements.	Aim and scope in one sentence.
2. Method An online survey was distributed to all 240 warehouse staff over two weeks in September; 172 responses were received (a response rate of 72%). Four team leaders were also interviewed.	Credibility: how the information was gathered. Passive keeps the focus on the process.
3. Findings 3.1 Ease of use. A majority of respondents (58%) described the paper swap form as difficult to complete. 3.2 Approval times. Swaps were found to take an average of four days to approve; in one case in five, approval arrived after the shift had begun. 3.3 Fairness. Almost half of respondents (47%) felt that requests were approved inconsistently across teams.	Numbered subheadings make the report navigable . Neutral, figure-based statements; no opinions yet.

4. Conclusions These findings suggest that the current system is slow, is perceived as unfair, and places an unnecessary burden on team leaders.	Interprets the findings, with a hedge (<i>suggest</i>).
5. Recommendations It is recommended that the paper form be replaced with a digital request in the existing scheduling app, that a maximum approval time of 48 hours be introduced, and that the approval criteria be published. A three-month trial in the Receiving team is advised before the system is adopted company-wide.	Specific, actionable steps. Subjunctive after <i>recommended that (be replaced)</i> . A realistic next step.

◆ READ – MODEL 3: A COVER LETTER (ANNOTATED)

Model text	What it is doing
Dear Ms. Carter,	Named reader (find the name if you can; otherwise <i>Dear Hiring Manager</i>).
I am writing to apply for the position of Customer Service Team Lead, advertised on your website. With five years of front-line customer service experience and two years supervising a team of six, I believe I could help your new service center deliver the fast, friendly support your posting describes.	Opening: names the role and where it was seen, then one line of relevance that mirrors the employer's own words.
In my current role at Brightway Appliances, I lead a team that handles around 300 customer calls and emails a day. Last year I introduced a shared troubleshooting guide that reduced repeat calls by 15 percent, and I now train every new hire to use it. Your posting emphasizes coaching, which is the part of my work I value most: two members of my team have since been promoted to senior roles.	Evidence + relevance: concrete achievements with numbers, each tied to what <i>they</i> need. Confident because it is specific, not because of adjectives.
I am also fluent in English and Spanish, which would allow me to support Spanish-speaking customers directly, a need your posting mentions specifically. I am comfortable with ticketing software and recently completed a certificate in conflict resolution.	Transferable skills matched to a stated requirement.
I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my experience could support your team. Thank you for your time and consideration; I look forward to hearing from you. Sincerely, Marisol Vega	Close: forward-looking and courteous, not pleading. <i>Sincerely</i> for a formal letter.

◆ READ • SAY – DIALOGUE: THE READ-ALoud TEST

Ana: Could you listen to this email before I send it? It's to a supplier I've never dealt with.

Joseph: Sure. Go ahead.

Ana: "Dear Mr. Patel, I hope you are well. We have been customers of your company for some time, and we have generally been satisfied. Recently, however, there have been some issues, and I was wondering whether it might be possible to discuss them."

Joseph: It's very polite. But as the reader, I still don't know what you want. What's the actual problem?

Ana: Our last two deliveries were three days late, and I need to know whether the next one will arrive on the 12th.

Joseph: Then say that first. Something like: "I am writing about our last two deliveries, which both arrived three days late. Could you please confirm that our next order will arrive on June 12?"

Ana: Isn't that a bit blunt for a first email?

Joseph: Not at all. It's courteous; it's just clear. The politeness is in "Could you please," not in making him guess.

Ana: Fair enough. Direct isn't rude, and vague isn't polite.

◆ WRITE — WRITING LAB

Part 1 (everyone): the email in Exercise 1.

Part 2 (choose one):

☐ **Report:** use the data card to write the Findings, Conclusions and Recommendations sections, with headings (150–200 words).

☐ **Cover letter:** choose a job posting and write as yourself **or** as a profile card (200–250 words; opening, one or two body paragraphs, close).

My reader: _____ My purpose: _____

Part 3 • Pair work — the reader panel. Swap texts. Your partner reads your text **aloud**, then reacts in role, using a reader card that tells them what this reader really cares about. Listen without defending your text. Then note:

What the reader noticed first: _____

One sentence I will change, and how: _____

◆ RUBRICS — PROFESSIONAL WRITING

Email	3 • Strong C1	2 • Secure	1 • Not yet
Purpose & subject	specific subject line; purpose clear in the first sentence	purpose clear by the second paragraph	purpose buried or missing; vague subject
Request	polite, direct, with a deadline or next step	clear request; deadline vague	over-softened or demanding
Register & conventions	greeting, tone and sign-off perfectly matched to reader	mostly appropriate; one slip	too casual or archaically stiff
Concision & accuracy	no filler; virtually error-free	minor filler or errors	rambling; errors distract

Report	3 • Strong C1	2 • Secure	1 • Not yet
Structure & navigation	informative headings; clear move from findings → conclusions → recommendations	headings present; sections occasionally mixed	continuous prose; opinions inside the findings
Use of data	figures selected and reported accurately and neutrally	figures used; some over-interpretation	data missing, wrong or cherry-picked
Recommendations	specific, actionable, justified by the findings	clear but general	vague ("things should improve")
Register	impersonal; controlled passive, nominalization and <i>recommend that + base verb</i>	mostly objective; some personal slips	chatty or personal throughout

Cover letter	3 • Strong C1	2 • Secure	1 • Not yet
Targeting	names the role; mirrors the posting's stated needs throughout	names the role; some generic content	could be sent to any employer

Evidence + relevance	concrete, quantified achievements, each linked to the employer's needs	relevant experience, few specifics	self-praise adjectives, or a prose résumé
Tone	confident, warm, never boastful or apologetic	mostly balanced	boastful or over-humble
Structure & accuracy	opening · body · close; conventions correct; virtually error-free	clear structure; minor errors	unclear structure; errors distract

◆ SELF-CHECK – CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

You need a colleague to send figures by Friday. Which request is best for professional writing?

- A) "I was just wondering if maybe it might be possible to perhaps get some figures sometime?"
- B) "Send me the figures by Friday."
- C) "I would be grateful if you could send the figures by Friday."

2

Which sentence strikes the right confident-but-not-boastful tone for a cover letter?

- A) "I am an exceptional leader with unrivaled talent and natural brilliance."
- B) "I led a team of four and delivered the project two weeks ahead of schedule."
- C) "I don't really have much experience, but I hope I might just about be suitable."

3

You are writing to a hiring manager, Ms. Carter, for the first time. Which opening and closing suit American business English best?

- A) "Hi Ms. Carter!" ... "Cheers,"
- B) "Dear Ms. Carter," ... "Sincerely,"
- C) "Dear Sir or Madam," ... "Yours faithfully,"

◆ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ write an email that states its purpose in the first sentence and makes a polite but direct request
- ◆ ☐ organize a short report under headings, moving from findings to recommendations

- ◆ ☐ report data objectively with the passive, nominalization and *recommend that... be*
- ◆ ☐ write a cover letter that matches concrete evidence to an employer's needs
- ◆ ☐ adjust register for the reader and test my tone by reading aloud

◆ WRITE — MY NEW WORDS

◆ WRITE — MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Which of the four principles does your own writing most often neglect? Name one habit you will use to fix it.

Listening, Speaking & Delivery

Three workshops on live spoken English. Follow a lecture by its structure and capture it as a map rather than a transcript. Make your own speech easy to follow through stress, pausing and intonation. Then take part in a seminar where you come in, build on other people's ideas, paraphrase, challenge respectfully and help the group reach a conclusion.

Lessons 7.1-7.3

Classes C20-C22

Level C1

Name: _____

BEFORE YOU START

This module is about doing rather than memorizing: listening twice, marking up scripts, speaking, coaching and discussing. You will not catch every word of the lecture, and nobody expects you to. The aim of the pronunciation work is **clear rhythm and melody, not a different accent**. Recording yourself is recommended but always private. When a task is about your life, you decide what to share: your real life, a new identity card or something invented. In the seminar you argue the side printed on your card, which may or may not be your own view.

◆ NEW WORDS — THE LANGUAGE OF TALKS

signposting a preview a digression a recap the upshot a thesis stance
 to hedge to boost (a claim) a cue to cram retrieval the spacing effect
 top-down listening

Signposts you will hear: learn their sound so you catch them at speed.

Today I'll argue that... This talk falls into three parts. That brings me to... A case in point is...
 Crucially, though... I can't stress this enough. As an aside... I won't dwell on...
 To recap... The upshot is...

◆ LANGUAGE BOX — WHAT EACH SIGNPOST TELLS YOU TO DO

Previewing	Today I'll argue that... · This talk falls into three parts.	Draw the map: leave space for each part.
Sequencing	First... · Turning to my second point... · That brings me to... · Finally...	Start a new heading, flush left.
Example	For instance... · A case in point is... · To illustrate... · The research shows...	Indent it and keep it short. Ask: "an example of what?"
Emphasis	The key thing is... · Crucially... · Here's the crucial part...	A main idea: write it in full and star it.
Digression	As an aside... · In passing... · I won't dwell on...	Optional detail: safe to skip.
Recap	To recap... · In short... · The upshot is... · So, to sum up...	The main ideas, distilled: put them at the top of your takeaways.

Cues that let you predict: *It's widely believed that...* → a reversal is coming · *Now, you might think...* → an objection, then the speaker's answer · *So why does this matter?* → a main idea next · *There are two problems with this.* → listen for exactly two.

Stance: hedges (*arguably, to some extent, one explanation is*) make a claim tentative; boosters (*clearly, undeniably, one of the most reliable findings*) show commitment.

→	leads to, causes	=	is, means	∴	therefore
↑ ↓	rise, fall, more, less	≠	is not, differs from	★	the speaker stressed this
b/c	because	w/	with	?	check this later

◆ EXERCISE 1 – NAME THE FUNCTION

Write *preview*, *sequence*, *example*, *emphasis*, *digression* or *recap*.

1. "To sum up, then..." _____
2. "This talk falls into three parts." _____
3. "A case in point is..." _____
4. "I won't dwell on this, but in passing..." _____
5. "Turning to my second reason..." _____
6. "The key thing to remember is..." _____
7. "To illustrate, consider a small bakery in Ohio." _____
8. "The upshot is that early action saves money." _____

◆ EXERCISE 2 – PREDICT WHAT COMES NEXT

What kind of information will follow each cue? Write a few words.

1. "On the one hand, remote work saves commuting time..." → _____
2. "It's often assumed that older learners find languages harder..." → _____
3. "There are two problems with this proposal." → _____
4. "Now, you might think that a longer lunch break lowers productivity..." → _____
5. "So why does any of this matter for ordinary commuters?" → _____

◆ EXERCISE 3 – MAIN IDEA, DETAIL OR ASIDE?

Read this extract from a talk on sleep. Write **M** (main idea), **D** (supporting detail) or **A** (aside) after each sentence.

- (a) The central point I want to make is that sleep is not the opposite of learning; it is part of it. _____
- (b) In one set of experiments, people who slept after practicing a finger-tapping sequence performed it faster the next day than people who stayed awake. _____
- (c) As an aside, I'm told the coffee machine was the hardest-working piece of equipment in the lab.

- (d) Crucially, the brain seems to replay and strengthen new memories while we sleep. _____

- (e) For instance, patterns of brain activity recorded while rats ran through a maze have been observed again while the rats slept. _____
- (f) So the upshot is simple: an all-nighter before an exam may cost you exactly the memories you were trying to build. _____

◆ EXERCISE 4 – FROM SENTENCES TO NOTES

Part A. Read the passage, then complete the notes with one keyword or symbol in each gap.

"Let me make one central point today: remote work is reshaping our cities, not just our offices. First, when people stop commuting daily, demand for downtown apartments falls and prices in commuter towns rise. Second, and this is the part planners overlook, the Main Street shops in those towns are booming, because workers now spend their lunch money close to home. To sum up, the office didn't disappear; it dispersed."

Thesis: remote work reshaping _____, not just offices

Pt 1: less commuting → downtown apt prices _____, commuter-town prices ↑

Pt 2: local Main Street shops _____ (b/c lunch money spent near home)

Recap: office didn't disappear, it _____

Part B. Rewrite each sentence as a note of no more than eight words and symbols.

1. Car-centered design makes walking a chore, and this damages public health. → _____

2. Residents of car-dependent suburbs walk much less than people who live downtown. → _____

3. This is not about individual laziness; it is about design. → _____

4. Wider sidewalks, mixed-use zoning and slower traffic are all tools we already have. → _____

My shorthand: decide on five symbols and five abbreviations, and use them every time.

Symbol					
Means					
Abbreviation					
Means					

◆ EXERCISE 5 – THE LISTENING LAB: "WHY CRAMMING FAILS"

Your teacher will read a five-minute lecture twice. **The first time**, your teacher will stop four times so you can write. **The second time** is at natural speed, with no stops: use a different color to fill the gaps. Take notes on your Cornell sheet or on this page.

Part A — Cornell notes. Write your notes on the right while you listen. After listening, add cue questions on the left and a summary at the bottom.

Cues (add after)	Notes (write while you listen)
Summary (from memory, 1–2 lines)	

Part B — Comprehension. Answer from your notes, not from memory of single words.

1. What is the speaker's thesis? _____
2. What are the three parts of the talk, in order? _____
3. How quickly did Ebbinghaus forget, and what happened each time he reviewed?

4. In the example of the two students, how is the study time organized, and who remembers more a week later? _____
5. What did the two groups do in the 2006 study, and how did the results change between five minutes and one week? _____
6. What is the one thing the speaker asks the audience to remember? _____

Inference. These answers are not stated directly. Discuss them with a partner and note the words that support your answer.

7. Which part of the talk does the speaker value most? Which two phrases tell you?

8. The speaker calls Ebbinghaus's methods "frankly, rather tedious." What is this comment doing, and does it belong in your notes? _____

9. "It's widely believed that the more hours you put in, the more you'll remember, and in one sense, of course, that's true." What is the speaker doing here, and what did you expect to hear next?

10. How certain is the speaker about (a) the spacing effect and (b) the explanation for it? Quote the words.

11. What does "the feeling of fluency is not the same thing as learning" mean? Why does rereading create that feeling? _____

12. What would the speaker probably say to a student who plans to reread her notes five times the night before an exam? _____

Part C — Summary. Write 3–4 sentences: the speaker's claim, the key support, the conclusion. No examples, names or dates.

Useful verbs: *The speaker argues / maintains / concedes / concludes that...*

Peer review. Swap summaries. Tick, then write one "keep" and one "change."

- ☐ the claim is in the first sentence · ☐ the three points are there, in order · ☐ no examples, names or dates ·
☐ the conclusion is the speaker's, not the writer's opinion

Keep: _____ · Change: _____

Lena: Did you get the three parts? I lost her somewhere around the German psychologist.

Omar: Forgetting, spacing, testing. She previewed them right at the start: "This talk falls into three parts."

Lena: Right. And the nonsense syllables? Did you write those down?

Omar: No. She said "as an aside" and "I won't dwell on his methods," so I let it go. What I did star was "the curve isn't fixed."

Lena: Good call. I've got "review → curve flattens" with a question mark. And the two students?

Omar: That's just the example. The point is that *when* you study matters as much as *how long*.

Lena: So the students are the packaging. Was the 2006 study the main idea, then?

Omar: The study's the evidence. The main idea is the one she flagged: "I can't stress this enough: the feeling of fluency isn't the same as learning."

Lena: And the upshot was: study at intervals and test yourself.

Omar: Exactly. Close your notes and see what you can remember. Which is what we should be doing right now, actually.

Underline the four signposts the students quote. Which lines separate a main idea from its example or its evidence?

◆ SPEAKING – PASS THE NOTES (NEXT CLASS)

At the start of the next class you and a partner will each get a **mini-talk card**: a skeleton with a preview, three points and a recap. You give a 90-second talk from the skeleton, using at least five signposts. Your partner takes keyword notes and summarizes your talk back in two sentences. You confirm or correct: "Not quite. My second point was..."

Signposts I will use: _____

◆ SELF-CHECK – CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

A speaker says, "As an aside, I won't dwell on the funding history." What does this signpost tell an advanced listener?

A) It's the most important point: capture every word.

B) It's a recap of what came before.

C) It's a digression: optional detail you can safely skip.

2

What is the single most useful habit when taking notes on a fast lecture?

A) Write keywords in a hierarchy, not full sentences.

B) Try to transcribe every word the speaker says.

C) Write nothing until the recap, then note only that.

3

A lecturer says, "Now, you might think a test is simply a way of measuring what you know." What is most likely to come next?

A) An example of a test the lecturer took.

B) The lecturer's answer to this view, probably showing that it's incomplete.

C) A recap of the whole talk.

◆ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ recognize signposts and say what each one predicts
- ◆ ☐ tell a main idea from an example, and ask "an example of what?"
- ◆ ☐ hear stance: a hedged claim vs a boosted one
- ◆ ☐ take hierarchical notes with stable symbols and abbreviations, on a Cornell page
- ◆ ☐ write a 3–4-sentence summary of a talk and review a partner's summary

◆ MY NEW WORDS

◆ MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Where does your listening usually break down: chasing unknown words, or catching the words but missing the shape? Name one habit from this lesson you'll try next time.

◆ NEW WORDS — TALKING ABOUT SPEECH

prosody

stress-timed

a content word

a function word

a weak form

a thought group

the tonic (syllable)

contrastive stress

a fall · a rise · a fall-rise

uptalk

linking

to shadow

pitch range

◆ LANGUAGE BOX — THE MARK-UP CODE

CAPITALS	a stressed syllable; the tonic (main stress of the group) in bold	I'd LIKE to BOOK a TABLE .
/	a thought-group boundary: a short pause and a small pitch step	When it's ready / I'll let you know.
↘ ↗ ↘ ↗	fall · rise · fall-rise at the end of a group	It's FRIday ↘ ↗ ... in theory.
—	link a final consonant to the next vowel	turn <u>it</u> <u>off</u>

Weak forms are correct, standard pronunciation, not laziness.

to	/tə/	of	/əv/	and	/ən/	for	/fə/
can	/kən/	at	/ət/	was	/wəz/	them	/ðəm/

But *can't* keeps its full vowel: I **/kən/** COME vs I **/kənt/** CAN'T come.

Intonation for attitude

Fall ↘	statements, wh-questions, commands: certain, finished	I live in Chicago ↘. · Where do you work ↘?
Rise ↗	yes/no questions; "there's more coming"	Are you ready ↗? · First ↗, we book; then ↘, we pay.
Fall-rise ↘ ↗	reservation, politeness, an implied "but..."	The food was nice ↘ ↗ ... (but...)

Stress the new, de-stress the given. "Where's the report?" "It's on your **DESK**." The tonic moves to whatever is new or contrasted.

◆ EXERCISE 1 — TAP THE BEATS

Write the stressed syllables in CAPITALS. Then underline two weak forms in each sentence and say it with even beats.

1. I'd like to book a table for two at eight. _____
2. When the meeting finishes, I'll send you the notes. _____
3. The results were better than we expected. _____
4. Could you send me a copy of the report? _____
5. We need to finish the proposal by Friday. _____

◆ EXERCISE 2 – CHOOSE THE STRESSED WORD

Write the **one** word that should carry the main stress.

1. Correcting someone who thought you wanted blue: "No, I wanted the _____ one."
2. Someone asks where the keys are; they're on the table: "They're on the _____."
3. Denying that you were the one who said it: "_____ didn't say that. Someone else did."
4. Insisting it happened today, not yesterday: "It arrived _____, not yesterday."
5. You only hinted at it: "I didn't _____ it. I hinted at it."
6. Someone thinks Anna sent the file, but it was Marco: "No, _____ sent it."

◆ EXERCISE 3 – THOUGHT GROUPS

Mark the natural pauses with /. Then say each sentence with a small pitch step at each pause.

1. If you finish early we can grab a coffee before the train leaves.
2. Honestly I'm not sure but I think it's worth a try.
3. If we can't agree on the budget by Friday we'll have to postpone the launch.
- 4a. The report, which I sent yesterday, covers all three regions.
- 4b. The report which I sent yesterday covers all three regions.

What is the difference in meaning between 4a and 4b, and how does your voice show it?

◆ EXERCISE 4 – STRESS THE NEW

Circle the tonic (the main stress) in each reply. Then practice the pairs aloud.

1. A: What time does the train leave? — B: It leaves at seven.
2. A: Is the meeting in Room 4? — B: No, it's in Room 5.
3. A: Did you enjoy the lecture? — B: I enjoyed the first half.
4. A: You're working late tonight, right? — B: I'm working late tomorrow.

5. A: I hear you're moving to Denver. — B: I'm moving to Dallas.

6. A: Is this your coffee? — B: No, that's my coffee.

◆ EXERCISE 5 – INTONATION FOR ATTITUDE

Part A. Write *falling*, *rising* or *fall-rise*.

1. A confident, complete statement: "I live in Chicago." _____

2. A yes/no question: "Are you ready?" _____

3. Polite reservation with an implied "but": "It was nice..." _____

4. A wh-question: "Where do you work?" _____

5. A list item that isn't the last one: "First..." _____

Part B. Write ↘ or ↗ at the end of each line to match the meaning. Then say it.

6. (You love the plan.) "That's a great idea." _____

7. (You have doubts about the cost.) "That's a great idea..." _____

8. (The hotel was clean, but noisy.) "The hotel was clean..." _____

9. (You are definitely free.) "Yes, I can come on Friday." _____

◆ DIALOGUE FOR SHADOWING – ONE SENTENCE, MANY MEANINGS

Read along as your teacher reads, half a second behind, copying the stress and the arrows. **Bold capitals** = the tonic.

Sam: Wait / you TOLD me to cancel the WHOLE ORder ↗?

Alex: I didn't say you should cancel EVerything ↘. / Just the dupliCATES ↘.

Sam: So you DID want SOME of it canceled ↘ ↗... / I wasn't SURE ↘.

Alex: I didn't decide that ↘, / actually. / MARcus did ↘. / I only PASSED it ON ↘.

Sam: RIGHT ↘. / And is the DEADline still FRIday ↗?

Alex: It's FRIday ↘ ↗... / in THEory.

Sam: UnderSTOOD. / So / cancel the dupliCATES ↗, / keep the REST ↗, / and AIM for FRIday ↘.

Alex: EXactly ↘. / NOW you've GOT it ↘.

Why does Alex stress I and then MARcus? What does the fall-rise on "Friday" tell Sam? Why rise, rise, then fall in Sam's last line?

◆ SPEAKING – THE DELIVERY CLINIC

Work in threes: **speaker**, **coach**, **listener**. Mark up a 60–90-second text, then deliver it. The coach follows your page and ticks the checklist; the listener doesn't look at any page and tells you the main point in one

sentence. Here is the recap of the C20 lecture, already marked up. You may use it, the summary you wrote in C20, or a passage from a talk you heard for homework.

READ ALOUD

So ↗ / to re**CAP** ↘. // We forGET **QUICKly** ↗, / but EVery reVIEW / SLOWS the forGETting **DOWN** ↘. // SPACing your STUDy ↗ / BEATS CRAMming the same NUMBER of HOURS / into ONE **NIGHT** ↘. // And PULLing inforMATION **OUT** of your memory ↗ / does FAR MORE / than PUSHing it **IN** again ↘. // The **UP**shot is ↗ / that the most effECtive LEARNers / aren't necesSARily the ones who study **LONG**est ↘ ↗; / they're the ones who STUDy at the **RIGHT** **I**ntervals ↗ / and TEST themselves a**LONG** the **WAY** ↘.

Coach's checklist for the speaker: _____

☐ content words stressed, small words weak · ☐ pauses at the / marks, not in the middle of a phrase · ☐ statements end with a fall (no uptalk) · ☐ the tonic moves for contrast where marked · ☐ a fall-rise where the text implies "but" · ☐ not rushed

One thing that worked: _____

One thing to change (with a demonstration): _____

Listener's one-sentence main point: _____

◆ **SELF-CHECK – CIRCLE A, B OR C**

1

In the sentence "I'd like to book a table for two," which words should carry the main stress?

A) to, a, for

B) like, book, table, two

C) every word equally

2

You say "It's a great plan..." with a fall-rise (↘↗) on "plan." What are you signaling?

A) Total, enthusiastic agreement with no reservations

B) That you're asking a yes/no question

C) Reservation: an implied "but I have doubts"

3

"Did you send the report on Monday?" You sent it on Tuesday. Which reply puts the tonic in the right place?

A) "No, I SENT it on Tuesday."

B) "No, I sent the REPORT on Tuesday."

C) "No, I sent it on TUESday."

◆ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ stress content words and use weak forms for function words
- ◆ ☐ pause at meaning boundaries and hear how pausing changes meaning
- ◆ ☐ put the tonic on new information and move it for contrast
- ◆ ☐ fall to sound certain, rise for yes/no questions, fall-rise for "but..."
- ◆ ☐ mark up a text, shadow a model and coach a partner on one change

◆ MY NEW WORDS

◆ MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Say "I didn't say she took it" six ways. Which meanings were easy to hear in your own voice? Name one rhythm or melody habit you suspect you bring from another language, and how you'll counter it.

◆ NEW WORDS — MANAGING A DISCUSSION

to come in to hold the floor to hand over to build on (a point) to clarify
 to paraphrase common ground to steer to refocus a facilitator a summarizer
 a challenger a respectful challenge

◆ LANGUAGE BOX — DISCUSSION-MANAGEMENT MOVES

Come in	Could I just come in here? · Can I add something? · Sorry to jump in, but...
Hold the floor	If I could just finish my point... · Just to finish my thought... · Hold on, there's one more thing...
Hand over	What are your thoughts, Priya? · I'd love to hear what you think. · Does anyone see it differently?
Build on	Building on what you said... · To add to that... · That ties in with Tom's earlier point... · I'd take that one step further...
Clarify	Sorry, could you clarify what you mean by...? · When you say X, do you mean...? · Could you give an example?
Paraphrase	So if I understand you correctly, you're saying...? · So your point is that...? · Let me see if I've got this right...
Challenge	acknowledge I take your point about..., → soften but I'm not sure... → challenge ... we've thought through the cost. · Up to a point, yes, but... · I'd question whether... · Isn't there a risk that...?
Common ground	Where we do agree is... · We agree on the goal; it's the method I'd question. · I think we both want the same outcome.
Steer & summarize	Could we come back to the main question? · Shall we move on? · So where does that leave us? · So, to sum up where we are, ...

Say it with the right melody. A paraphrase ends with a rise (it's a real question). An acknowledgment takes a fall-rise ("I take your **point** ↘ ↗..."). The challenge itself falls, calmly.

◆ EXERCISE 1 — COMPLETE THE PHRASE

- Coming in politely: "Could I just come _____ here?"
- Holding the floor: "If I could just _____ my point..."

3. Building on an idea: "_____ on what you said..."
4. Paraphrasing to check: "So if I _____ you correctly..."
5. Disagreeing constructively: "I take your _____, but..."
6. Steering to a decision: "So where does that _____ us?"

◆ EXERCISE 2 – COMPLETE THE EXCHANGE

Use: *come in · finish · thoughts · correctly · agree · move.*

A: "...and so I think we should delay. Could I just _____? There's one more reason."

B: "Sorry, could I just _____ here? I see it differently."

A: "Of course. What are your _____, then?"

B: "Well, so if I understand you _____, you're worried about the timing?"

A: "Exactly. Where we do _____ is that it needs doing."

B: "Right. Shall we _____ on to how?"

◆ EXERCISE 3 – SOFTEN THE BLUNT DISAGREEMENT

Rewrite each line using **acknowledge → soften → challenge**. Keep the same view: be firm about the idea and warm toward the person.

1. "No, that's wrong. Remote work kills productivity." _____
2. "That idea will never work." _____
3. "I completely disagree with cutting the budget." _____
4. "That's not what the reading says." _____
5. "Nobody takes notes on paper anymore." _____

◆ DIALOGUE – A SEMINAR IN ACTION

A team discusses whether to switch to a four-day week.

1 Dana: I think a four-day week would boost productivity. People work better when they're rested. What are your thoughts, Ben?

2 Ben: Building on what you said, there's real evidence for that: several trials found output holding steady on four days. To add to that, it's a huge draw for hiring.

3 Priya: Could I just come in here? I take your point about productivity, but I'd question whether it works for a client-facing team. We can't just close on Fridays.

4 Dana: So if I understand you correctly, your worry is coverage: clients expecting us five days a week?

5 Priya: Exactly. That's my main concern.

6 Marco: If I could just add something: we could stagger the days off, so someone's always in. That ties in with Priya's point: it keeps coverage and gives everyone the shorter week.

7 Priya: Up to a point, yes, but staggering means we're never all in on the same day. Isn't there a risk that collaboration suffers?

8 Dana: That's fair. Where we do agree, though, is that the shorter week is worth trying. It's the logistics we're split on.

9 Marco: So where does that leave us? Maybe we trial it for two months and measure both output and coverage?

10 Dana: So, to sum up, we broadly agree on trialing a four-day week, staggered, with a review after two months. Shall we move on to who'd own the trial?

◆ EXERCISE 4 – NAME THE MOVE

Write the move(s) in each numbered line of the dialogue: *hand over · build on · come in · acknowledge + challenge · paraphrase · confirm · link two ideas · partial agreement · common ground · steer · summarize · move on.*

1 _____ · 2 _____

3 _____ · 4 _____

5 _____ · 6 _____

7 _____ · 8 _____

9 _____ · 10 _____

Priya disagrees twice. Why does the discussion never turn sour? _____

◆ EXERCISE 5 – PARAPHRASE TO CHECK

Paraphrase each view, beginning *So if I understand you correctly, ...* or *So your point is that...*, and end with a rise.

1. "Phones in meetings are a distraction, but banning them treats adults like children."

2. "Portfolios are fairer than final exams, but they take teachers far longer to grade."

3. "Closing Main Street to cars sounds lovely, but the shops there depend on drivers who stop on the way home." _____

◆ SPEAKING – THE SEMINAR

Your group will discuss **one reading card** for 12 minutes. Everyone has a role, and everyone has four **move cards**. Each time you use a move, put that card face up. When all your cards are down, you may only speak to hand over to someone else.

Facilitator	opens with the question; hands over by name; keeps time; refocuses the group
Summarizer	tracks each person's key point; summarizes at half time and at the end
Challenger	tests claims on both sides; acknowledges before every challenge
Contributors	argue the side printed on their card
Observer	doesn't speak; tallies moves; gives feedback at the end

My preparation. Reading: _____ · My role: _____ · My side (if any):

Two points I can make: _____

One question for the other side: _____

My four moves: _____ · _____ · _____ · _____

Self-review (after the seminar). Which moves did I use? Which felt natural and which felt forced? Where did I go quiet, or sound more direct than I intended?

◆ SELF-CHECK – CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

A colleague is mid-sentence and you have something to add. What's the most appropriate way to take a turn?

- A) "Sorry, could I just come in here?"
- B) Start talking loudly over them until they stop.
- C) Say nothing and let the moment pass.

2

You strongly disagree with someone's proposal. Which opening keeps the disagreement constructive?

- A) "No, that's completely wrong."
- B) "I take your point, but I'm not sure we've thought through the cost..."
- C) "Sure, whatever you think is best."

3

You are the facilitator. Omar has spoken for three minutes; two people haven't spoken yet. What do you say?

- A) "Omar, please stop talking now."
- B) "Thanks, Omar, that's really useful. I'd love to hear from someone who hasn't come in yet. Lena?"
- C) Nothing. The facilitator shouldn't interrupt.

◆ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ come in politely, hold the floor and hand over by name
- ◆ ☐ build on someone's point by naming it before I extend it
- ◆ ☐ ask for clarification and paraphrase to check understanding
- ◆ ☐ challenge respectfully: acknowledge → soften → challenge
- ◆ ☐ steer and summarize, and take a seminar role: facilitator, summarizer or challenger

◆ MY NEW WORDS

◆ MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Which discussion move do you already do well, and which do you tend to skip? Choose one phrase to make your own this week, and say where you'll use it.

Fluency, Craft & the Final Project

The last module of C1 asks for two opposite disciplines and then combines them. Keep talking when a word, an idea or a sentence lets you down. Go back over what you have written and cut everything that does not earn its place. Then write a short, sharp position paper and defend it, calmly, against questions you did not see coming.

Lessons 8.1–8.3

Classes C23–C25

Level C1

Name: _____

ICONS

Write · Listen · Say · Work with a partner · Read

When a task touches on your own life, you decide what to share: your real experience, a new identity card, or something invented are all equally valid. In the position paper you may argue a side you drew rather than chose; examiners question your *argument*, never you. You can always say "Pass."

◆ NEW WORDS — THE FLUENCY TOOLKIT

Fluency at C1 is not speed. It is the ability to keep going coherently while your mind is still working. These phrases fill a pause with meaning instead of silence.

Buying time

That's a good question...

Let me think for a second...

Well, it depends...

How can I put this?

The way I see it...

If you ask me...

Bear with me a moment...

Talking around a word (circumlocution)

it's a kind of...

the thing you use to...

it's like..., but...

the person who...

it's when / it's where...

what's the word...?

the, oh, whatever it's called...

Repairing on the move

or rather...

or should I say...

what I mean is...

let me rephrase that

to put it another way...

◆ STRATEGY BOX

When this happens...	Do this	For example
A hard or unexpected question	Buy time with a phrase that carries meaning, then pause calmly.	"That's a good question. I'd say it comes down to trust."
A word will not come	Describe it: category, function, comparison, role or situation.	"It's the thing you use to measure temperature." (thermometer)
A sentence goes wrong	Repair it lightly and keep going. No apology, no restart.	"We arrived on Tuesday, or rather, Wednesday, and..."
You reach for a filler	Keep it only if it does a job; otherwise use a silent beat.	"Well, I actually think we should wait." (two markers, both useful)

A filler with a job: *well* opens a turn · *actually* flags a surprise or mild correction · *I mean* introduces a clarification · *you know* invites shared feeling · *sort of* marks an honest approximation. **A filler that is a tic:** the same word in every clause, doing nothing.

◆ EXERCISE 1 — FREEZE OR FLOW?

Your teacher reads two answers to the same interview question: "What's the biggest challenge in your job right now?" Both speakers hit the same three walls. Write what **Speaker 2** does at each one.

Wall	Speaker 1 (freezes)	Speaker 2 (keeps going): what she says
1 · the question is hard	"Um... [silence]..."	_____
2 · a word is missing	"How do you say...? Sorry."	_____
3 · a detail is wrong	"No, wait, sorry, that's wrong..."	_____

Who was faster? Who sounded more fluent? Why?

◆ EXERCISE 2 – CHOOSE THE STRATEGY PHRASE

Choose from: *that's a good question* · *or rather* · *it depends* · *the thing you use to* · *what I mean is* · *let me think* · *how can I put this* · *the person who*. Use each once.

- "Which is better, remote or office work?" "Well, _____ on the kind of job, honestly."
- "Why did you leave your last role?" "_____. Let me put it this way..."
- "I need the, um, _____ measure temperature."
- "It happened in June, _____ July, I think."
- "So the point is... _____ we can't afford to wait."
- "Give me a moment. _____ about how to phrase it."
- "We need someone to check the contract, you know, _____ deals with legal questions for the company."
- "Was the meeting a success?" "Hmm, _____? It was productive, but not exactly pleasant."

◆ EXERCISE 3 – TALK AROUND IT

Imagine you have forgotten each word. Write a circumlocution with a **different frame** each time, then say it to a partner, who names the word.



remote control



wardrobe



mechanic



umbrella

- remote control: _____
- wardrobe: _____
- mechanic: _____
- umbrella: _____
- a receipt: _____

6. a commute: _____

7. a landlord: _____

8. a deadline: _____

◆ EXERCISE 4 – CLUMSY REPAIR → SMOOTH REPAIR

Rewrite each clumsy repair so that it holds the flow. Keep the corrected information.

1. "The store opens at nine. No, wait, sorry, I'm wrong, sorry, it's ten."

2. "There were about fifty people. Sorry, that's not right. Um. Maybe eighty? Sorry."

3. "The new system is cheaper. No, sorry, it's not cheaper, I mean... it's faster. Sorry."

4. "She's the manager of the, how do you say, sorry, I don't know the word, the money department."

◆ EXERCISE 5 – THE FILLER AUDIT

Your teacher reads this answer at natural speed. First, **listen** and tally every filler you hear: _____.

Then **read** it and cross out every filler that does no job. Keep a maximum of **two** that do a real job, and be ready to say what job.

READ ALOUD

So, um, basically I think that, like, working from home is, you know, sort of good, actually, because, um, you don't have to, like, commute and stuff. I mean, it's, you know, basically really nice to, um, have, like, more time. But, actually, I sort of miss, you know, my colleagues, like, sometimes, I mean, not always, but, um, yeah.

Now write a clean version (about 30 words) that says the same thing:

◆ DIALOGUE – A HARD QUESTION, HANDLED WELL

Interviewer: So, what would you say is the single biggest challenge facing your industry right now?

Maya: Hmm, that's a really good question. Let me think for a second... Well, it depends on how you look at it, but I'd say it comes down to, how can I put this, trust.

Interviewer: Trust in what sense?

Maya: Trust in the, um, what's the word, the whole system that checks whether information is accurate. You know, the process you use to verify a source. Fact-checking, essentially. Or rather, the lack of it.

Interviewer: And is that getting worse?

Maya: It's... well, it's sort of a mixed picture. I mean, the tools are better than ever, but so are the, let me rephrase that, the people trying to game them. To put it another way: we're in an arms race.

Interviewer: That's a striking way to put it.

Maya: Bear with me a second; I want to get this right. The way I see it, the technology isn't the problem. It's a kind of... trust gap. And you can't patch that with software.

Underline every strategy Maya uses. Label each one: **T** (buying time), **C** (circumlocution), **R** (repair), **M** (a marker with a job).

Read the dialogue in pairs twice, swapping roles. The second time, the interviewer asks one new follow-up question and "Maya" answers it with a time-buyer.

◆ SPEAKING – IMPROMPTU TALKS

Groups of three: **speaker**, **timekeeper** and **strategy spotter**. Draw a topic card, take **15 seconds** to think (three key words at most), then talk for **one minute** without freezing, restarting or apologizing. The timekeeper then asks one follow-up question. Rotate roles every turn.

Strategy checklist: the spotter tallies, and you add your own notes afterwards.

Round	Topic	Bought time	Talked around a word	Smooth repairs	Silences / restarts
1 · Warm-up					
2 · Opinion					
3 · Stretch + curveball					

A filler I use a lot: _____ What I will use instead: _____

◆ SELF-CHECK – CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

At C1, the best definition of spoken fluency is:

A) speaking as fast as possible without pausing

B) keeping going coherently, even while you think

C) never pausing at any point

2

You can't remember the word "corkscrew" mid-sentence. The most fluent response is to:

A) stop and say "sorry, I don't know the word"

B) go silent until it comes to you

C) describe it: "the thing you use to open a wine bottle"

3

Which is the smoothest self-correction?

A) "The meeting is on Thursday, or rather, Friday, so we have an extra day."

B) "The meeting is on Thursday. Sorry, sorry, no. Friday. Sorry."

C) "The meeting is on... I don't know how to say. Friday, I think."

◆ ☒ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ explain why fluency means continuity, not speed
- ◆ ☐ buy thinking time with a phrase that carries meaning
- ◆ ☐ keep the markers that do a job and cut the ones that don't
- ◆ ☐ describe a word I can't reach, so the sentence doesn't stop
- ◆ ☐ repair a mistake on the move with *or rather* or *what I mean is*
- ◆ ☐ talk for a full minute on a topic I didn't choose

◆ MY NEW WORDS

◆ MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Which strategy rescued you most often in today's talks, and which filler habit will you work on this week?

◆ NEW WORDS — THE EDITOR'S VOCABULARY

concise

wordy

padding

redundancy

an intensifier

a buried verb

a light verb (make, have, give, carry out)

to trim · to tighten

a first draft · to redraft

a double negative

The editor's questions: ask them of every sentence you write.

Can I say this in fewer words?

Which phrase is padding?

Is this intensifier earning its place?

Is there a verb hiding in that noun?

Does the reader already know this?

Would a period be clearer than this comma?

Read it aloud: where do I run out of breath?

◆ GRAMMAR BOX — FOUR CUTS

1 · Wordy phrase → lean phrase

in order to → to	due to the fact that → because	at this point in time → now
in the event that → if	a large number of → many	has the ability to → can
in spite of the fact that → although	with regard to → about	in the near future → soon

Redundant pairs: keep the word that carries the meaning: ~~end~~ result · ~~free~~ gift · ~~past~~ history · ~~advance~~ planning · each ~~and every~~ · ~~completely~~ eliminate.

2 · Empty intensifier → one precise word

very tired → exhausted	really important → crucial / vital	very surprised → astonished
very big → huge / vast	very good → excellent	very bad → terrible / dire

Cut *basically, just, really, quite, actually* when the sentence means the same without them. Keep an intensifier that adds **real emphasis** (*I'm absolutely certain*) or a **precise degree** (*slightly undercooked*).

3 · Noun + light verb → strong verb

make a decision → decide	reach a conclusion → conclude	carry out an investigation of → investigate
give consideration to → consider	have a discussion about → discuss	make an improvement to → improve

This is the reverse of **nominalization** (Lesson 3.1). Neither is wrong: **strong verbs** for clear, direct writing (emails, summaries, arguments); **nominalization** for formal, impersonal density (reports, legal texts). Match the tool to the goal.

4 • Untangle: *It is not uncommon* → **It is common** · *not without merit* → **has some merit**. If you can't read a sentence aloud in one breath and remember how it began, split it or put the main idea first.

◆ EXERCISE 1 – TIGHTEN THE WORDY PHRASE

One word each, unless a note says otherwise.

1. in order to → _____
2. due to the fact that → _____
3. at this point in time → _____
4. completely eliminate → _____
5. make a decision → _____
6. has the ability to → _____
7. very important → _____ (one strong adjective)
8. reach a conclusion → _____
9. in spite of the fact that → _____
10. in the near future → _____

◆ EXERCISE 2 – CUT THE REDUNDANT WORD

Write each phrase without its unnecessary word.

1. free gift → _____
2. end result → _____
3. past history → _____
4. advance planning → _____
5. each and every → _____
6. close proximity → _____
7. final outcome → _____
8. join together → _____

◆ EXERCISE 3 – UPGRADE, CUT, OR KEEP?

Items 1–6: replace the intensifier + adjective with one precise word. Items 7–10: write **CUT** (and the shorter sentence) or **KEEP** (and why).

1. The team was very tired after the audit. _____
2. They live in a really big house. _____
3. We were very surprised by the results. _____
4. The damage from the storm was really bad. _____
5. After the hike, we were very hungry. _____
6. The kitchen was very clean when the inspector arrived. _____
7. "It's basically just a really simple change, actually." _____
8. "I'm absolutely certain I locked the door." _____
9. "The chicken was slightly undercooked." _____
10. "We were quite really pleased with the very good feedback." _____

◆ EXERCISE 4 – DIG OUT THE VERB

Rewrite each sentence with a strong verb. Keep the tense.

1. The committee will carry out a review of the proposal. _____
2. We had a discussion about the budget on Monday. _____
3. The manager gave an explanation of the new policy. _____
4. The volunteers provided assistance to the new families. _____
5. The council has made an improvement to the bus service. _____
6. We need to give consideration to all the options before we make a decision. _____

In which kind of document might the *original* version of sentence 1 be the better choice?

◆ EXERCISE 5 – UNTANGLE IT

1–3: say it positively and simply. 4: split it into two clear sentences.

1. It is not uncommon for delays to occur in the event that staff are absent.

2. Her proposal is not unlike the one we rejected last year.

3. It is not impossible that the results were not entirely inaccurate.

4. The report, which was written by the team that had been assembled in order to look into the matter that had been raised at the previous meeting, was well received.

◆ DIALOGUE – IN THE EDITING ROOM

Editor: Read me your opening line as it stands.

Writer: "Due to the fact that we are currently at a point where costs are very high, we have made the decision to carry out a review of our spending."

Editor: Right. First, "due to the fact that" is just "because." And "we are currently at a point where"? Cut it.

Writer: So: "Because costs are very high, we have made the decision to carry out a review of our spending."

Editor: Better. Now, "very high": is there one word for that? And there are two verbs hiding in nouns.

Writer: "Very high" could be "soaring." "Made the decision to" is "decided," and "carry out a review of" is "review."

Editor: Say the whole thing now.

Writer: "Because costs are soaring, we have decided to review our spending." Eleven words instead of twenty-nine, and it hits harder.

Editor: That's the craft. You didn't lose a single idea; you lost the padding around them.

Name the four cuts the editor asks for: _____

◆ WRITING — THE 30% CUT CHALLENGE

In a group of three, edit your text (A, B, C or D). Cut **at least 30%** and lose **no idea**: every fact, number, name and source stays. Roles: **editor** (holds the pen), **word-counter**, **meaning-keeper** (can veto any cut that loses meaning).

Our text	_____	Words before	_____	Target (70%)	_____
Words after	_____	Percent cut	_____	Ideas lost	0 ✓

Our final version:

The cut we're proudest of, and its name: _____

A word or phrase we decided **not** to cut, and why: _____

◆ SELF-CHECK — CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

Which is the most concise rewrite of "We will make a decision at this point in time"?

- A) We will decide now.
- B) We will make a decision at the present time.
- C) We will proceed in order to arrive at a decision now.

2

You're drafting a formal legal clause that needs impersonal, abstract density. When is nominalization the right move rather than strong verbs?

- A) When the genre calls for formal, impersonal abstraction: match the tool to the goal
- B) Never: strong verbs are always better than nouns
- C) Always: nominalization is more correct than plain verbs

3

Which is the best edit of "Due to the fact that a large number of staff were absent, we made the decision to postpone the review"?

- A) Due to many staff being absent, a decision was made to postpone.
- B) Staff absent, review postponed.
- C) Because many staff were absent, we postponed the review.

◆ ☒ I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ swap wordy stock phrases for lean ones and cut redundant pairs
- ◆ ☐ replace "very + adjective" with one precise word, and keep intensifiers that earn their place
- ◆ ☐ dig a strong verb out of a noun, and say when nominalization is still the right choice
- ◆ ☐ untangle double negatives and overloaded sentences
- ◆ ☐ cut a text by 30% without losing any idea

◆ MY NEW WORDS

◆ MY JOURNAL (2 SENTENCES)

Which kind of padding (wordy phrases, empty intensifiers or buried verbs) do you personally

overuse, and in what kind of writing?

YOUR PROJECT TIMELINE

End of C23: choose or draw a topic card (and a side card, if you prefer an assigned position). · **Before C24:** fill in the planning frame below (notes only). · **C24:** a partner checks your frame. · **After C24:** write a first draft, then edit it to **about 500 words (450–550)**; send it to your viva group the evening before C25. · **C25:** read two papers, prepare questions, then defend your own paper. · **After C25:** hand in your paper with the self-check.

◆ WHAT A POSITION PAPER IS – SIX PARTS

A position paper takes a clear stand on a debatable question and argues for it with reasons and evidence. It is not a neutral survey of views, and it is not a personal outburst. Its signature move is the counter-argument: you state the strongest objection fairly, then answer it.

Part	Job	Typical language
1 · Thesis	state your position clearly and early	This paper argues that... · It will be contended that...
2 · Argument A	your first supported reason	The primary reason is... · Research suggests that...
3 · Argument B	a second reason, linked to the first	Furthermore, ... · A related consideration is...
4 · Counter-argument	the strongest objection, stated fairly	Admittedly, ... · It might be objected that...
5 · Rebuttal	why your position still holds	This concern, while valid, overlooks... · However, ...
6 · Conclusion	restate the position, sharpened	On balance, ... · The weight of evidence therefore suggests...

Language for the defense

If I've understood your question, you're asking whether...

That's a fair point, and I don't want to brush it aside.

You're right that...

To some extent, yes; that said, ...

I take your point, but I'd still argue that...

So I'd put it slightly more cautiously: ...

Let me come at that from another angle.

The weight of evidence points to...

◆ EXERCISE 1 – LISTEN TO A DEFENSE

Your teacher reads Priya's opening and the questions she faces. Answer in note form.

1. What is Priya's thesis? _____
2. Which objection does she include in her paper, and how does she answer it? _____
3. How does she handle the question about residents with disabilities and older people?

4. What does Questioner 2 challenge? _____
5. How does Priya change her claim, without abandoning her position? _____
6. What does she do first with Questioner 3's long question, and what does she propose?

◆ EXERCISE 2 – READ A MODEL PAPER

Read the paper. Then (a) write the part number (1–6) in the margin next to each paragraph; (b) underline **three hedges**; (c) find one example of each tool: a participle clause, an inversion, a conditional, a cleft or fronting for emphasis, and an academic collocation.

LATER BELLS, BETTER LEARNING: WHY HIGH SCHOOLS SHOULD START AT 9 A.M.

Across much of the country, the high-school day begins at around 7:30 a.m., a timetable designed more for adult convenience than for adolescent biology. This paper argues that high schools should start no earlier than 9 a.m. Not only would a later start protect students' health, but it would also improve the quality of their learning.

The primary reason is biological. Sleep researchers broadly agree that during adolescence the body clock shifts: teenagers begin to feel sleepy up to two hours later than they did as children, yet they still need eight to ten hours of sleep. Given this shift, a student who must wake at 6 a.m. is, in effect, being asked to function in the middle of their biological night. The consequences of chronic sleep loss are well documented: lower mood, weaker concentration and, among newly licensed drivers, a higher risk of accidents on the way to school. It is for this reason that leading pediatric organizations have recommended that no middle or high school begin before 8:30 a.m.; this paper simply goes half an hour further.

A related consideration is academic performance. Schools that have moved their start time later have generally reported better attendance and punctuality, and some studies suggest modest gains in grades, particularly in first-period classes. This is hardly surprising, since a rested brain retains new information far more effectively than an exhausted one. Were the school day aligned with students' sleep patterns, teachers would spend less time repeating material and more time extending it. Nor would the benefit be evenly spread: it is typically students with the longest commutes, often those from lower-income families, who lose the most sleep and would gain the most.

Admittedly, it might be objected that a later start would disrupt family routines. Parents who begin work early may be unable to drop their children off, bus companies would have to redesign their routes, and after-school commitments, from sports practice to part-time jobs, would finish later in the evening.

These concerns, while valid, are practical rather than fundamental, and practical problems invite practical solutions. Schools could open their doors at 7:30 a.m. for a supervised breakfast and quiet study, so that no student is left waiting outside, and several districts that have made the change have reorganized their bus schedules within a single year. Moreover, the cost of adjusting a timetable is paid once, whereas the benefits of better-rested students recur every school day.

On balance, then, the weight of evidence points in one direction. A modest change to the timetable, one that asks adults to adapt rather than asking teenagers to fight their own biology, would appear to offer a rare combination of low cost and high return. Rarely does a single decision promise to improve health, safety and learning at the same time. High schools should seize that opportunity and move the first bell to 9 a.m.

You are an examiner. Write the **hardest fair question** you could ask this writer: _____

◆ EXERCISE 3 – THE THESIS TEST

A good thesis is **arguable** (reasonable people could disagree), **clear** and **specific**. Mark each one ✓ or ✗. If ✗, say what is wrong: *a fact · too vague · a survey, not a position · an outburst*.

1. "This paper argues that companies with office jobs should adopt a four-day week without reducing pay." _____
2. "Smartphones were first sold in large numbers in the late 2000s." _____
3. "There are many different views on homework, and all of them have good and bad points." _____
4. "Technology is sort of changing things in education, in some ways." _____
5. "Cashless stores are a ridiculous idea that only lazy people could support." _____
6. "Secondary schools should replace final exams with portfolios assessed over the whole year." _____

Rewrite one ✗ thesis so that it passes the test: _____

◆ EXERCISE 4 – MIXED C1 REVIEW

Complete each gap. The hint in brackets tells you which C1 tool you need.

1. _____ the scale of the problem, action is overdue. (participle clause, one word)
2. The policy poses a serious threat _____ small businesses. (dependent preposition)
3. Research _____ that foot traffic tends to rise. (academic reporting verb)
4. The costs are high; _____, the benefits recur every year. (contrast linker)
5. It would _____ that the evidence supports the change. (hedging)
6. Not only is it costly, _____ it is also unfair. (inversion)
7. _____ the plan adopted, costs would fall sharply. (conditional without *if*)
8. _____ really matters is not the price but the long-term value. (cleft sentence)
9. "Due to the fact that" → _____ the evidence is clear, we should act. (concision, one word)
10. The committee will "make a decision" → _____ next week. (strong verb)

◆ EXERCISE 5 – CONCEDE WITHOUT COLLAPSING

For each challenge, circle the **poised** response: it concedes what is fair and holds what is sound.

1. "Wouldn't a four-day week just push the same work into four longer days?"
 - A) "Yes, you're right. It probably wouldn't work, then."
 - B) "That's a fair concern, and in some jobs it would. That said, the trials I cite measured output, not hours, and output held steady."
 - C) "No. That's simply not true."
2. "Your evidence comes from very large companies. Does it apply to small ones?"
 - A) "To some extent, no; my examples are mostly large firms. So I'd put it more cautiously: the case is strongest for organizations with fifty or more staff."

B) "It applies to everyone."

C) "I don't know. Maybe my paper is wrong."

3. "Isn't this just too expensive?"

A) "Money isn't important."

B) "It is expensive, I admit. So my idea is bad."

C) "I take your point about cost. However, the cost is paid once, whereas the savings recur every year, which is why I'd still argue for it."

Now write a poised answer to this challenge to **your own** paper: "What's the strongest argument against your position, and why doesn't it win?"

◆ PLANNING FRAME – MY POSITION PAPER

My question (topic card)	_____
My position	☐ my own choice ☐ an assigned side (card) → _____
1 • Thesis (one sentence)	This paper argues that _____
2 • Argument A	Reason: _____ Support (evidence, example, consequence): _____
3 • Argument B	Reason: _____ Support: _____
(optional) Argument C	_____
4 • The strongest objection	It might be objected that _____ Would someone on the other side really say this? ☐ yes
5 • My rebuttal	This concern, while valid, _____
6 • Conclusion	On balance, _____
C1 tools I plan to use	☐ hedging ☐ participle / absolute clause ☐ inversion or cleft ☐ conditional ☐ nominalization + cohesion ☐ academic collocation
Partner's question (C24)	_____

◆ BEFORE YOU SEND YOUR PAPER – THE SELF-EDIT CHECKLIST

- ◆ ☐ My thesis is in the first paragraph, and a reasonable person could disagree with it.
- ◆ ☐ Each argument has a reason **and** support; each claim is hedged as strongly as the evidence allows, no more.
- ◆ ☐ The objection is one the other side would really make, and my rebuttal answers *that* objection.
- ◆ ☐ Each paragraph has a topic sentence, and linkers and reference words (*this, such, these concerns*) connect the paragraphs.
- ◆ ☐ I ran the four cuts from 8.2: wordy phrases, empty intensifiers, buried verbs, tangles.
- ◆ ☐ I read it aloud and split every sentence where I ran out of breath.
- ◆ ☐ Words in my first draft: _____ · Words now: _____ (target 450–550)
- ◆ ☐ One spelling system (American or British), used consistently.

◆ DEFENSE PREP – PREDICT YOUR QUESTIONS

Write the three questions you most fear, and a first move for each: concede what is fair, then hold with a reason.

The question I fear	What I can concede	How I hold my position

My opening statement in four key words: _____ · _____ · _____ · _____

◆ RUBRIC SELF-CHECK – CIRCLE ONE LEVEL FOR EACH

The paper	★★★	★★	★
1 · Position & thesis	clear, early, arguable	clear but late or broad	unclear, or a survey
2 · Arguments & support	2–3, each well supported	support thin in places	opinions without support
3 · Counter-argument & rebuttal	real objection, answered well	objection weak or answer thin	missing or a straw man
4 · Organization & cohesion	logical, smoothly linked	mostly clear	hard to follow
5 · Range & precision	C1 tools used naturally	some C1 tools	mostly B2 language

6 · Accuracy, register & concision	precise, formal, tight	some errors or padding	errors block meaning
The defense	★★★	★★	★
1 · Opening statement	from notes, signposted	partly read	read aloud / lost
2 · Understanding questions	answered what was asked	once or twice off target	often misunderstood
3 · Concede & hold	poised every time	sometimes collapsed or stonewalled	rarely
4 · Hedging	claims well calibrated	occasionally overclaimed	overclaimed or gave up
5 · Fluency strategies	kept going smoothly	one or two freezes	often froze
6 · Delivery & interaction	calm, clear, courteous	mostly	hurried or hesitant

★ My examiners' star: _____

🎯 My examiners' wish: _____

◆ SELF-CHECK – CIRCLE A, B OR C

1

What single element most distinguishes a position paper from a simple opinion essay?

A) It is much longer and more detailed.

B) It stays neutral and presents every view equally.

C) It acknowledges a counter-argument and rebuts it.

2

In the Q&A, someone raises a genuinely fair objection to your case. The most advanced response is to:

A) refuse to concede anything and restate your thesis more loudly

B) concede the fair point, then explain why your position still holds

C) immediately abandon your position and agree

3

An examiner asks a long question, and you're not sure what exactly they mean. Which is the best start?

A) "Sorry, I don't understand. Next question, please."

B) "If I've understood your question, you're asking whether the evidence applies to smaller cities. To some extent, yes; however..."

C) Answer a different question that you prepared at home.

◆  I CAN...

- ◆ ☐ write a concise position paper with a clear thesis, supported arguments, a fair objection and a rebuttal
- ◆ ☐ use the C1 toolkit where my argument needs it, not as decoration
- ◆ ☐ summarize my paper aloud from notes in two minutes
- ◆ ☐ check a question, concede what is fair, hold what is sound, and hedge a claim
- ◆ ☐ keep going under questioning without freezing
- ◆ ☐ ask a peer a sharp, respectful question about their argument

◆ MY FINAL C1 JOURNAL

Which module changed your English the most, and why? Which C1 tool now feels automatic, and which still takes conscious effort? How does it feel to have finished all twenty-four lessons, and what is one goal you want to carry forward, into C2, your work or your studies?

